WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2026

The Indian EXPRESS

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 20 PAGES

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THE INDIAN EXPRESS

The World

WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2026

Australian social media users can choose to opt out of algorithms

Associated Press
Canberra, September 8

AUSTRALIAN SOCIAL media users would be given a choice to opt out of algorithms under proposed laws announced by the government Tuesday that would let users have more control over what they see on their social media feeds.

"We'll require social media platforms to provide user empowerment tools that give people over the age of 16 genuine and enduring choice about what they see in their feeds," Prime Minister Anthony Albanese told reporters in Canberra.

The proposed legislation would also protect children from content promoting eating disorders, hostile ideas about women, pornography, crime, dangerous stunts.

The move for more user control and to keep children safer online follows Australia introducing world-first laws in December last year that ban children younger than 16 from holding accounts on the world's largest social media platforms including Instagram, Facebook and TikTok.

"It gives users choice and it will hold the big tech companies responsible for inaction. If they don't follow our laws, they will face penalties," Albanese added. Penalties under the proposed Digital Duty of Care legislation could be as high as $78.6 million.

TEHRAN-BACKED HOUTHIS ACCUSE RIYADH OF LAUNCHING AIRSTRIKES ON YEMEN

Houthis strike oil facilities in 4 Saudi cities as war expands

US submersible captured near Strait, says IRGC

Reuters
Cairo, Dubai, September 8

YEMEN'S TEHRAN-backed Houthis attacked four cities in the south of US ally Saudi Arabia Tuesday, injuring over 70 people and setting oil installations ablaze in what appeared to be a major expansion of the six-month-old West Asia war.

The Houthis said they launched a broad operation deep into Saudi territory. They used drones and missiles to strike a Saudi airbase in southern city of Khamis Mushait, and targets belonging to Saudi Arabia's state oil company in nearby Abha, Najran on the Yemeni border, and Jazan, a major Red Sea port city that houses a large refinery and power plant.

NASA satellite images showed a thick cloud of black smoke over the Jazan refinery and a column of white smoke rising from an oil distribution centre in Abha.

Saudi authorities described blazes at the sites and said women and children were among the 73 people hurt. The reports of such large numbers of wounded suggested the attacks were among the biggest carried out against Saudi Arabia since the US and Israel launched their war against Iran in February.

The Houthis released pictures of explosions of what they said were trucks from Saudi Arabia they had hit in separate strikes at the border in another area the previous day.

Houthi-controlled media reported later on Tuesday that Saudi warplanes had carried out airstrikes in Yemen's Jubah district east of the capital Sanaa and Taiz province in the southwest.

Saudi Arabia has led an Arab coalition battling against the Houthis in Yemen for more than a decade. That war had calmed in recent years, but a ceasefire there has broken down, with the Houthis threatening shipping at the mouth of the Red Sea.

The International Organization for Migration said more than 18,500 people had fled their homes because of fighting along Yemen's west coast over the past three days. "The coalition will take all necessary operational measures to deter this terrorist militia and resolutely confronts its hostile approach," Turki al-Malki, spokesperson for the Saudi-led coalition, son X.

Houthi spokesperson Yahya Saree accused Riyadh of having escalated the war by launching airstrikes on Yemen, and said the Houthis would respond.

Meanwhile, the navy of Iran's Revolutionary Guards said on Tuesday it had captured an unmanned US submersible at the mouth of the strait. There was no confirmation from Washington.

US imposes 36 fresh sanctions on Iran, aviation sector targeted

Washington: The United States on Tuesday issued 36 fresh Iran-related sanctions targeting Iran's aviation sector and other companies as part of a broad push to escalate economic pressure on Tehran as the war in West Asia entered a seventh month.

The US Treasury Department said the action was aimed at grounding Iran's Mahan Air, already sanctioned by the US and the EU, and all other Iranian airlines.

The sanctions also took aim at covert front companies, foreign intermediaries and deceptive trans-shipment routes that Washington says Iran relies on to obtain US-origin aircraft and sensitive technology.

The Treasury also issued an alert asking financial institutions to report any procurement networks supporting Iran's aviation industry, while designating firms based in Turkey and the UAE that it said helped Tehran procure US-origin aircraft and sensitive technology. **Reuters**

Israel to close British consulate after UK, France, Canada ban trade imports from settlements

12 countries make statement in support of two-state solution

London, Tel Aviv, Paris, September 8

ISRAEL SAID Tuesday it was closing Britain's consulate in East Jerusalem in response to plans by the UK, France and Canada to block imports from Israeli settlements in West Bank.

Britain will also no longer participate in a US-led coordination mission for Gaza and some British officials, including former Labour party leader Jeremy Corbyn, and other nationals will be banned from entering Israel, Israeli Foreign Minister Gideon Saar said.

"The British move is morally distorted, and constitutes blatant interference in the affairs of a sovereign state and its electoral process," he said, describing comments by Foreign Secretary Ed Miliband about ethnic cleansing of Palestinians by Israel as accusations that were "outrageous lies".

A view of the British Consulate in east Jerusalem. AP

The British consulate in East Jerusalem is accredited to the Palestinian Authority in the West Bank. Saar said that he had coordinated Israel's response with Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu as Israeli President Isaac Herzog accused Britain of interfering in Israel's upcoming elections, due in late October.

The trade measures proposed by Britain, France and Canada on Tuesday are the latest in a series of actions targeting Israel's settlement policy and underscore its growing diplomatic isolation among some of its traditional allies.

They were joined by foreign ministers of 10 countries, including Denmark, Norway, Poland, Spain and Sweden, in a statement reaffirming support for a negotiated two-state settlement, a Palestinian state co-existing peacefully alongside Israel. Concern is mounting over settlement expansion and violence in Israeli-occupied West Bank.

"Together, we are resolute: the two-state solution must be protected, and we will take action in pursuit of a just and lasting peace," they said.

Miliband said on Tuesday that Britain could no longer simply "call out" injustice and suffering, but had to act to oppose the expansion of settlements, which he said threatened viability of a Palestinian state.

Trump told Putin he wants swift end to war: Kremlin

Reuters
Moscow, September

DONALD TRUMP told Russian President Vladimir Putin by phone on Tuesday that he wanted a swift end to the war in Ukraine, which would allow US-Russia ties to be fully restored, the Kremlin said, adding that Putin had supported the US president's view.

The call, which the Kremlin said lasted an hour, followed a visit to Moscow and Kyiv by US envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, who are trying to revive stalled talks designed to find a way to end the fighting.

Their weekend diplomacy did not appear to result in any immediate public breakthrough although they did raise possibility that three-way talks between Russia, Ukraine and the US could be resumed. The Kremlin, which has said it does not rule that out, made no mention of the possibility in its readout of the Putin-Trump call.

Instead, Kremlin aide Yuri Ushakov said the two leaders rated the US envoys' weekend diplomacy "with a plus sign" and Putin told Trump what he believed the US could do to help end the conflict and given him an assessment of what the situation on battlefield was. Trump, Ushakov said, had made it clear he wanted the war quickly finished.

"Donald Trump clearly emphasised desirability of bringing conflict to an end as soon as possible, which would immediately open up prospects – impressive and far-reaching ones at that – for full restoration of relations between US and Russia," said Ushakov. "In his view, this would have a particular impact on trade and economic ties, promising enormous benefits for both countries.

Donald Trump is keen to see a breakthrough achieved during his presidency. Vladimir Vladimirovich Putin supported this approach."

Russia strikes Kyiv after pause in attacks for US envoys' visit, kills 5

Kyiv: Russia pummelled Kyiv with drones and missiles on Tuesday, resuming its air attacks on the Ukrainian capital after a brief halt for the visit of US peace negotiators, and killing five people, Mayor Vitali Klitschko said.

The overnight attack caused fires in several districts across the Ukrainian capital, damaging at least 14 high-rise buildings, a dorm, a school, a clinic, warehouses and other sites, officials said. "Kyiv was exploding and burning," Katarina Mathernova, EU ambassador to Ukraine, said.

Explosions reverberated across the city as Russia kept menacing it with jet-powered drones into Tuesday afternoon.

Two people were killed in a strike on a warehouse, bringing the total death toll in the city to five, Klitschko said. Close to 30 people have been injured, authorities said. **REUTERS**

NEPAL DISASTER

Air pocket, muddy water: A fight to survive for 9 days

Reuters
September 8

A DELIRIOUS Kabir Maharjan drifted in and out of consciousness in muddy water, trapped for nine days in a tunnel beneath the wreckage of Nepal's worst flood in decades.

When he awoke in hospital after a rescue, he did not recognise his wife. He asked why she had not given him a bed sooner.

Maharjan was one of hundreds of hydropower workers believed buried after a glacier collapsed above Nepal's Trishuli valley on August 26, unleashing mud and water that killed over 1,300 people and left thousands missing across Nepal and neighbouring Tibet.

Maharjan and mechanical foreman Sanjay Sah survived in an air-filled chamber, said lawmaker Shri Ram Neupane, a tunnel engineer involved in the rescue. Their survival has raised hopes for the 121 workers still believed trapped as of Monday.

At 7:30 am Maharjan called his wife before starting his shift at the Upper Trishuli 3A hydropower project. "I have to go inside the tunnel," he told her. "There won't be any network inside." An hour later, a glacier collapsed at Langtang Lirung mountain, 25 miles upstream, triggering a landslide and wall of water that flattened villages and submerged 12 hydropower projects with 900 workers inside.

In Kathmandu, officials watched power supplies disappear from control panels. Suraj Dahal, a Nepal Electricity Authority engineer said he was not alarmed because floods were normal in Nepal.

Search and rescue teams at the Upper Trishuli-3A Hydropower Project, Rasuwa, on Tuesday

Officials soon realised the scale. The 3A station manager was abroad, delaying contact with about 40 workers by two minutes. At 9:15 am, after his wife failed to reach him, officials ordered station to "Evacuate!"

Sah, working in the powerhouse control room, ran floor to floor warning colleagues. Outside, workers tried to escape but were swept away. Footage showed about 30 workers engulfed by a wave.

Rescuers later identified an escape ladder that could have saved many inside, Dahal said. But workers "didn't know where to go".

Of four access routes, drawings showed one ran over 180 metres to the underground powerhouse, but rescuers believed it was fully flooded.

Neupane instead focused on a shorter cable-duct tunnel, where Maharjan and Sah had sheltered, 160 metres from the exit. For nine days, the air pocket that saved them became their prison. Sah recited Hindu prayers, while Maharjan drank muddy water to survive, his wife said.

Rescuers faced deep landslide debris, rain and collapsing ground. A five-inch borehole confirmed tunnel's alignment.

On the 10th day, rescuers heard noises while drilling. They estimated the source was 15 to 20 metres away. Then they saw a hand. Soldiers opened a small hole. From inside came one word: "hunuhuncha" — "we are here". Neither man could stand when rescued. Sah was carried out on a rescuer's back, while Maharjan was taken out on a stretcher.

5.3 magnitude quake hits Nepal

Kathmandu: An earthquake measuring 5.3 magnitude hit Mustang district in northwest Nepal on Tuesday.

The epicentre of the earthquake was Lomanthang in Mustang district, 375 km Northwest of Kathmandu, according to the National Earthquake Monitoring and Research Centre. The earthquake occurred at 9.53 pm.

There was no report of any damage caused by the earthquake. The tremor was also felt in neighbouring Manang, Dolp and Myagdi districts.

Meanwhile the neighbouring country of Tibet was struck by a 5.3 magnitude quake, European-Mediterranean Seismological Centre said. **REUTERS & PTI**

Toll climbs to 1,357 as rescue efforts continue

Kathmandu: The death toll from the devastating flash floods in Nepal rose to 1,357 on Tuesday as more bodies were recovered from the affected areas, authorities said.

Rescue teams continued to search for 5,326 people, while 13,583 people have been rescued so far, the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) said.

The death toll from the devastating flash floods reached 1,357 after more bodes were recovered from different affected areas. The joint command of security forces have recovered 363 bodies from Chitawan district, 223 from Nawalparasi East, 222 from Nawalparasi West and 197 from Nuwakot.

The disaster killed at least 43 people on the Chinese side, while over 500 people remain missing in Tibet, according to Chinese media reports. **PTI**

BRIEFLY

FRANCE

Two Renoir works stolen in Museum heist

THIEVES STOLE four valuable Renoir paintings Tuesday from a small museum on the French Riviera, but abandoned two of them as they fled, the local mayor said adding that police are searching for the perpetrators. A group of "well-equipped" and "well-informed" thieves entered the Renoir Museum in Cagnes-sur-Mer via the garden, the town's mayor, Bryan Masson, told reporters at the scene. They sliced through a fence with an electric knife or saw, entered the museum through the ground floor, and then cut clips securing artwork frames, Masson said. AP

UNITED STATES

Huawei faces trial over theft of US tech, fraud

HUAWEI TECHNOLOGIES, a leading Chinese tech company, faces a criminal racketeering trial in New York over charges that it stole technology, plotted to steal US trade secrets and committed wire and bank fraud, among other crimes. Jury selection began Tuesday afternoon. Opening statements weren't expected to occur until Wednesday. The indictment alleges besides stealing trade secrets, Huawei and some of its subsidiaries did business in North Korea despite US sanctions there and installed surveillance equipment that helped Iran spy on protesters during anti-government demonstrations in 2009. AP

Over 600 flights cancelled in UK after ATC faces technical issues

Associated Press
London, September 8

MORE THAN 600 flights were canceled on Tuesday due to a technical issue in Britain's air traffic control system that caused disruptions at major airports across the UK, the flight monitoring website Flightradar24 reported.

Britain's National Air Traffic Services said a problem had been identified in its flight processing system and engineers were urgently working on the issue, which affected flights across UK. In an update, it said it "implemented a fix and our flight system is starting to recover."

At least 625 flights to and from UK airports, including London Heathrow, were canceled, affecting services operated by multiple airlines, including British Airways, EasyJet, KLM and Lufthansa, according to Flightradar24.

A passenger looks at a departure board displaying cancelled flights at Heathrow Airports in London, on Tuesday. REUTERS

Some passengers took to social media to complain about being stuck on the tarmac for hours, before their flights were eventually canceled. Many expressed frustration about a lack of communication from airlines.

The affected airports included Stansted and City in London, as well as those in Manchester, Birmingham, Gatwick and Scotland. They warned passengers to check the status of their flight with their airline.

It was not clear what caused the technical problem.

OUTSIDE THE TREKIVERSE, DISPARITIES IN GENERATIONAL SLANG, POLITICS AND SOCIAL MORES ARE PRACTICALLY A FOREGONE CONCLUSION; BUT *STAR TREK* FUNCTIONS AS CONNECTIVE TISSUE BETWEEN FANS PAST & PRESENT

60 years of *Star Trek*: Fans pass down not only shared language but values too

Sam Corbin
September 8

AT 76, FRAN Friedrich knows the words to every episode of the original *Star Trek*.

In fact, she's pretty sure she could recite them by heart if she had to. "I say the lines with them, 'cause I've seen them a zillion times," Friedrich said, referring to the nightly reruns of the original series on cable, which she watches in addition to streaming the other *Star Trek* series during the day. "I can't live without it. It's just part of my life."

That's how Friedrich's son, Robert, remembers it, too. A *Star Trek* fan "by birth," he described a childhood spent listening to his mother and his aunt quote different phrases from the show back and forth at each other, or speak them in unison. "Sometimes I'd catch it, and sometimes I didn't," Robert said. "And if I didn't catch it, I knew it was from *Star Trek*. It was always from *Star Trek*."

As of 2026, the 60-year-old science fiction franchise boasts a fandom of carbon units — sorry, humans — that spans at least three generations.

What began, in 1966, as a five-year space mission on the USS Enterprise to "boldly go where no man has gone before" now represents an anthology of space travel across more than 25 series and films in parts of two centuries.

Where once it was James T Kirk or bust, it's not unusual to find fans who prefer other captains, like Picard, Janeway or Sisko. There are so many series to keep track of that fans often communicate using country code-like abbreviations for each installment: TOS (the original series), TNG (The Next Generation), DS9 (Deep Space Nine), ENT (Enterprise) and so on.

Outside the Trekiverse, disparities in generational slang, politics and social mores are practically a foregone conclusion. But "*Star Trek*" functions as connective tissue between fans past and present.

Some of that tissue is just shared references: There will always be captain's logs, timelines by stardate, warp factors one through 10, phasers and photon torpedoes and, every now and then, a doctor who insists, "I'm a doctor, not a ___!"

A poster for the 1966 series

The Vulcan salute has become a general symbol of geek-recognize-geek, but real Trekkies (or Trekkers, as some prefer) know that "Live long and prosper" is only half the message; the recipient is meant to say "Peace and long life" in response.

But the series' staying power, and the ease with which each generation finds its way into them, is an indication that fans of all ages share not only language, but values, in common.

Friedrich, who grew up Catholic and remains religious, also found a certain proverbial wisdom in the ways in which characters treat one another. "Everyone cares about each other," she said. "I've always liked that, because I'm kind of a compassionate person. And it relates to God quite a bit."

Robert, too, found that as he started watching the series with his mother, he took spiritual teachings from the show. When Spock said that "having is not so pleasing a thing, after all, as wanting," it struck him as "something that came out of, you know, maybe the Bible."

Seeing his mother so comfortably "geeking out over stuff" also gave Robert license to chase a geekdom of his own: comic books. Now, at 50, he delights in being able to normalize geekdom for his 10-year-old daughter. "Kids are going to always look over with interest, you know?" he said. "'Hey, what's my mom doing? What's my dad doing?' And so the seed gets planted yet again."

In some families, the planting of that seed isn't so subtle.

Kirk James Damato, a comedy writer based in Los Angeles, was named after the captain of the USS Enterprise, with Captain Kirk's first and last names reversed in order to make the association especially clear. "My parents very much valued the relationship between Kirk/Spock/McCoy," Damato wrote in a message.

In a sense, he noted, he got off easy: "They wanted to name my older brother Spock, but fortunately rethought that decision."

In a feat of nominative determinism, Damato fell in love with "Star Trek," attending fan conventions and developing his own relationship to the show.

By dint of its basic humanist principles, "Star Trek" generally leans left of center on political issues. It imagines a future without a scarcity mind-set, where respect for others' cultures and societies is implied in every interaction — essentially, a future in which everyone lives long and prospers. A friend and longtime fan I spoke to described the show as "the most hopeful futurism we have." **NYT**

The Editorial Page: Questions for Bhagwat, and how he can easily lay debate over his remarks to rest 8

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Happening today

● **NAVY CHIEF** Admiral Krishna Swaminathan will begin a visit to Australia and New Zealand.

THE BIG PICTURE

NEPAL FLOODS: THE FAMILY IN THE PHOTOGRAPH PAGE 12

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY

UNVEILS SLEW OF PROJECTS WORTH OVER Rs 35,000 CRORE IN GUJARAT

Freight corridors complete, UPA kept files pending: PM

'Atakti, latakti, bhatakti': Modi on 'administrative inertia' before 2014

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, September 8

INDIA LOST several years to "administrative inertia", as files for key infrastructure projects kept moving from one office to another, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Tuesday as he criticised the UPA era that preceded his term.

The Prime Minister addressed a "NaMo for Viksit Bharat" gathering in Vadodara after inaugurating three key sections of the 1,500-km Western Dedicated Freight Corridor connecting Jawaharlal Nehru Port Trust (JNPT) in Navi Mumbai with Dadri near Noida in Uttar Pradesh.

The Dedicated Freight Corridor project, comprising 2,800 km of high-speed railway lines along the eastern and western corridors, was now complete, the Prime Minister said.

"This is a major milestone for Gati Shakti and India's logistics transformation", and a "historic achievement for 21st century India", he said.

The Prime Minister described the completion of the Dedicated Freight Corridor as evidence of the way in which

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

PM Narendra Modi in Vadodara, Tuesday. BHUPENDRA RANA SURPRISED BY FURORE OVER GDP: MODI, P 11

2,843 km, 400-plus trains: Corridors cut time and cost, offer last-mile link

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, September 8

AMONG THE projects that Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated in Vadodara on Tuesday were the last three sections of the Western Dedicated Freight Corridor (WDFC), together covering 326 kilometres and developed at a cost of over Rs 20,700 crore.

These three sections between Gujarat and Maharashtra — New Sanand (N)-New Makarpura, New Umbergaon-New Saphale, New Saphale-New Jawaharlal Nehru Port Trust (JNPT) — mark the completion of the 1,506-km WDFC, which runs from JNPT in Navi

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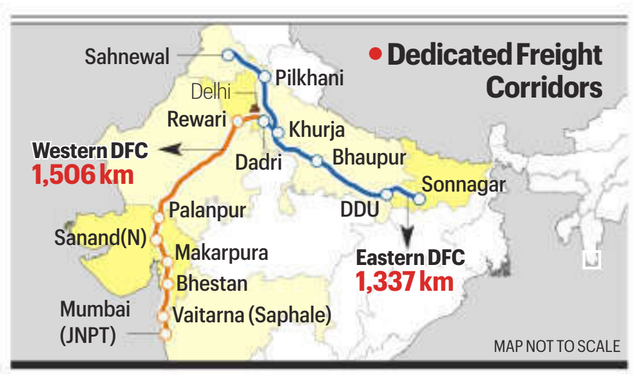

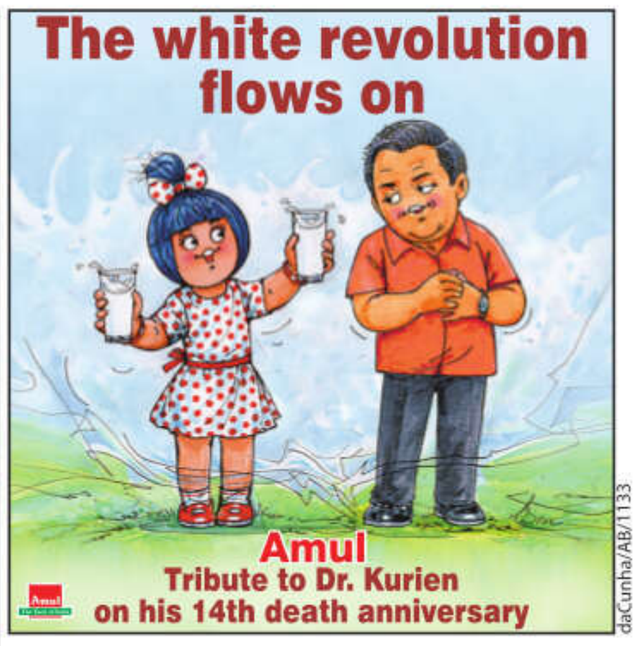

Putin and Modi to hold talks Friday ahead of BRICS summit: Kremlin

Welcomes Indian efforts to end Ukraine conflict

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, September 8

UNDERLINING THAT Russia does 90 per cent of its payments with BRICS member countries through national currencies, Kremlin spokesperson Dmitry Peskov said Tuesday that Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Russian President Vladimir Putin will meet Friday, a day ahead of the summit of BRICS leaders in New Delhi on September 12-13.

In an online interaction with India-based journalists, organised by Russian media outlet Sputnik India, Peskov said, "Our two leaders are in a very close personal contact, they are very pragmatic... and they are as sincere as to be able to discuss in a very open and constructive way the most sensitive issues on the global agenda and our bilateral relations."

He described BRICS as a flexible club organised around policy and security, economics and finance, and cultural and humanitarian cooperation.

"Like always, they (Modi and Putin) will touch on the bilateral agenda... Trade and economic cooperation have a very wide scope. You know that lots of issues cannot be discussed publicly, having some unfriendly countries that are

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Illegal constructions: SC indicates may lay down pan-India guidelines

Top court to take up Satya Niketan building collapse matter tomorrow

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, September 8

TWO DAYS after a building housing students in South Delhi's Satya Niketan collapsed, killing seven persons, the Supreme Court Tuesday indicated it may transfer to itself a matter related to unauthorised and unsafe constructions, which is being heard by the Delhi High Court, and said it intends to lay down pan-India guidelines.

On Thursday, the Supreme Court will hear issues related to the Satya Niketan building collapse and an application filed

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THE CITY PAGE 4

MCD PREPARES TO DEMOLISH BUILDINGS

Row over Kharge visit 'purification': Haldwani police file FIR against 'unknown' persons

Vidheesha Kuntamalla & Asad Rehman
Dehradun, New Delhi, September 8

POLICE IN Uttarakhand's Haldwani have registered an FIR against "unknown" persons over the alleged "purification" of the city's Ramlila Maidan following a rally last month by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge.

Police had received around 80 complaints and petitions from across the state, including 19 from Nainital district alone, in the matter.

On August 30, an FIR was lodged against Rahul Gandhi, Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha, for allegedly giving the issue a caste angle.

The FIR against Gandhi was based on a complaint by Amit Kumar, a resident of Jawahar Nagar Colony in Haldwani, who said he was a member of the Valmiki community. He said that he, along with other members of his community, had participated in a "cleanliness drive and religious ritual" at Ramlila Maidan, and that the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Deleted from Punjab, Chadha back on Delhi rolls; illegal entry, says AAP

Availed remedies, says MP; Delhi CEO office: All Form 6 being processed

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 8

Rajya Sabha MP Raghav Chadha moved from AAP to BJP in April

DAYS AFTER he alleged "political vendetta" behind the deletion of his name from the draft Special Intensive Revision (SIR) roll in Punjab, BJP Rajya Sabha MP Raghav Chadha was back on the electoral rolls Tuesday — but in Delhi.

Addressing the media, the Aam Aadmi Party alleged that Chadha, who left the party to join the BJP in April, had got himself enrolled illegally as a voter in Delhi after being struck off the draft SIR roll last month in Punjab, where he had been registered as a voter since at least 2024.

Responding to the allegation, Chadha, in a statement, said, "The facts are simple and straightforward. I have followed

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Investigations to in-depth reporting: Indian Express Group and OpenAI team up to enrich reader experience

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 8

THE INDIAN Express Group and OpenAI Tuesday announced a strategic partnership designed to help more people discover and engage with the Group's original journalism.

The partnership will enhance how content from participating Express Group publications appears in ChatGPT: When select summaries or excerpts are surfaced in response to relevant questions, results will clearly identify the source and include direct links to the original articles, helping readers access the full reporting and analysis on the publisher's platforms.

The initial partnership will include content from *The Indian Express*, *The Financial Express*, the Group's business properties, and will cover live reporting and archived content across seven languages

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● FELLOW MUSICIANS, FAMILY MEMBERS HOLD CANDLELIGHT VIGIL IN IMPHAL DEMANDING JUSTICE

'Always kind, never argued': Colleagues on Manipur musician killed in Delhi

Suanshu Khurana & Jimmy Leivon
New Delhi, Imphal, September 8

CHONGTHAM VIKRAM Singh grew up in a family steeped in music. His mother Chongtham Kamala, now 85, is one of the defining voices of Manipuri music and cinema. She sang in *Matamgi Manipur* (1972) — the first Manipuri feature film in which her melodious voice earned her the moniker 'Lata Mangeshkar of Manipur'.

But Singh wanted an identity distinct from his mother's, and chose the electric guitar to find himself. He went on to become a pioneering guitarist of Manipur's early rock scene.

Beaten to death in Delhi's Kilokari village after objecting to a group making noise outside his residence on Monday, the 54-year-old leaves behind a significant musical career that ranged from Manipur's early Western music scene to years spent teaching and mentoring young musicians in the Capital.

Those who have worked with him — from guitarist Sachidananda Angom to folk musician Mame Khan of Coke Studio India fame — remember him as someone who was "always kind, helpful" and who "never had arguments with anyone."

Singh is survived by his wife, Joshna, 54, and their son Yaiphaba, 20, a law student.

On Tuesday, fellow musicians, family members and well-wishers held a candlelight vigil at the Kangla fort in Imphal, demanding justice.

Manipur Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh, in a letter to his Delhi counterpart Rekha Gupta, requested that a fair probe be conducted

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Joshna, wife of Chongtham Vikram Singh who was killed in New Delhi. ABHINAV SAHA PAGE 3

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Freight corridors

the country's work culture had changed since his government came to power 12 years ago.

The idea of a Dedicated Freight Corridor to streamline the movement of cargo across the country was conceived in 2004, and two years later, a dedicated company was set up to execute it, the Prime Minister said.

But "until 2014, the files simply kept moving from one place to another, from one desk to the other... To the misfortune of the files, there was no dedicated corridor for them," he said.

The earlier government's approach was such that "not even one kilometre of the freight corridor could be completed in seven or eight years", the PM said. "*Filein atakti thi, latakti thi, bhatakti thi* (Files would keep getting stuck, lost, or were kept hanging)," he said.

Addressing the younger people among the 6,000-strong gathering of students, state ministers, MLAs, BJP leaders, and social media influencers at the Pavilion Ground of The Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda, Modi said: "Had the country been run in their (UPA's) way, who knows, perhaps three or four generations would have come after you, even then [this project] would not have been completed."

The PM cited figures to underline the impact of the Dedicated Freight Corridors: more than 430 goods trains now run daily on the Eastern and Western corridors, and a train that took six-and-a-half hours to cover 100 km now does that distance in less than half that time, he said.

Modi noted that a single double-stack container train had recently transported a load from JNPT to Vadodara that would have required more than 250 trucks to carry. However, "naaraz fufas (grumpy uncles)" would start screaming, "what will happen to truckers", he said, using the same expression that he had used in his speech at Shri Ram College of Commerce in Delhi on September 5 to mock older people who were allegedly unable to think positively.

Later in his speech, the Prime Minister used the expression "Jhooth ki Goonj", seemingly a reference to Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi's "Chhatron ki Goonj' youth outreach, and declared that the youth of India were guided by the "roar of truth".

At a time when the BJP and the central government face significant anger from younger voters on a range of issues led by the state of education and leaks of competitive examination question papers, Modi's message to the youth was clear: They were too young to know the crises that had gripped the country before the NDA's rule, his tenure as Prime Minister brought better governance, and those critical of him were naysayers and out of sync with the aspirations of the youth.

Modi also spoke about artificial intelligence (AI), and said India faced a race against time to prepare for the transformation that this new technology was bringing.

"We want the coming generation of our young people to be prepared for AI... If we want to become a superpower in AI, then the country will have to prepare for it and build its ecosystem," he said.

The PM urged the youth to understand that AI skills were not confined to the technology sector. A person equipped with the right skills "can develop new AI solutions for agriculture, create technology for the healthcare sector, improve productivity in manufacturing, or launch a startup in robotics", he said.

For almost 150 years, Vadodara had demonstrated how "education, skills and industry" could come together, the PM said. "A journey that began with textiles and tiles later expanded into oil and petrochemicals... Vadodara emerged as a major MSME hub over the past two to two-and-a-half decades. Today, look at how dramatically things have changed... India's first Made-in-India military transport aircraft, the first flight of the C-295 aircraft has taken to the skies from here," he said.

During his visit to Vadodara, Modi inaugurated, laid the foundation stones for, and flagged off projects adding up to more than Rs 35,200 crore. These included development projects worth more than Rs 30,766 crore under Railways.

Later, he inaugurated the BJP's new 'Namo Kamalam' office in Navsari town of South Gujarat.

To cut transit time, cost

Mumbai to Dadri (Uttar Pradesh) near Delhi.

Traffic on the western corridor mainly comprises ISO containers from JNPT and Mumbai Port in Maharashtra, and Pipavav, Mundra and Kandla ports in Gujarat, headed for Inland Container Depots (ICDs) located in north India, mostly at Tughlakabad (Delhi), Dadri (UP), Dhandari Kalan (Punjab) and Khatuwas (Rajasthan). The corridor is also expected to see the transport of fertilisers, foodgrain, salt, coal, iron, steel and cement.

With the last remaining stretch on the WDFC, between Vaitarna (Saphale) and JNPT in Maharashtra, now operational, freight loading on the corridor is expected to increase further, driven by the direct connectivity to JNPT.

The 1,337-km Eastern Dedicated Freight Corridor (EDFC) runs from Ludhiana (Punjab) to Sonnagar (Bihar), and caters mostly to coal and mineral traffic from eastern India. The EDFC has two distinct segments -- an electrified double-line segment of 936 km between Sonnagar (Bihar) and Dadri (UP), and an electrified single-track segment of 401 km between Ludhiana (Sahnewal) in Punjab and Khurja in UP.

The alignment of the EDFC, which was fully commissioned in October 2023, takes a detour to bypass densely populated towns like Mirzapur, Allahabad, Kanpur, Etawah, Firozabad, Tundla, Hathras, Aligarh, Hapur, Meerut, Muzaffarnagar, Ambala, Rajpura, Sirhind, Doraha and Sahnewal.

These special freight corridors are one of the biggest infrastructure projects undertaken by the Railways. Currently, a total of about 426 freight trains run on both corridors daily.

While the current share of freight traffic by rail is around 27%, the National Rail Plan has envisaged an increase to 45% by 2030 i.e 3,000 million tonnes. The Railways recorded its highest ever loading of 1,670 million tonnes in the 2025-26 financial year.

Due to their separation from the passenger network, the DFCs offer reduced transit time, less cost, and last mile connectivity at certain places.

According to Railways data, the average speed of trains on DFCs was over 50 kmph, double the average speed of freight trains on the non-DFC network. In April and May, the speed was 44.9 kmph and 44.7 respectively on the EDFC, and 53.6 kmph and 52.3 kmph respectively on the WDFC.

In Indian Railways, freight revenue plays a crucial role in subsidising passenger travel, with freight services accounting for over 65 per cent of the Railways' total earnings.

Earlier, due to oversaturation of the existing trunk routes -- Howrah-Delhi on the eastern corridor and Mumbai-Delhi on the western corridor -- with line capacity utilisation varying between 115 per cent and 150 per cent, Railways saw a dip in freight traffic.

This led to the conceptualisation of the Dedicated Freight Corridors (DFCs) along the eastern and western routes, which would be separated from the passenger network. The importance of the DFCs can be gauged from the fact that the National Highways along these corridors, comprising 0.5 per cent of the road network, account for almost 40 per cent of the total road freight.

The DFC project was first discussed at a Japan-India meeting in April 2005. It was included in the declaration of co-operation signed between the two sides. A feasibility study report was prepared in October 2007 and a special purpose vehicle -- the Dedicated Freight Corridor Corporation of India Limited (DFCCIL) -- was set up for construction, operation and maintenance of the corridors.

The projects were financed through debt funding from World Bank (Rs 14,900 crore) and Japan International Cooperation Agency (Rs 38,722 crore), with gross budgetary support accounting for the remaining amount.

In its Budget this year, the government announced plans for a third corridor, connecting Dankuni in West Bengal to Surat in Gujarat. The detailed project report is being prepared.

Putin and Modi to hold talks

trying to put obstacles in the way of further development of our cooperation. So it is being discussed discreetly, but in a very, very constructive manner," he said, indicating the threat of sanctions from the Western countries on Indian businesses dealing with Russia.

"Indian companies are interested in the Russian market. They are interested in broadening their investments in the Russian economy in various projects. We appreciate and welcome that," he said.

On the BRICS declaration on the war in West Asia where the UAE and Iran have been at loggerheads, Peskov said, "The UAE and Iran, understandably, there are contradictions in their positions, and understandably, they are now experiencing problems in their bilateral relations. We sincerely wish those countries who are good friends of Russia to overcome this very hard period in their history, and Russia is ready to contribute, if it is necessary, in normalisation of the relationship... So, you ask if it influences the processes within BRICS... Yes, of course, it has a negative impact, and it gets the work on drafting the papers on declaration more complicated. But we have very talented diplomats, and we have very talented diplomats on the side of the Indian presidency. We have no doubt that necessary phrasings will be found in order to satisfy national interests of both countries concerned."

On the issue of Russia-Ukraine war, he blamed the West including Europe. "We know the position of India on the Ukrainian conflict, and to a great extent, by the way, it corresponds with our own position, because we do want the solution of the Ukrainian conflict by peaceful means, and Russia is open to this process. We actually never wanted this war. What we are trying to do, we are trying to stop the war that was launched before, and it was not launched by us. It was not started by us."

Asked about India's possible role, he said, "We welcome all attempts to make any contribution in the sphere of Ukraine settlement. We welcome the willingness of the Indian side to contribute. We welcome the efforts of American President Trump. He is really willing to contribute to the solution, and you know that very serious work is being done. American negotiators are spending lots of time and lots of effort, travelling between Moscow and Kyiv these days, conveying each other's positions. We hope that there will be some movement in this respect, we hope for the restart of negotiations between the three parties: Russian, Ukrainian and American. So we do hope for the best. We do hope that sooner or later we will pursue a peaceful way of solution."

On sanctions imposed on Russia, Peskov said, "We do not accept, and we consider it to be illegal, definitely illegal in terms of international law, any attempt to introduce limitations on international trade and to threaten other countries, third parties for doing trade with others. We consider it illegal, unfair, and unacceptable."

Asked about Russian energy supply to India, he said, "I wouldn't give you the figure. I don't want to give you any figures due to understandable reasons. But every month we have a new record."

On Indians in the Russian army, he said, "This issue was brought to the agenda by India... with great attentiveness, we approached this issue. Now work is being done to make a list of those Indian citizens who are now on the battlefield, and they will be sent back home as soon as determined. We are in very deep contact, profound contact with the Indian side on this issue."

Asked about defence ties with India, he said, "We are satisfied with our cooperation in technical and military fields... We have very good military equipment... We are ready to share these equipment with our Indian partners. We went further in this cooperation than just selling and buying, we are producing jointly."

"Cooperation in the military field is a very sensitive sphere, and of course, no one would discuss it publicly and openly," he said.

On the delays in delivery of the S-400 air defence system to India, he said, "Russia is capable of fulfilling its obligation, and it will be fulfilled."

On the prospect of the Sukhoi-57 fighter aircraft, he said, "It is a very very sophisticated machine, and they are one of the best in the world. And then the issue of selling those machines to India is on the agenda. The Indian side is (for) production technologies, and this is a question for additional discussions... that are also underway.

Illegal constructions

by the amicus curiae for a time-bound inspection and safety audit of student housing across Delhi.

Appearing before the bench of Justice A Amanullah and Justice R Mahadevan, Senior Advocate Ajit Kumar Sinha, the amicus curiae, said a status report, indicating the progress of the committee set up by the court to carry out inspection of buildings in Lajpat Nagar, Saket, and Malviya Nagar, had been filed. He said, "Satya Niketan did not fall within the scope of the inspection."

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta said the Delhi High Court is already hearing a public interest litigation on the matter and had passed certain directions.

Justice Amanullah said the matters overlap and that the Supreme Court may transfer the High Court proceedings to itself. "It will enlarge the scope. We probably have something in mind. It has to be on an all-India basis," he said.

The report, filed through Advocate Govind Jee, pointed out that Satya Niketan, located near the Delhi University South Campus, had "emerged as a major hub for student accommodation, with a large number of PG accommodations, hostels, messes, eateries and other commercial establishments operating in the area".

"The present incident is also required to be viewed in the context of an earlier building collapse in Satya Niketan in April 2022, in which two persons lost their lives, and four others were injured. The recurrence of such an incident in the same locality raises serious concerns regarding the effectiveness of the existing mechanism for inspection, identification of dangerous structures and enforcement of building bye-laws," it stated.

According to the report, the Satya Niketan incident also needs to be seen in the context of the "larger concentration of PG accommodations and private hostels in areas surrounding colleges and universities in Delhi".

"Such establishments are often operated from residential properties which may have undergone additions, alterations or changes in use," it stated. "The extent to which such premises comply with sanctioned building plans, applicable building bye-laws, permissible land use, structural safety requirements and fire-safety norms requires verification by the competent authorities."

"In these circumstances, it would be appropriate that the inspection exercise be extended beyond the areas" presently identified by the Supreme Court, and that authorities concerned "undertake a time-bound inspection and safety audit of PG accommodations, private hostels and similar student-accommodation establishments situated in and around colleges and universities across Delhi," the report stated.

"Such exercise ought to include verification of: (i) sanctioned building plans; (ii) actual construction and number of floors; (iii) basement construction and alterations; (iv) permissible land use; (v) structural safety; (vi) fire-safety compliance; (vii) means of ingress and egress; and (viii) the existence of any dangerous or ruinous condition."

The report said the inspection of Lajpat Nagar and other areas was completed on September 3. "During the course of the said inspection, the Committee is stated to have found certain buildings situated in Saidulajab, Saket and Lajpat Nagar to be in a precarious and unsafe condition. The report of the Committee is presently under preparation and is expected to be placed before this Hon'ble Court shortly," it stated.

It said "the precise cause and circumstances leading to the collapse are currently under investigation."

"However, the preliminary material presently available indicates that construction-related work was being undertaken in or around the basement, and there were also reports of water logging in the basement immediately prior to the incident," it stated.

Express Group, OpenAI

— English, Hindi, Marathi, Malayalam, Tamil, Bengali and Gujarati.

Nandagopal Rajan, CEO, Indian Express Digital, said, "Our legacy of agenda-setting investigations, news breaks and a breadth of voices that cut across the political spectrum makes the Express Group unique in Indian media. We have always been open to new technologies, and this partnership creates a new way for readers to discover the work of our large national network of journalists and their rigorous reporting with clear attribution and a direct path to the original source. As technology changes how people find and consume information, our priority remains credible journalism, with full editorial responsibility for everything we publish."

Varun Shetty, Vice President — Media Partnerships, OpenAI, said, "*The Indian Express* has an extraordinary tradition of in-depth investigations and unbiased reporting that helps people understand India in all its depth and complexity. We want AI to help more people discover that work, with clear attribution and direct links, reflecting our commitment to working constructively with publishers and developing technology that supports journalists, readers, and a strong news ecosystem."

The Indian Express Group will continue to exercise complete and independent editorial control over its journalism. OpenAI will have no role in determining which stories the Group reports, how those stories are produced, or the editorial conclusions they reach.

The two organisations will explore how OpenAI technology can support new reader experiences and practical workflows across the Group. Potential areas include archive discovery, research, data analysis, translation, reader services, and business operations. Any editorial use of these tools will remain subject to the Group's standards, policies and human oversight.

The partnership builds on OpenAI's work with news organisations around the world to improve the discovery of reliable information, create responsible applications of AI for publishers, and develop new ways for audiences to engage with original reporting.

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PUBLIC NOTICE ON AUCTION OF PLEDGED GOLD ORNAMENTS

The borrower/s in specific and interested bidders in general, are hereby informed that on account of non-repayment of the Banks due by the borrowers as under despite the payment notice and recall/auction notice issued by the Bank, the gold ornaments pledged with the bank security by the respective borrowers for the loan availed by them will be sold in public auction on "as is where is" and "non-recourse" at branch premises on **22nd September 2026 at 10.30 AM**. The auction may be adjourned to any other later date at the discretion of the bank upon publication of the same in the Bank's notice board. The borrowers are hereby further inform that the gold ornaments will be disposed of by public auction/e-auction, if the auction is not successful, and if there is a further balance to be recovered thereafter, legal action will be initiated against the borrower/s for recovery of the balance amounts due to the bank. "In case of deceased borrower, all conditions will be applicable to legal heirs."

S. No.	Auction Center CSB Branch	Account Name	Client ID	No.of Acc.	Bal. Outstanding as on 06-09-2026	Weight (grams)
1	Rohini Sector 7	Manjeet	10172775	001	28,23,060.66	239.74

For more details/account wise information borrowers/interested bidders may contact respective branches and for participating in the auction

NCT of Delhi | 09.09.2026 Sd/- Authorized Officer, CSB Bank

MADHYA PRADESH POWER TRANSMISSION COMPANY LIMITED

Block No. 3, Shakti Bhawan, Rampur, Jalalpur-482 008
Phone : (0761) 270-2199, 2146, 2162, 2192
E-mail : procurement@mptransco.nic.in

Online Tenders are invited against TR-25/2026 for Construction of Various 220KV Transmission Lines for Transmission system strengthening works in Handia and Sheopur area in Madhya Pradesh associated with power evacuation from 400KV ISTS S/s Handia and 765KV ISTS S/s Morena on Turnkey Basis & TR-26/2026 for Procurement of 33KV Vacuum Circuit Breakers. For further details please visit Website **https://www.mstcecommerce.com/eproc, & https://www.mptenders.gov.in & https://www.mptransco.in**

Madhyam/127936/2026 **CHIEF ENGINEER (Procurement)**

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(Formerly SML ISUZU Limited)

CIN: L50101PB1983PLC005516 | **Regd. Office & Works:** Village Asron, Distt. Shahid Bhagat Singh Nagar (Nawanshahr) Punjab -144 533; **Phone:** 01881- 270155; **Corporate Office:** 1st Floor, T7 Tech Park, C-119, Industrial Area, Phase 7, Sector 73, Mohali, SAS Nagar, Punjab-160055. **Phone:** 0172- 2647700-02; 0172-4155901. **Email:** investors@smlmahindra.com | **Website:** https://smlmahindra.com/in

SPECIAL WINDOW FOR RE-LODGEMENT OF TRANSFER REQUEST OF PHYSICAL SHARES

Shareholder are hereby informed that SEBI vide its Circular No. SEBI/HO/MIRSD/MIRSD-PoD/P/CIR/2025/97 dated 2nd July, 2025 had opened a special window for a period of 6 months from 7th July, 2025 till 6th January, 2026, to facilitate re-lodgment of transfer deeds, which were originally lodged prior to the deadline of 1st April, 2019 and rejected / returned / not attended, due to deficiency in the documents / process / or otherwise.

In this regard, we hereby inform you that SEBI Vide its Circular no. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-POD/ I/3750/2026 dated 30th January, 2026 has opened another special window for a period of one year from 5th February, 2026 to 4th February, 2027 to facilitate transfer and dematerialization of physical share(s), which were sold/purchased prior to 1st April, 2019 and also to facilitate re-lodgment of transfer deeds as mentioned above.

For clarity with regard to applicability of this window, below matrix may be referred to:

Execution Date of Transfer Deed	Lodged for transfer before April 01, 2019?	Original Security Certificate Available?	Eligible to lodge in the current Window?
Before April 01, 2019	No (it is fresh lodgement)	Yes	✓
	Yes (it was rejected/ returned earlier)	Yes	✓
	Yes	No	✗
	No	No	✗

Further, the following cases will also not be considered under this special window:

- Cases involving disputes between transferor and transferee.
- Securities which have been transferred to Investor Education and Protection Fund (IEPF).

Note: All shares re-lodged during this period will be processed through transfer-cum-demat route, i.e. they will only be issued to dematerialized (demat) form after transfer and the same will be subject to a lock-in of one year.

For any further information/clarification in this regard, concerned shareholders can get in touch with the Company /RTA at any of the addresses given below-

SML Mahindra Limited
1st Floor, T7 Tech Park C-119, Industrial Area, Phase 7, Sector 73, Mohali, SAS Nagar, Punjab-160055.
Phone: 0172- 2647700-02; 4155901
Email: investors@smlmahindra.com
Website: https://smlmahindra.com/in

M/s MCS Share Transfer Agent Limited
179-180, DSIDC Shed, 3rd Floor, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase 1, New Delhi-110020.
Phone: 011-41406149, 41406150, 41406151
Email ID: helpdeskdelhi@mcsregistrars.com
Website: https://www.mcsregistrars.com/

Transfer requests submitted after 4th February, 2027, will not be accepted by the Company/RTA.

For **SML MAHINDRA LIMITED**
PARVESH MADAN
Company Secretary | ACS-31266

Place: Mohali, Punjab
Date: 08.09.2026

FIR filed in Haldwani

act had no connection with any individual or caste.

On Monday, the FIR against "unknown" persons was registered at Haldwani Kotwali on the complaint of Anju, a social activist and lawyer based in the city, who was the first person to submit a formal complaint in the matter, police said.

On Tuesday, Nainital SSP Manjunath TC told The Indian Express: "We received various petitions and applications from organisations, political parties... across the state concerning the alleged events at Ramlila Maidan on the 10th (of August) ... specifically the cleaning, rituals, and the alleged purification ceremony."

"We were conducting a legal review of all these applications. During this legal scrutiny, we learned that Anju had been the first to lodge a formal written complaint at the Haldwani Kotwali police station. She had also provided relevant videos to the Station House Officer and other officials," he said.

"Consequently, based on her formal complaint, we have registered an FIR against unknown persons under Sections 196 and 299 of the IPC and Section 3(1)(r) of the SC/ST Act," he said.

The FIR invoked Section 3(1)(r) of the SC/ST Act for caste-based insult/humiliation, and Sections 196 and 299 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) for promoting enmity between groups and deliberately outraging religious feelings.

The FIR did not name any accused.

The complaint by Anju alleged that after Kharge addressed the rally on August 8, the venue was "purified" on August 10 and photographs and videos were circulated on social media.

"It is particularly noteworthy that Shri Mallikarjun Kharge is a person belonging to the Scheduled Caste category," the complaint said.

It said that, in these circumstances, having the venue "purified" after his programme "prima facie appears to be an act intended to create caste discrimination, social insult and hatred and feelings of inferiority towards a person belonging to the Scheduled Caste".

SSP Manjunath said the investigation would now focus on the allegations contained in the complaint and the material submitted to police.

In New Delhi, a group of Dalit Congress MPs and leaders reached the Parliament Street police station, seeking an FIR in the matter.

K Raju, Congress leader and national coordinator for the SC, OBC, Minority and Adivasi Departments, said that the group of MPs, comprising 20 Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha members, reached the police station to file an FIR "against an act of untouchability" committed against the Congress president.

Congress MP Sasikanth Senthil said, "That is untouchability. It is a crime under the law. An FIR against Rahul Gandhi took one day. Against the men who did this? One month and nothing."

Chadha on Delhi rolls

all applicable ECI guidelines and procedures and availed the prescribed remedies." He said the allegations were "frivolous".

The Election Commission of India did not respond to queries from The Indian Express on AAP's allegations.

The office of the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer Ashok Kumar, in a statement, said that approximately 2.14 lakh Form 6 were received while the Delhi electoral roll was frozen for the SIR draft stage from June 16 to August 31. During the draft stage, new electoral registration forms are not included in the draft list.

The CEO office said a total of 25,011 Form 6 had been submitted by electors in eight days, from the publication of the draft roll until Monday. Of those, 700 forms across Delhi had been approved by the EROs as on Tuesday, the CEO said. The statement did not mention Chadha's status specifically.

Chadha's name had figured on the list of Absent, Shifted, Deceased and Duplicate (ASDD) voters who were deleted in the draft SIR roll of Punjab published on August 13, as reported by The Indian Express on September 3.

In a statement issued on September 2, Chadha said that he was "in the process of availing the remedies provided under the SIR guidelines". When The Indian Express checked the electoral registration status of Chadha in Delhi and Punjab on September 2, the ECI's voter services portal showed "no result found".

On Tuesday, AAP Delhi chief Saurabh Bharadwaj alleged that Chadha's name had been added to the rolls of booth number 46 in Rajinder Nagar Assembly constituency in Delhi.

A search for Chadha's details on the ECI's portal showed Raghav Chadha enrolled at serial number 747 of booth number 46. However, the draft electoral roll of that same booth published by the ECI on August 31 as a part of the SIR in Delhi ended at serial number 746, without Chadha's name. Bharadwaj also shared an electronic copy of Chadha's electoral details.

The CEO office said that the new additions in the final roll begin from the last serial number at which the draft roll of the booth is frozen.

"All Forms-6 submitted by electors for inclusion of their names during Pre-SIR period or during period of claims & objections are under process alongwith Forms 7 & 8. Once the Forms are approved, addition, deletion & modification will be reflected in the Electoral Database as the case may be," its statement said.

The EC's SIR guidelines allow those left out of the draft roll to get back on the rolls by filling a Form 6 (voter registration form) in the one-month claims and objections period following the draft publication. All those Form 6 applications approved by the Electoral Registration Officers are then included in the final roll, which in the case of Punjab is due to be published on October 12, and for Delhi on November 4.

According to the EC's SIR guidelines' paragraph 6, the EROs and Chief Electoral Officers are mandated to make the daily list of all Form 6 received available on notice boards and their websites, in the prescribed format known as Form 9, "so that citizens are able to see the list and lodge objections, if any, with the concerned ERO".

In the case of Rajinder Nagar Assembly constituency, the Form 9s uploaded on the CEO website for September 1 to September 7 have a total of 205 names of applicants, which does not include Chadha's name.

According to Chadha's affidavit for the 2022 Rajya Sabha elections, he had declared that he was registered to vote in Booth Number 52 in Delhi's Rajinder Nagar, Delhi. After he entered the Upper House as an MP from Punjab, Chadha shifted his electoral registration, and also voted in a booth in Punjab's SAS Nagar, or Mohali, in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections on June 1, 2024.

Bharadwaj said, "Raghav Chadha ji himself was claiming that he is a voter from Punjab and would get his vote recast there. The Election Commission had also frozen the Draft Electoral Roll. In such a situation, how did Raghav Chadha ji's name get added to the voter list at the same booth in Delhi during SIR? Under what process was this new vote created? The Election Commission must answer."

Musician

under the supervision of senior police officers. The Manipur CM also asked for reinforced security measures across Delhi localities with significant populations of students and working professionals from Manipur and other northeastern states.

Originally from Imphal West district, Singh was the eldest son of Kamla and Chongtham Birendra, a doctor. Kamla, sitting quietly at the family home, told *The Indian Express*, "Vikram (Singh) and his brother Vivek always loved to perform as kids. They always participated in school entertainment events."

Singh began as the lead guitarist of famous Manipur band Ultra Vires formed in the late '80s. He had just finished his Class 10 then. This was a time when rock music was at its peak in the state and Singh immersed himself in the sound. To hone his skills further, he later enrolled at Trinity School of Music in Kolkata, where he studied classical guitar.

He then went on to play with Phoenix (later Phynyx) and then Eastern Dark, remembered for its socially conscious themes. Almost two decades ago, Singh moved to Delhi and began giving lessons in electric guitar. This is when Angom became his student.

"He was a really good guitarist and, as a person, one of the nicest guys you would ever meet. He was always kind, helpful and could really light up a room. It (his death) is a terrible loss," said Angom.

CCTV FOOTAGE SHOWS 'ATTACKERS' LEAVING BUILDING

Musician was threatened earlier by men who killed him, says FIR

Sakshi Chand & Alok Singh
New Delhi, September 8

SOME OF the men who allegedly beat Manipur musician Chongtham Vikram Singh (54) to death on Sunday night had threatened him earlier after he objected to them creating a disturbance near his home, Singh told his son in the taxi while he was being taken to the hospital, according to the FIR lodged into the murder case.

Singh allegedly identified the attackers to his son as men who had come from the dhaba located outside their building, the FIR – registered at Sunlight Colony police station in South Delhi on Monday – added.

The incident took place around 11.30 pm on September 6, when Singh had gone downstairs to dispose of garbage outside his home in Sunlight Colony. Sources in the police said he spotted a group of people, including workers from nearby eateries and food delivery agents, allegedly making noise. He reportedly objected, leading to an argument.

Before he was beaten to death, Singh was allegedly chased and assaulted by eight people in the stair lobby of the building where he lived with his wife and son on the third floor.

Two CCTV camera footages have since emerged. One shows the alleged attackers leaving Singh's building through the staircase at 12.06 am on September 7. Around 10 minutes later, Singh is seen being taken out of the building by his family members to be hospitalised.

According to the FIR, Singh's son, Yaiphaba (20), was inside the house when he heard his father shouting. When he opened the door, he allegedly saw four to five young men beating Singh with kicks and blows. He raised an alarm, following which the men fled.

Yaiphaba told police that he had seen the faces of the men and would be able to identify them if they were brought before him.

Inside the building (top) in Kilokari where the musician lived with his family; spot where the altercation started and the musician (left) being taken to hospital. ABHINAV SAHA

Singh was taken to Holy Family Hospital in New Friends Colony in a taxi, accompanied by Yaiphaba, his wife and a neighbour. It was during this journey that he allegedly told his son that the men who attacked him had come from the dhaba in front of their building. He also said some of them had previously threatened him.

Singh died during treatment at the hospital.

Police have registered a case under Section 103(2) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, which deals with murder by a group of five or more persons acting in concert on specified grounds, and Section 3(5), relating to acts done by persons in furtherance of a common intention.

Seven accused have been arrested. The eight, a juvenile, has also been apprehended.

Four of the accused worked at Saini Dhaba: Bharat Kumar, 19, and Pramod, 26, are food delivery agents; Deepanshu, 21, and Mohan Vishwakarma, 32, work in food packaging.

The other three are Ramzan Khan, 22, a food delivery agent at New Choudhary Dhaba; Vijay, 36, a food delivery agent at Annapurna Dhaba; and Mannu, 26, who works at Diamond Pizza kiosk.

Chased three floors, beaten by eight men: Wife recounts horror

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, September 8

SINCE THE death of Manipur musician Chongtham Vikram Singh, his wife Joshna Chongtham and her 20-year-old son have not returned to their third floor home at Kilokari village in South Delhi.

"The family has not been staying there because of safety concerns," said a relative on Tuesday, two days after the 54-year-old musician was allegedly beaten to death after he objected to a group of men making noise outside his home.

Joshna on Tuesday spoke to mediapersons at Tikendrajit House in Chanakyapuri. Reading from a statement in a low voice, she said, "I have lost my husband, and my son has lost his father."

Recalling that night, Joshna said her husband rushed upstairs to their third floor home, chased by eight men who assaulted him before fleeing.

He complained of breathlessness and was rushed to the emergency room at Holy Family Hospital. "His blood pressure was very low... he died around 6 am," she said.

Joshna thanked those who had supported her family since Vikram's death. She said she hoped that no other family would have to go through what hers was going through and expressed hope that justice would be done.

The killing has shaken Northeast community, which described the incident as an instance of racial violence and raised concerns over the safety of people from the region living in the Capital.

The family, however, did not allege that a racial slur was used or that the assault was racially motivated.

For many in Manipur, Vikram was a familiar name in the state's music scene and is remembered as a pioneer of its rock movement. He was the lead guitarist of Phoenix, a prominent band from the 1980s, and later worked as a music teacher in Delhi.

For a family that had lost a husband and a father barely two days earlier, the brief appearance was also a public appeal: that the circumstances surrounding Vikram's death be investigated and that those responsible face justice.

The body will be flown to Manipur on Wednesday for the final rites.

At the press conference on Tuesday. ABHINAV SAHA

LEADERS REACT

"This incident has once again reopened the painful wounds of atrocities faced by people from the North East in Delhi. Call upon the authorities and Delhi Police to ensure those responsible are dealt with the strictest consequences"

CONRAD SANGMA, MEGHALAYA CHIEF MINISTER, NATIONAL PEOPLE'S PARTY, NDA ALLY

"[Chongtham] father, killed outside his own home, in his own country's capital. After many such incidents, every Northeast family in Delhi is asking the same question today - are we safe here? What are [Amit] Shah's MHA and Delhi Police doing to stop this growing lawlessness?"

RAHUL GANDHI, LEADER OF OPPOSITION IN LOK SABHA

"Forget taking swift and exemplary action against the guilty, often the accused belong to their own party and the entire machinery starts protecting the guilty. A common citizen is now finding himself helpless against their party and government"

ARVIND KEJRIWAL, AAP CHIEF

"The safety and dignity of every person from the Northeast is non-negotiable. I urge the Delhi Police to ensure swift action and a thorough investigation, and that those responsible face the strictest consequences"

JYOTIRADITYA SCINDIA, DEVELOPMENT OF NORTH EASTERN REGION MINISTER

Rakesh Mehta, former chief secy, dies by suicide

Drishti Jain
Noida, September 8

FORMER DELHI Chief Secretary Rakesh Mehta allegedly died by suicide at his residence in Noida on Sunday afternoon, police said. He was 75.

Police said a purported suicide note was found, where Mehta mentioned "prolonged illness" as the reason behind the extreme step.

A 1975-batch IAS officer who served under the Sheila Dixit government, took over as the chief secretary in 2007 and retired in November 2010. Mehta held key posts in the Delhi government, including that of MCD commissioner and DTC chairman.

Police said that Mehta lived alone at his residence in Pocket 6, Kendriya Vihar II, Noida.

"...Members of his family, including his wife and son who lives in Dehradun, tried reaching him ... after their calls went unanswered, they informed the guard. The guard subsequently found Mehta hanging," an officer said.

"He was suffering from hypertension and diabetes," the officer added. He was cremated on Monday.

Mehta was also credited with the execution of some of the key transport, power and civic infrastructure projects in Delhi. The Commonwealth Games in Delhi were organised in 2010 during his tenure.

Greater Noida notice to student over CJP protest, revoked later

Drishti Jain
Noida, September 8

A 20-YEAR-OLD second-year law student at the Gautam Buddha University, who allegedly participated in the CJP protests in July, was served a notice last Friday by the Greater Noida Executive Magistrate seeking a personal bond of Rs 5 lakh to ensure that he will preserve peace. Police on Tuesday said the order was revoked a day later after probing the claims.

This comes days after the Supreme Court on September 1 quashed all the FIRs filed against people who participated in CJP protests between July 20 and 25, except those with criminal antecedents.

The notice, dated September 4, was sent to Akshat Tripathi, who hails from Jhusi in Allahabad and resided in Ecotech-1, under BNSS Section 130 which empowers the Magistrate to pass an order for executing a bond for good behaviour as a preventive measure. This followed proceedings initiated under BNSS Section 126 (for wrongful restraint) and Section 135 (which empowers the Magistrate to conduct an inquiry to ascertain the facts and circumstances under which execution of bond for good behaviour might be necessary).

The notice ordered Tripathi to show cause as to why he should not be bound down to maintain peace for six months by executing a personal bond of Rs 5 lakh and two local, solvent sureties of equal amount.

A hearing was scheduled for September 5. Tripathi denied the allegations. "I haven't gone to the university since the last three months. A two-month holiday began on May 25. Over the last month, our classes shifted to online mode. I was working as an intern at the Allahabad High Court in July. How could I go and provoke people?" he told *The Indian Express*.

CJP's co-convener Saurav Das wrote on X: "Has the DM Gautam Buddha Nagar not read the historic September 1 order of the Supreme Court? All protesters have a permanent blanket immunity from any legal action for their participation in CJP protests..."

THE POWER BEHIND PROGRESS

Excerpts of Chairman's Message at the 40th Annual General Meeting held on 31st August, 2026

Parminder Chopra, CMD

Dear Shareholders,

It gives me immense pleasure to welcome you to the 40th Annual General Meeting of Power Finance Corporation Limited.

As PFC completes four decades of nation building, we do so at a time when India itself is entering a new era of economic growth and infrastructure development.

The nation today stands at the cusp of a historic transformation—one where energy security, economic competitiveness and sustainable development are becoming increasingly interconnected.

India's aspiration of becoming a **Viksit Bharat by 2047** will not only be shaped by the pace of economic growth, but by our ability to build resilient infrastructure and ensure affordable, reliable and 24X7 power for every sector of the economy.

Building the Power Sector of Tomorrow

Over the past decade, India's electricity sector has demonstrated a remarkable progress. Installed generation capacity has more than doubled to over 520 GW, while peak electricity demand has crossed 250 GW, making India one of the world's fastest-growing electricity markets.

Unlike earlier decades, this growth is no longer driven solely by population expansion. It is being propelled by rapid industrialisation, increasing adoption of air conditioning, electric mobility, urbanisation, artificial intelligence, green hydrogen production and the emergence of large-scale data centres.

Four Decades of Nation Building

For forty years, Power Finance Corporation has fulfilled precisely this role.

Established to strengthen India's power sector, PFC has evolved alongside the nation's changing priorities. From financing conventional power generation and transmission projects in its early years to supporting renewable energy, transmission corridors, energy storage, distribution reforms and emerging clean-energy technologies today, PFC has consistently adapted to the evolving needs of the sector while remaining true to its core purpose—to provide long-term financial support for projects that are critical to India's development.

As the nodal agency for the Revamped Distribution Sector Scheme (RDSS), PFC has played a critical role in strengthening the India's distribution sector by enabling investments in smart metering, infrastructure modernisation and operational efficiency. A strong and financially sustainable distribution sector remains the cornerstone of a resilient power system and will be critical to sustaining India's long-term energy security and economic growth.

With four decades of experience, PFC remains uniquely positioned to mobilise long-term capital, develop innovative financing solutions and partner with stakeholders in building India's future power ecosystem.

Delivering Performance with Purpose

Our performance during FY 2025–26 reflects not only strong financial outcomes but also our continued ability to anticipate the evolving needs of the sector and respond with discipline, agility and purpose.

During FY 26, PFC continued to be India's highest profit-making NBFC, while the PFC Group reaffirmed its leadership as India's largest NBFC Group with a consolidated balance sheet of around **₹12 lakh crore**.

Smt. Parminder Chopra, CMD, PFC, along with Mr. Nick McCaffrey, Australia's Deputy High Commissioner to India and Shri K. Balasubramanian, MD, India CEO, Citi exchanging Loan Agreement. Export Finance Australia (EFA), the Australian Government's export credit agency is extending a guarantee to support PFC in raising USD 180 million from Citi.

On a consolidated basis, Profit After Tax increased to **₹33,625 crore**, while standalone Profit After Tax crossed **₹20,000 crore** for the first time, reaching **₹20,051 crore**. Standalone net worth surpassed the landmark **₹1 lakh crore**, significantly enhancing our capacity to finance India's growing infrastructure requirements.

Also, during FY 2025–26, we recorded annual disbursements of approximately **₹1.65 lakh crore**, while our loan assets expanded to **₹5.80 lakh crore**, with **₹90,135 crore**, of renewable book. Even as we grew, we maintained a healthy Capital Adequacy Ratio of **23.44%**, ensuring that our growth continues to be supported by a strong capital base.

The Board has recommended a dividend of **₹18.55 per share**, the highest in the Company's history, reflecting our commitment to delivering sustainable value to our shareholders while preserving financial strength for future growth.

1.09% Gross NPA Ratio

₹5,80,115 crore Loan Assets

0.15% Net NPA Ratio

86% Provisioning maintained on NPA assets (Stage-III)

₹1,65,414 crore Disbursements

₹6,323 crore Assets under advanced stages of resolution (Stage-III Total)

Recognising the increasing importance of sustainable finance, we have continued to strengthen our Environmental, Social and Governance (ESG) framework and integrate sustainability considerations into our financing strategy. Our objective is not merely to finance growth, but to finance growth responsibly, balancing commercial excellence with environmental stewardship and long-term societal impact.

During the year, we also expanded our engagement with leading international development finance institutions, including **Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC)** and **Export Finance Australia (EFA)**, broadening access to diversified sources of long-term capital and reinforcing PFC's standing in global financial market.

These achievements are not merely financial outcomes. They reflect disciplined lending, prudent capital allocation, robust governance and the continued confidence reposed in PFC by borrowers, investors, lenders and other stakeholders.

Building the Institution for India's Next Decade

FY 2025–26 also marked one of the most significant strategic developments in PFC's history.

The proposed merger of REC Limited with PFC represents much more than the coming together of two successful institutions. It is a strategic step towards strengthening India's development finance landscape.

Upon completion, the merged entity will create one of India's largest specialised infrastructure financing institutions, with an aggregate loan book of around **₹12 lakh crore**.

The combined scale will strengthen our ability to mobilise larger pools of domestic and international capital, diversify funding sources and finance increasingly complex infrastructure projects across the evolving value chain.

For borrowers, this will mean stronger and innovative financing capabilities. For investors, it offers enhanced operational efficiencies and long-term value creation. For the nation, it strengthens an institution capable of supporting one of the world's most ambitious energy transition and infrastructure investment programmes.

This is not simply an organisational milestone; it is an opportunity to build an institution that is better equipped to support India's next phase of economic growth.

Smt. Parminder Chopra, CMD (in centre) along with (Standing from L to R) Shri V. Packirisamy, Director (Commercial), Shri Rajesh Kumar Agarwal, Director (Finance), Shri Shashank Misra, Joint Secretary, Ministry of Power and Dr. Sudhir Mehta, Independent Director at the "Investors Meet 2026" held in Mumbai.

Looking Ahead

As we enter our **Fifth Decade**, we do so with a clear conviction: our role is no longer limited to financing power projects. Our responsibility is to help finance India's energy future.

Our priorities remain clear—to strengthen our leadership in power and infrastructure financing, accelerate sustainable and green finance, deepen access to global capital, preserve best-in-class asset quality and continue delivering consistent long-term value to all our stakeholders.

With a strong foundation and deep sectoral expertise, we are confident that PFC will continue to remain India's most trusted finance institution and a key partner in financing the India's journey towards Viksit Bharat 2047.

Acknowledgements

Before I conclude, I extend my sincere gratitude to the Government of India, the Ministry of Power, our regulators, auditors, lenders, investors, customers for their continued trust and partnership. I express my heartfelt gratitude to you, our shareholders, for your continued confidence in PFC.

Together, we will continue financing progress, powering possibilities and shaping the energy future of our nation.

Thank you.

Place : New Delhi
Date : 31.08.2026

(Parminder Chopra)
Chairman & Managing Director

(This does not purport to be a record of the proceedings of the Annual General Meeting held on 31st August, 2026. For full text, please visit : **www.pfcindia.co.in**)

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TWO DAYS AFTER HOSTEL BUILDING COLLAPSE IN SATYA NIKETAN

Panic, evacuations as MCD prepares to demolish first of several buildings

At the site of the incident on Tuesday. The government said dilapidated buildings near the collapsed structure will be demolished. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, September 8

THE FAMILIAR bustle of Satya Niketan had given way to an uneasy stillness by Tuesday night. Shops were shuttered, students were carrying bags and suitcases out of paying guest accommodations, and municipal workers were preparing to take apart a building that until days ago was someone's home and hostel.

Under the lights, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) began removing the water tank and tin roofs of building 13, the first of several structures in the South Delhi locality earmarked for demolition after a five-storey building collapsed on Sunday, killing seven persons, five of them Delhi University (DU) students.

The Delhi government has said "dilapidated buildings" near the collapsed structure will be demolished. Orders to vacate the premises have been issued to three more buildings in Satya Niketan, which is packed with private hostels and PG accommodations catering to students of DU's South Campus colleges.

Building 13 is set to be demolished on the direction of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, who had cited its "dilapidated condition" and said that the action was "in the interest of public safety".

Like the one that collapsed on Sunday, building 13 housed a private hostel. Its students were evacuated on the day of the collapse. Through Tuesday, their belongings, which remained inside, were removed with the help of the Delhi Fire Service and MCD personnel.

An MCD official present at the site said, "The students have vacated building 13 and today, their belongings were removed. The demolition will be conducted in stages and at a very slow pace over the next couple of days. This is necessary since buildings here are located very close to each other."

A man, who runs a grocery shop in a nearby building, has a godown in building 13. On Sunday afternoon, he was asleep in his house above his shop when the crash jolted him awake. He had rushed out after hearing screams. When the dust settled, he saw that the building two properties away from his had collapsed.

His shop was shut on Tuesday. "My shop will remain shut for a week. As my godown is in building 13, I have started moving my stock elsewhere," he said.

Maintaining that while authorities had assured him that his own building was safe, he added, "Since the locality has been sealed, I won't be getting customers anytime soon."

Students, meanwhile, continued to move out of the other PGs on Tuesday.

Tamanna, a second-year undergraduate student at Motilal Nehru College, lives in a PG opposite the collapsed building. "I had felt the tremors when it collapsed. I have been traumatized since then, she said.

Her PG owner, she added, is shifting them to a newly-constructed building two lanes away. "When the building collapsed, the manager told us that this building will also fall soon," she said.

Many, however, have decided to leave Satya Niketan altogether.

"I just want to get out of Satya Niketan," said Atiksha, another second-year student at Motilal Nehru College.

"After the collapse, I couldn't be with myself and I had left in my night clothes to go to my friend's place. I came back today just to collect my clothes, and I will continue living with my friend."

As students left with their belongings from other PGs, a PG owner was seen trying to stop and convince them to shift into his "new building" in the area.

Licences, registration, listing on a public portal: Govt drafts Bill to regulate PGs

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, September 8

EVERY BUILDING offering paying guest (PG) accommodation must obtain, within 90 days, a licence from the municipal zonal authority, clearance from the local police, and a No-Objection Certificate (NOC) with regard to structural and fire safety from the Municipal Corporation of Delhi and the regional administration, the Delhi government has proposed in a draft Bill to regulate such establishments.

Each establishment will have a unique registration number, and will be listed on a public portal, says the draft regulation and welfare Bill for private hostels and PGs.

Seven people, including five students, were killed after a five-storey private hostel collapsed in Satya Niketan near Delhi University's South Campus on Sunday. Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu chaired a meeting with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and top officials on Monday to review building safety, student accommodation, and PG regulations.

Thousands of students from around the country come to Delhi every year to study or attend coaching classes. An estimated 2 lakh rooms are rented out as private hostel or PG accommodation in areas such as Mukherjee Nagar, Rajendra Nagar, Laxmi Nagar, Munirka, and areas around North and South Campus, but police, the Fire Department, or MCD have no records of these buildings, their owners or tenants.

"With the growing influx of students, privately operated PG accommodations have become a primary housing option... The absence of a formal integrated regulatory framework has led to...arbitrary rent practices, substandard living conditions, inadequate safety provisions, and...lack of an effective grievance redressal mechanism for students," the draft Bill says.

Students continued to move out of hostels and PGs in the area; (top) a barricaded lane near the collapse site, Tuesday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Work on the Bill is ongoing, and its provisions will be finalised in the next two months, Delhi Education Minister Ashish Sood, who is also the chairman of the committee formed to draw up the PG regulation Bill, told *The Indian Express* on Tuesday.

The draft has proposed a dedicated online portal ("GovPG") with details of all registered PGs to serve as a one-stop hub for information and complaints.

"Each PG must post its details and monthly updates (occupancy, rent changes, audit dates)... Students can use the portal to file complaints (anonymously). Core features include PG contact details, verification of PG registration and capacity certificates, submission of grievances, and tracking complaint status," says the draft.

"If a grievance is lodged, the portal will notify the relevant Zone Authority and institutional accommodations committee," it says.

Each college, university, and registered coaching institute will be required to set up an "Institutional Accommodation Committee" comprising two faculty members, two elected student-union representatives with at least one female member, a representative of the NSS or NCC, a ward-level municipal official, and a police liaison officer.

"Every registered PG accommodation must install functional CCTV cameras at all entrances and common areas, with footage retained for a minimum of 30 days. ...Accommodations housing 15+ students are additionally required to employ a licensed security guard during night hours...," the draft says.

"Every PG must also designate a Warden who resides or maintains an office within 500 metres..., remains reachable at all times on a dedicated contact number, and is physically available within 15 minutes of any emergency call," officials said.

Hostel operator paid owner Rs 1 lakh per month: Police probe

Alok Singh
New Delhi, September 8

THE INVESTIGATION into the collapse of a five-storey building in South West Delhi's Satya Niketan has now widened, with the role of the contractor and operator of Hostel Daze, a hostel facility, having come under scanner following the arrest of the property owners, police said. *The Indian Express* has learnt that the operator had taken the building on a lease of Rs 1 lakh per month in August last year and had rented out rooms to students.

On Tuesday, police arrested the contractor, Sanoj, from Uttar Pradesh's Kasganj. They said he was allegedly carrying out repair and construction work in the basement and on the ground floor of the building despite knowing that the building was "weak".

According to the police, even on the day of the incident, repair work was underway in the basement to address waterlogging and seepage issues, while a shop on the ground floor was being extended.

"There was a high chance that the building did not have adequate support and due to the works which were being carried out in the basement and on the ground floor, it might have collapsed," an officer said.

Sources said that the police are probing the role of the hostel operator, identified as Sudhanshu, who was allegedly running around seven such facilities in the vicinity under the banner of Hostel Daze. "Sudhanshu is currently missing. A few workers and his associates have been questioned. His role is being examined," a police officer said.

Building owner Hariram Gupta (81), his wife Urmila Gupta (75) and their son Mahesh Gupta (52) were on Monday arrested in connection with the case. Meanwhile, during questioning, Mahesh, who is currently in police custody, allegedly told investigators that he used to oversee the maintenance of the building on behalf of his parents.

Mahesh also told investigators that repair work was being carried out in the basement as waste had accumulated owing to the monsoon showers. Repair and extension work were also allegedly underway on the ground floor which was used for commercial purposes.

The upper floors had two rooms each. According to police sources, 16 students thus lived in the eight rooms that the building housed.

According to the police, Mahesh said that on the day of the incident, the family learnt about the collapse from local residents and subsequently left their home and went to his in-laws' house in Bhiwadi, Rajasthan.

Police have registered an FIR under BNS sections 105, 290 and 125(a) which pertain to culpable homicide not amounting to murder, negligent conduct in connection with construction or repair of buildings, and acts endangering life or personal safety. The case was registered based on the complaint of an Assistant Sub-Inspector-rank officer.

According to police record, the incident took place around 1 pm, while a PCR call was received around 1.34 pm. The caller, according to the FIR, stated that a building which was home to young people had collapsed.

The FIR also mentions that when police teams reached the spot, the entire structure had collapsed.

It further states that the building was several years old. "During the preliminary local enquiry, police were informed that the owners had allegedly constructed additional floors and that further construction work was underway," the FIR stated.

The FIR further also highlights that the owner, Hariram, was aware that the building's foundation could not safely bear the additional weight that was being put on it, but went ahead to earn money despite the potential risk to the occupants.

Debris at the site on Tuesday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

PIL in High Court seeks hostel policy for Capital

ANOTHER PUBLIC interest litigation (PIL) has been filed in the Delhi High Court after the Satya Niketan hostel collapse that left seven people dead, seeking directions to the Delhi government to formulate and implement a time-bound hostel development policy and to Delhi University to provide hostel facilities in each of its colleges.

The PIL, filed by National Students' Union of India (NSUI) national president Vinod Jakhar, was mentioned for urgent listing on Tuesday.

The court, however, declined to list it urgently. **SOHINI GHOSH**

● THE INDIA HABITAT THEATRE FESTIVAL RETURNS FROM SEPTEMBER 18 TO 27, BRINGING NINE MAINSTAGE PRODUCTIONS AND THREE ADDITIONAL PERFORMANCES

At IHC, a festival where life, memory & loss take centre stage

Anusree K C
New Delhi, September 8

ON A theatre stage, a single father and his neurodivergent son try to find their way through a world that does not quite understand them. Elsewhere, a Shakespearean actor loses his grip on memory, slowly surrendering to dementia.

For 10 days this September, the Stein Auditorium at India Habitat Centre (IHC) will become a space for such encounters. The India Habitat Theatre Festival 2026 returns from September 18 to 27, bringing nine mainstage productions and three additional contemporary theatrical productions in Hindi, English, Tamil and Punjabi to the Capital.

Prof Dr K G Suresh, Director of IHC, calls this year's festival "more humane than ever". "It talks about life, death and in between. These aspects are blended and shaped in art and movement," he says.

The festival opens with *Dancing With Dad*, written and directed by Maneesh Verma. At its heart are Noor, a neurodivergent boy, and his single father, a contemporary dancer. Together, they "try to navigate the world which is not ready for them".

For Verma, the story began years ago, when he was studying acting at the National School of Drama, Delhi. "One of my seniors, Itzik Weingarten, an Israeli actor, had performed a play, where a 40-year-old neurodivergent man recalls his relationship with his father. I was moved to tears... Since then the idea to work on something similar has been on my mind," he says.

Dancing With Dad by Maneesh Verma; (left) *The Tragedy of Ham MacLear*, written and directed by Akash Khurana.

Verma has now returned to that memory, rewriting the idea as an interdisciplinary production combining theatre, live music and dance – all blending together, to tell a story. "The whole attempt is to really try and make the audience feel what the world of a neurodivergent feels like," he says.

On September 23, the festival will witness *The Tragedy of Ham MacLear*, a play written and directed by Akash Khurana. Ham, a passionate Shakespeare veteran, is struggling with dementia. His long-time companions, Busker and Chorus, must find a way to honour the actor and his legacy while ensuring his well-being.

"This play is not merely about the person who goes through dementia but also the people around him who actually have a bigger challenge in terms of being his caregivers," says Khurana.

Cilappatikaram/The Anklet's Verdict, directed by Sooraj Nambiar, brings Ilango Adigal's ancient Tamil epic into the meditative vocabulary of Kutiyattam. *Bhasabharatam*, directed by Piyal Bhattacharya, revisits the timeless plays of Bhasa through the oral traditions of Charan and Bhatta. The programme also includes *Breast of Luck*, *Amb Da Boota* and *The Queen*.

Further, the festival will feature three other performances – *Maaye Ni Meri Akh Lag Gaya*, *Home in a Suitcase* and *Hindi Medium Tight*.

"The curation of this year's festival has been guided by the idea of presenting a programme that is varied, engaging and representative of the many ways in which theatre is being imagined today. We have looked at the diversity of stories, languages, theatrical forms and perspectives while putting the programme together," says Syed Shadab Hussain, Head of Programmes, IHC.

HC seeks govt reply on rabies elimination plan

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, September 8

THE DELHI High Court on Tuesday instructed the government to file its reply detailing the steps it will take to eliminate rabies from stray dogs by 2030.

A division bench of Justices Dinesh Mehta and Rajnish Kumar Gupta sought the response as suggested by the amicus curiae in the case, animal welfare activist Gauri Maulekhi. Granting four weeks to the government to file its response, the HC said: "The counsel appearing for GNCTD ... is granted four weeks time to obtain instructions and file a response to the action plan and suggestions and recommendations made by the amicus curiae."

The division bench was hearing a suo motu PIL that it has registered to monitor compliance with the Supreme Court's directions issued in May to all high courts to register suo motu continuing proceedings to monitor the implementation of its directions with respect to managing strays and dog attacks.

The top court had directed every district in India to establish at least one functional animal birth control centre and had asked states and UTs to expand infrastructure. The Delhi HC had in August directed the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) and North Delhi Municipal Corporation (NDMC) to identify one ward each and organise camps for sterilisation and vaccination of stray dogs on pilot basis. On Tuesday, the court directed the MCD and NDMC to file status reports with respect to its direction.

DELHI CONFIDENTIAL

Cong UPheaval

THERE IS a growing buzz in Lucknow and Delhi that Congress's Uttar Pradesh unit president Ajay Rai could be replaced in next couple of days. Sources in Delhi said the party high command is not happy with Rai, who has been having differences with the newly appointed AICC in-charge for UP, Rajendra Pal Gautam. Insiders say Rai could be replaced by MLA Aradhana Mishra Mona who is a senior Congress leader and party MP Pramod Tiwari's daughter.

Youth Connect

AMID THE government's renewed focus on youth outreach, the Railways celebrated the completion of the Western Dedicated Freight Corridor with a new look and feel, in tune with the taste of the younger audience. While the bookings for the event were done through an online platform, a grand entry was planned for PM Narendra Modi via a ramp amid rows of cheering crowds, upbeat music, moving visuals on LED screens and ambient lighting. The message was for the Gen Z that the country's infrastructure story can also have modern vibes, the organisers said.

Tuesday Tryst

HOPING TO continue what he termed was his "auspicious connection" with the day, BJP Rajya Sabha MP Dinesh Sharma has chosen next Tuesday for his oath-taking ceremony as the new L-G of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands. During a brief visit to the BJP headquarters in the Capital on Tuesday, the former Uttar Pradesh Dy CM said the "most auspicious events of his life", whether as an academician or a politician, had happened on Tuesdays. Sharma was appointed the UT's new L-G on Sunday.

ED asks police in Keralam to file FIR against Pinarayi, daughter

Wants Prevention of Corruption Act to be invoked; not afraid of probe, will fight legally and politically: Ex-minister Riyas

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, September 8

THE ENFORCEMENT Directorate has asked the police in Keralam to register an FIR against former CM Pinarayi Vijayan, his daughter T Veena, son-in-law Mohammed Riyas and others under the Prevention of Corruption Act in connection with a money laundering case allegedly involving Veena's IT firm.

"ED has sent a detailed report to the state DGP on the Cochin Minerals and Rutile Limited case and sought registration of a separate FIR," sources from the central investigative agency said.

Vijayan is currently the Leader of Opposition and Riyas, a former minister, is a CPI(M) legislator. A final call on the FIR will be taken by the state police, which comes under the Home Department headed by Congress leader Ramesh Chennithala.

The ED has alleged that payments were made by Kochi-based CMRL to Veena's IT firm Exalogic Solutions without providing any services. The alleged illegal payments, made during Vijayan's first term, were unearthed by the Income Tax Department.

The ED had earlier alleged that Exalogic Solutions, owned by Veena, received Rs 2.78 crore from CMRL in the guise of IT consultancy payments. ED had searched Vijayan's premises in May. The agency also conducted searches on eight premises linked to local CPI(M) leaders in Kozhikode district, where Riyas hails from.

State police chief Ravada Chandrasekhar said they have received the ED report. "We have to examine the report before taking any action. There are issues which need more clarity. The report has been forwarded to the Home Secretary," he said.

Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala said, "Let the Home Secretary examine the report. Once he forwards the report along with his recommendation, the government will examine the matter and take a decision in consultation with the chief minister."

Congress state president Sunny Joseph said, "I hope the police will act as there is evidence for a preliminary probe."

CPI(M) leader Muhammed Riyas, who also figured in the ED report to the state police, said, "We are not afraid of any probe. The script is good. The innocent will remain innocent, irrespective of probes at any level. The issue will be fought legally and politically."

As per the ED report to the police, Vijayan allegedly collected Rs 3.28 crore from CMRL as a bribe through Veena. To substantiate this claim, the ED quoted an admission by the former chief financial officer of CMRL. The ED claims that Riyas helped transfer the bribe money to Dubai through Veena and others.

The ED has also sought registration of an FIR against senior employees of Exlogic Solutions.

"Several statements and digital evidence relating to the transfer of money through hawala routes were seized. Veena has been handling money beyond her known sources of income. The amounts stated in her handwritten accounts were over and above the amounts received from CMRL. The amount transferred to Dubai as per notings is 3.49 lakh UAE Dirhams (equivalent to Rs 85 lakh). The amount maintained for Indian rupees is about Rs 20.05 crore," the ED had earlier claimed.

Last month, Vijayan had said, "My hands are clean, and I have full confidence that neither my daughter nor any of my family members have engaged in any hawala dealings."

Questioning ED's claim regarding hawala transactions, Vijayan said, "Veena was facing unusual actions on the ground that she is my daughter. She does not have huge wealth. She had cooperated with the probe and will continue to do so."

India, China Corps Commander talks went on for two days: MEA

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, September 8

INDIA AND China held Corps Commander-level military talks in the eastern sector on Sunday and Monday, the Ministry of External Affairs said Tuesday. The meeting took place amid ongoing tensions in the Taksing area of the Upper Subansiri district of Arunachal Pradesh.

The first Senior Highest Military Commander-Level Flag Meeting was held on two consecutive days at Wacha on the Indian side in Arunachal Pradesh and Damai on the Chinese side on Sunday (September 6) and Monday (September 7), respectively, official spokesperson for Ministry of External Affairs, Randhir Jaiswal, said at a press conference. He added that a similar mechanism also exists in the Western Sector.

This mechanism has existed in eastern Ladakh since 2020 to resolve the military standoff between India and China along the LAC. India and China have held 23 rounds of Corps Commander-level meetings at the Chushul-Moldo border meeting point in eastern Ladakh to resolve issues related to the military standoff along the LAC.

Jaiswal said the meeting took place pursuant to the understandings reached between the Special Representatives of India and China in August 2025 and August 2026, and subsequent discussions at Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination (WMCC) meetings in Beijing and New Delhi in May and August 2026, respectively.

Lt General Girish Kalia, commander of the Army's III Corps, also called the Spear Corps, headquartered at Rangapahar near Dimapur in Nagaland, met his Chinese counterpart along with other officers for talks. These talks follow a meeting in Beijing on August 25 between NSA Ajit Doval and Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi, the Special Representatives of the respective countries for boundary talks. This comes ahead of Chinese President Xi Jinping's likely visit to India for the BRICS Summit on September 12-13.

Ladakh LG Saxena gets additional charge of J&K

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, Leh, September 8

LADAKH LIEUTENANT Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena was given additional charge of J&K Tuesday during the "absence, on leave" of incumbent Manoj Sinha, with Saxena's new assignment beginning with administering the oath of office to new Chief Justice of the high court.

This is for the first time since Ladakh became a UT in August 2019 that an LG of the region will administer the oath of office to the Chief Justice of J&K and Ladakh High Court. Officials said Sinha is currently in the US and addressed IIT (BHU) Global Alumni Meet in Chicago Monday.

"The President of India is pleased to appoint Shri Vinai Kumar Saxena, Lt. Governor of Ladakh to discharge the functions of the Lt. Governor of Jammu and Kashmir, in addition to his own duties, during the absence, on leave, of Shri Manoj Sinha, Lt. Governor of Jammu and Kashmir," a communique issued by the Rashtrapati Bhavan said on Tuesday.

In Patna, protest march seeking hike in quota runs into police barricades; seven detained

Santosh Singh
Patna, September 8

HUNDREDS OF protesters from Scheduled Caste and OBC organisations took out a protest march in Patna on Tuesday, demanding that the state government implement a 65% reservation quota instead of the existing 50%. Police detained seven protesters and later released them.

The protesters have been demanding implementation of the enhanced 65% quota, which was declared "unconstitutional" by the Patna High Court in 2024. Supreme Court later refused to stay the HC order.

Protest in Patna on Tuesday. ANI

The protest, held under the banner of the Aarakshan Badhao Samvidhan Bachao Sangharsh Samiti, was led by Dalit rights activist Amar Paswan Azad. Bihar government, under former CM Nitish Kumar, had raised the reservation ceiling to 65% following the Bihar Caste-based Survey report of 2022-23.

At present, the Bihar government provides 16% reservation to SCs, 1% to STs, 18% to Extremely Backward Classes, 12% to OBCs and 3% to Backward Class women.

Bihar Police deployed personnel from more than 20 police stations. The protest march, which began at Gandhi Maidan and was headed towards Raj Bhavan, was stopped at Dak Bungalow Chowk, where police erected makeshift iron gates and barriers to prevent the protesters from moving ahead.

Azad said, "We have two main demands: putting the 65% quota decision of the Bihar government in the Ninth Schedule of the Constitution to give it legal immunity, and introducing reservation in the private sector to realise the goal of an inclusive society."

Two BRS MLCs arrested over 'derogatory' remarks, released

Nikhila Henry
Hyderabad, September 8

TELANGANA POLICE on Tuesday arrested BRS MLCs Tata Madhusudan, also known as Tata Madhu, and Naveen Kumar Reddy for allegedly making derogatory remarks against Speaker Gaddam Prasad Kumar. Later in the day, both were released on personal surety or bond later in the day.

Madhusudan and Naveen Reddy were also suspended for the remainder of the Monsoon session in the Council. A resolution to this effect was moved by Minister D Sridhar Babu. The two MLCs were booked under the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act Monday, following complaints over their remarks against the Speaker.

NPCL NOIDA POWER COMPANY LIMITED
CIN: U31200UP1992PLC014506

Notice Inviting Bids for Procurement of 300 MW RE-RTC Power on Long Term Basis from Grid Connected Projects

Bids are invited by "Noida Power Company Limited having its registered office at Electric Sub-station, Knowledge Park-IV, Greater Noida – 201310 (U.P.)" for procurement of 300 MW Round-the-Clock Renewable Power (RE-RTC) on Long Term basis for 25 (twenty-five) years in accordance with the Guidelines for procurement of Firm & Dispatchable RE Power issued by Ministry of Power, GOI dated 09.06.2023 and its subsequent amendments thereof. Bid Document is available on www.bharat-electronictender.com.
The Company reserves the right to reject all or any of the Bids or cancel the bidding process at any stage without assigning any reasons whatsoever and without any liability.
For any clarification, contact at e-mail id Powertradingnpcl@rpsg.in or mobile no. 9718804966.

Head (Power Management Services)

उत्तर प्रदेश आवास एवं विकास परिषद
कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता मेरठ
ऑफिस कॉम्पलैक्स, सैक्टर-9 शास्त्री नगर, मेरठ

पत्रांक- 2720/ अधी0अभि0 / मेरठ / जी-12 / 74 दिनांक:- 08.09.2026

ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

अधोहस्ताक्षरकर्ता द्वारा परिषद की ओर से उ0 प्र0 आवास एवं विकास परिषद में अर्ह श्रेणी/ग्रुप में पंजीकृत अनुभवी ठेकेदारों / फर्मो से टू-बिड पद्धति पर अवस्थापना निधि के अन्तर्गत योजना सं0-11 जागृति विहार (विस्तार) मेरठ, योजना सं0-10 माधवपुरम मेरठ, मंगल पाण्डे नगर मेरठ, मोहनपुरी मेरठ व शास्त्रीनगर मेरठ में विभिन्न कार्यों तथा शहर में विभिन्न चिन्हित स्थलों पर थीम वॉल पेन्टिंग कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा आमन्त्रित की जाती हैं। विस्तृत नियम व शर्ते परिषद की वैबसाईट www.upavp.in पर देखी जा सकती हैं।

अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

ANDHRA PRADESH STATE CIVIL SUPPLIES CORPORATION LTD.,
(A STATE GOVERNMENT UNDER TAKING)
HEAD OFFICE, Sri Sai Towers, Door No.10-152/1, 4th & 5th Floor, Ashok Nagar, Besides Siris Company, Bandaru Road, Kanuru, Vijayawada-520007.

Lr.No. Proc./ M2/ PADDY/ KMS-2025-26 Date: 08-09-2026

TENDER NOTICE

APPOINTMENT OF REVENUE DISTRICT WISE PADDY TRANSPORT CONTRACTORS FOR TRANSPORTATION OF PADDY FROM PPCs AT RSKs TO RICE MILLS/GODOWNS WITHIN AND OUTSIDE THE DISTRICTS FOR KMS 2026-27 & 2027-28 UNDER ZONE I, II & III THROUGH NCDEX E MARKETS LIMITED (NeML) AUCTION PLATFORM IN ANDHRA PRADESH.
Those who are interested to participate in tender should be registered with NCDEX e-Markets Ltd. on their website **www.neml.in** and can contact the Customer Service Group on **phone numbers (+91-22) - 48810500/ 9962059599/ 9032429420** or **email: askus@neml.in** . Last date for online registration and completion of formalities for submitting the online tenders shall be up to **22.09.2026 by 5.00 PM IST.** For complete details and to download tender documents at free of cost visit **www.apscscl.in** and **www.neml.in** .

Sd/- VC & MANAGING DIRECTOR

रानी लक्ष्मी बाई केंद्रीय कृषि विश्वविद्यालय, झाँसी
Rani Lakshmi Bai Central Agricultural University, Jhansi
ग्वालियर रोड, झाँसी–284003 (उत्तर प्रदेश)
Gwalior Road, Jhansi -284003 (U.P.)

Advertisement No: RLBCAU/6/2026 Dated: 7.09.2026

स्नातक पाठ्यक्रमों में प्रवेश के लिए आवेदन

विश्वविद्यालय के विभिन्न स्नातक पाठ्यक्रमों में प्रवेश के लिए संबंधित श्रेणियों के तहत रिक्त सीटों के लिए प्रवेश लेने के इच्छुक पात्र एवं वैध आईसीएआर रैंक कार्ड–2026 धारक उम्मीदवारों से (प्रवेश शैक्षणिक सत्र 2026–27 के लिए) आवेदन आमंत्रित किए जाते हैं. अधिक जानकारी के लिए कृपया विश्वविद्यालय की वेबसाइट **www.rlbcau.ac.in** देखें। पंजीकरण 08.09.2026, सुबह 10.00 बजे से 12.09.2026 सायं 05.00 बजे तक होगा। प्रवेशित छात्रों को कोई एनटीएस / विश्वविद्यालय फैलोशिप प्रदान नहीं की जाएगी।

Application for Admission in UG courses

Applications are invited from eligible and valid ICAR rank card-2026 holder candidates desirous of taking admission on vacant seats under the respective categories for admission to various UG courses of University (Admission Academic Session 2026-27). Kindly see the university's website **www.rlbcau.ac.in** for more information. Registration will start from 08.09.2026, 10.00 A.M. to 12.09.2026 till 05.00 P.M., no NTS / University Fellowship will be awarded to the admitted students.

कुलसचिव / **Registrar**

Government of Maharashtra
Forest Department
Mangrove Division - North Konkan
Abhimaan II 5th Floor, Teen Haat Naka, Naupada, Thane (W)- 400 602
Email- dfommcu@gmail.com
Parent Portal: http://mahatenders.gov.in

E-Tender

Online Tender Forms in B-1 Format, for the following work are invited by the Divisional Forest Officer, Mangrove Division- North Konkan, Abhimaan II, Floor, Teen Heat Naka, Naupada, Thane (W)-400 602 from the contractors registered with the Government of Maharashtra in appropriate class of Tender Notice.

The blank tender documents should be downloaded from Government website http://mahatenders.gov.in from 09.09.2026 at 05.00 pm to 16.09.2026 at 05.00 pm. Blank Tender documents will not be sold by this office interested contractors have to download tender documents from the website. For any queries in this regard the interested contractors can contact on telephone no 022-69309286 during office hours.

All requisite information required for the submission of Bid Capacity documents is available on the above said website. If any assistance is required regarding eTendering (uploading/downloading) please contact NIC Help Desk number: 1800 3070 2232.

Sr. No.	Name of work Tender	Tender Notice No.	Tender cost. (Rs.)	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs)	Time limit	Cost of Blank Tender Form (Non - Refundable)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	Construction of RCC Compound Wall in the premisses of Manda Society, Sector- 9 at Charkop in Survey No.41(CTS No. 3A/1) In. Borivali Beat in West Mumbai Range of MDNK.	DFO/ MDNK/ WM/03/ 2026-27	83,07,583/-	83,076/-	4 Months	Rs. 1180/- (Including GST)
2	Construction of RCC Compound Wall On Malwani-Marve Road at Malwani in CTS 1601 in Malwani Beat in Borivali Round in West Mumbai Range of MDNK.	DFO/ MDNK/ WM/O5/ 2026-27	82,55,687/-	82,557/-	4 Months	Rs. 1180/- (Including GST)
3	Construction of RCC Compound Wall On Malwani Marve Road at Malwani in CTS No. 02 in Malwani Beat in Borivali Round in West Mumbai Range of MDNK.	DFO/ MDNK/ WM/O6/ 2026-27	83,24,367/-	83,243/-	4 Months	Rs. 1180/- (Including GST)
4.	Construction of RCC Compound Wall for Malwani-Ambujawadi Aadava patta in CTS no. 2841 in Malwani Beat in Borivali Round in West Mumbai Range of MDNK.	DFO/ MDNK/ WM/O7/ 2026-27	81,35,383/-	81,353/-	4 Months	Rs. 1180/- (Including GST)
5.	Construction of RCC Compound Wall for Ma1wani Ambujawadi Ubha Patta in CTS no. 2841 in Malwani Beat in Borivali Round in West Mumbai Range of MDNK	DFO/ MDNK/ WM/O8/ 2026-27	50,50,746/-	50,508/-	4 Months	Rs. 1180/- (Including GST)
6.	Construction of RCC Compound Wall for Back Side of Mahada Colony at Malwani-Ambujawadi Gate no. 8 in Survey No.263 (N. Bhu. no. 2841) in Malwani Beat in West Mumbai Range of MDNK.	DFO/ MDNK/ WM/O9/ 2026-27	83,13,498/-	83,134/-	4 Months	Rs. 1180/- (Including GST)

1) No changes are to be made by the contractor in he tender documents published on the website. If any changes are made the tender documents will be rejected & action accordingly will be taken against the contractor. information published on the government website will be final.
2) Right to reject any or all the tenders without assigning any reason there of is reserved.

Sd/-
Divisional Forest Officer,
Mangrove Division North Konkan.

DGIPR/2026-27/2711

MP INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED
(Government of Madhya Pradesh Undertaking)
SECRETARIAT FOR SINGLE WINDOW SYSTEM
21, Arera Hills, Bhopal-462011, M.P. (India), Tel. : (91) 755-2571830, 2575618, 3523555, 3523505
E-mail : helpdesk@mpidc.co.in, Website : www.invest.mp.gov.in, CIN: U51102MP1977SGC001392
MPIDC/CE/Tech-RFP/2026/281, 282 and 283 Date: 08.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Madhya Pradesh Industrial development Corporation Ltd. (MPIDC Ltd.) invites online percentage rate bids for the following work from registered contractors and firms for the following work :

NIT No.	Name of Work	District	Probable Amount of Contract (in Rs. Cr.)
281	Construction of Road from Kolar Main Road to Gourav Nagar Tiraha & Gourav Nagar Tiraha to Tehsil Road Tiraha , district Bhopal	Bhopal	9.62
282	Construction of Road from Gourav Nagar Tiraha to Bridge and Bridge to Satgarhi 45m wide Road, district Bhopal	Bhopal	6.82
283	Construction of slab Culvert & Retaining Wall, district Bhopal	Bhopal	10.13

The Tender documents can be downloaded from the e-procurement **Portal- https://mptenders.gov.in – MPIDC HO** shortly.
M.P. Madhyam/127942/2026 I/C CHIEF ENGINEER

GOVT. OF BIHAR
BIHAR COMBINED ENTRANCE COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION BOARD
I.A.S. Association Building, Near Patna Airport, Patna-14.
Website : bceceboard.bihar.gov.in / Helpdesk : helpdesk.bceceboard@bihar.gov.in

UGMAC-2024 एवं UGMAC-2025 के Security Deposit की राशि Refund से सम्बन्धित आवश्यक सूचना

Adv. No.- BCECEB-2026/03 Dated 08.09.2026

UGMAC-2024 / UGMAC-2025 से सम्बन्धित सभी अभ्यर्थियों / सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि वैसे सभी अभ्यर्थी जिन्होंने उपरोक्त दोनों के Online Counselling के माध्यम से सीट आवंटन हेतु Security Deposit की राशि जमा किया है तथा सीट आवंटन उपरांत नामांकन ले लिये हैं अथवा उन्हें सीट आवंटन हुआ ही नहीं है, वैसे अभ्यर्थियों को विवरण-पुस्तिका के अनुसार Security Deposit की राशि Online माध्यम से उनके उसी खाता तथा उसी Transaction mode के माध्यम से Refund किया जा चुका है, परन्तु कतिपय कारणों से कुछ अभ्यर्थियों का Security Deposit की राशि Refund नहीं हो पा रहा है। वैसे सभी अभ्यर्थी, जिनका Security Deposit की राशि refund नहीं हो पाया है, उनकी सूची "UGMAC-2024 Annexure-A" एवं "UGMAC-2025 Annexure-B" इस विज्ञापन के साथ पर्षद के website पर उपलब्ध करायी जा रही है।

उपरोक्त सूची में सम्मिलित अभ्यर्थियों को पर्षद के Helpdesk email ID: **helpdesk.bceceboard@bihar.gov.in** द्वारा Refund करने हेतु अपना Bank Account details भेजने हेतु बार-बार सूचित किया गया है। परंतु उपरोक्त सूची में सम्मिलित अभ्यर्थी द्वारा अभी तक अपना **या** अपने पिता **या** माता का Bank Account details उपलब्ध नहीं कराया गया है, जिसके कारण Refund pending है। पर्षद द्वारा उक्त अभ्यर्थियों को एक और मौका दिया जा रहा है कि अभ्यर्थी, अपना **या** अपने पिता **या** माता का Account details के साथ सम्बन्धित Passbook / Cancelled Cheque तथा Online Application Form की Hard Copy (Confirmation Page) जिस पर Transaction details अंकित है, की Scanned copy को **पर्षद के Helpdesk email ID: helpdesk.bceceboard@bihar.gov.in पर अपने आवेदन में भरे गये email ID से दिनांक 22.09.2026 तक निश्चित रूप से भेज दें ताकि Security Money की राशि Refund किया जा सके। यह अनिवार्य है।** किसी अन्य email ID से भेजे गये अनुरोध स्वीकार्य नहीं होंगे।

परीक्षा नियंत्रक

NPCL NOIDA POWER COMPANY LIMITED
CIN: U31200UP1992PLC014506

Notice Inviting Bids for Procurement of Thermal Power on Long Term basis

Bids are invited by "Noida Power Company Limited having its registered office at Electric Sub-station, Knowledge Park-IV, Greater Noida – 201310 (U.P.)" for procurement of 100 MW power from 01.04.2028 onwards for 15 years in accordance with the Guidelines for procurement of thermal power dated 06.03.2019 issued by Ministry of Power, GOI and its subsequent amendments thereof. Bid Document is available on DEEP Portal of www.mstcecommerce.com.
The Company reserves the right to reject all or any of the Bids or cancel the bidding process at any stage without assigning any reasons whatsoever and without any liability.
For any clarification, contact at e-mail id Powertradingnpcl@rpsg.in or mobile no. 9718804966.

Head (Power Management Services)

SECURITY PRINTING AND MINTING CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
(WHOLLY OWNED BY GOVT. OF INDIA)
Mini-Ratna Category-I CPSE
3rd Floor, Tower-G, World Trade Centre, Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi - 110029.
E-mail - recruitmentcell@spmcil.com, Website: www.spmcil.com

Extension of Last Date of receipt of Applications against Advt. No. 05/2026

With reference to the Advertisement No. 05/2026 for posting in Vigilance Department of SPMCIL on deputation basis published on 08.08.2026, it is hereby informed that the last date for receipt of applications through proper channel against the aforesaid advertisement has been extended up to **29.09.2026 (Tuesday).**
All other terms and conditions of Advertisement No. 05/2026 shall remain unchanged.

Sd/-
Jt. General Manager (HR)

EXPRESS Careers

Advertisement No. 96/2026
Government of India
Public Enterprises Selection Board
invites online applications for the post of
Director (Personnel & Administration)
in
The Shipping Corporation of India Limited
Last date of submission of online application by the applicant is by 15:00 hours on **29/09/2026**
Last date of forwarding of applications by the Nodal officers on online system of PESB is by 17:00 hours on **08/10/2026**
For details login to website
https://www.pesb.gov.in
Link for registration of Nodal Officers / Competent Authorities is available on PESB website.

YouTuber held in Saharanpur for 'breach of peace'

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, September 8

A 34-YEAR-OLD YouTuber and journalist was arrested in Saharanpur on Monday for "breach of peace" after she created a ruckus at the Circuit House, police said on Tuesday.

Police, meanwhile, lodged another FIR against Huda Zariwala for allegedly posting objectionable content on social media following the demolition of a mosque within the Saharanpur Collectorate premises.

"We have arrested Huda Zariwala on charges of breach of peace for creating a nuisance at the Circuit House. She was produced before the court, which sent her to judicial custody," Superintendent of Police, Saharanpur, Vyom Bindal said.

According to the police, Zariwala was stopped from entering the Circuit House by woman police personnel during the visit of Leader of Opposition Lal Bihari Yadav. "The woman (Zariwala) created disturbance and behaved aggressively, despite the female officers present at the spot trying to convince her that she was not permitted to go further," said a police officer.

It is alleged that Zariwala wanted to accompany the Samajwadi Party delegation to the site of the demolished mosque.

Police subsequently arrested Zariwala under Section 170 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (arrest to prevent the commission of a cognizable offence).

TOWER REOPENS, PARIS MAYOR ORDERS PROBE

Eiffel Tower women staff 'sidelined': BAPS apologises, MEA steers clear

Divya A & Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, September 8

THE ICONIC Eiffel Tower was closed on Monday after women workers were asked to "limit interactions" during a visit by a Hindu religious delegation at the weekend, prompting a staff protest and an investigation by Paris city authorities.

On Saturday, a delegation linked to the Bochasanwasi Akshar Purushottam Swaminarayan Sanstha (BAPS) made a private visit to the Eiffel Tower.

In a statement, the local trade union condemned "workplace instructions that led to female employees being sidelined, replaced and rendered invisible on the basis of their gender", according to the French media.

"Some were asked to leave their posts and withdraw to other areas. In some posts they were replaced by men. And all female employees were instructed not to go through or cross certain areas while the delegation was present," according to the statement quoted by French media.

Union representative Diane Davoine said, "Women were asked to leave their workstations so that men could take their places."

"That absolutely does not go down well with the employees, with women obviously — who are all humiliated by what happened, by the way some were treated," Davoine told Reuters.

"Tensions mounted over the weekend, so this morning the employees decided to meet: First, to open a dialogue with management, and second, to ensure that women are never treated this way at the company again," she said.

Davoine added that management had since apologised to workers over the incident.

The Eiffel Tower, which receives nearly seven million visitors a year, as per its website, was closed on Monday, France 24 reported.

In New Delhi on Tuesday, Ministry of External Affairs spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said, "We are aware of the opening of a temple by the BAPS Sanstha in the Paris area. As to the particular issue pertaining to the Tower, this is a matter purely between the entities concerned."

When asked about Prime Minister Narendra Modi addressing the inauguration of BAPS Swaminarayan Hindu Mandir in Paris on Sunday, he said, "It is a common practice for the Prime Minister to convey his good wishes on such occasions. In this case, it was done virtually. There is no cause for any comment in this regard."

Meanwhile, BAPS said in a statement that the visit to the Eiffel Tower was arranged at the start of opening hours to avoid disrupting others, given the size of its delegation.

The Eiffel Tower reopens on Tuesday, a day after a strike over restrictions on women during a visit by a Hindu delegation. AP

"We respect the concerns raised and take them very seriously. Due to the size of our delegation, the visit was arranged in conjunction with the Eiffel Tower team at the start of normal opening hours to avoid disrupting or inconveniencing others," the group said.

"To the best of our knowledge, at no point was anyone prevented access to the Eiffel Tower. Nevertheless, we sincerely apologise for any pain or inconvenience caused. We believe in the universal values of mutual respect and service," it added.

Société d'Exploitation de la tour Eiffel (SETE), the company that runs the Eiffel Tower, said the delegation had requested the visit be organised in such a way as to limit "interactions with women" and acknowledged that "these conditions should not have been accepted".

The conditions "were not in line with SETE's values, nor with the principles of equality between men and women," the company said, promising to accept the "consequences."

"We are going to shed light on what happened, and we will draw the necessary conclusions," SETE president Ariel Weil, who is also an elected official in Paris, told AFP.

Paris Mayor Emmanuel Grégoire expressed support for the strike in a post on X, describing the exclusion of women workers as "unacceptable" and contrary to the "values that the Eiffel Tower stands for".

"I have taken note of the anger expressed by Eiffel Tower staff, and I want to tell them that their grievances are legitimate. Such conditions are unacceptable. These are neither my values nor the values the Eiffel Tower should embody -- a place where everyone must be able to move about and act freely, without distinction between women and men," Grégoire said. "It is urgent that the full facts surrounding this protest be brought to light. Gender equality does not stop at the foot of our historic monuments, nor anywhere else in this city. It must apply everywhere, for everyone. I will ensure this happens, everywhere and without exception. An investigation will be launched immediately."

French Equality Minister Aurore Bergé also posted on X, saying, "In France, we do not ask women to erase themselves... no dogma, no religion is above the laws of the Republic."

Far-Right French leader Marine Le Pen, an early frontrunner in next year's presidential election, also weighed in, saying France would "never accept that women's presence be 'limited'."

• BRIEFLY

Food safety officials inspect a restaurant in Kolkata. EXPRESS

WEST BENGAL

Licences of 40 Kolkata eateries suspended for food safety violations

THE KOLKATA Municipal Corporation (KMC) on Tuesday suspended food licences of 40 restaurants and eateries, including well-known establishments like Balaram Mullick & Radharaman Mullick, for violating food safety rules following a week-long drive coinciding with the Food Safety Week. Civic officials said that during the drive, which covered restaurants, hotels, food courts across the city, food safety inspectors flagged gross violations such as unhygienic conditions, and poor sanitation. Officials said they found cockroaches and rat infestations where food was stored, fungal growth and rodents roaming around the premises. ENS

Karan Darda is new INS president

KARAN RAJENDRA DARDA of *Lokmat* has been elected president of The Indian Newspaper Society for 2026-27. Darda was elected Monday at the 87th annual general meeting of The Indian Newspaper Society, an apex body of publishers of newspapers, magazines and periodicals in the country. The INS, in a press release, named Tanmay Maheshwari (*Amar Ujala*) as its deputy president, Harsha Mathew (*Vanitha*) the vice president, Anant Nath (*Grihshobhika*) the honorary treasurer and Mary Paul the secretary general. ENS

6 killed, 7 injured as truck rams SUV in Gondia

SIX PEOPLE, including a three-year-old boy, were killed and seven others were injured after a speeding truck collided with an SUV in Maharashtra's Gondia district, police said on Tuesday. The victims were labourers from neighbouring Madhya Pradesh and were travelling to Karimnagar in Telangana for work, an official said. The truck driver, Mohsin Khan (32), a resident of Gondia, crashed into the SUV coming from the opposite direction, he said. Pawar said that the victims were extricated from the mangled vehicle, with the impact killing six. PTI

No UAPA in chargesheet against 7 foreigners, NIA seeks further probe

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 8

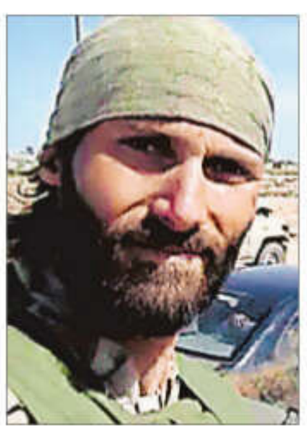
THE NATIONAL Investigation Agency (NIA) invoked sections of the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025 in its chargesheet against seven foreign nationals arrested in March this year for allegedly conspiring to carry out terrorist activities against India.

The chargesheet, filed on Tuesday before a special NIA court in Delhi, did not invoke the anti-terror law — Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) — against the seven foreigners, including one US national and six Ukrainians, who are accused of having links to ethnic armed groups in India.

Special Public Prosecutor (SPP) Rahul Tyagi representing the NIA informed the court that the investigation into offences under UAPA has been kept pending for further probe.

The agency may file a supplementary chargesheet if an offence under the Act is made out, he said.

"A substantial part of the further investigation with respect to the offences committed under UA(P) Act, 1967 has been completed. Further investigation is ongoing and more time is required in order to ascertain and verify the true and complete facts about the commission of offences under UA(P)A in view of import and recovery of huge quantities of drones and accessories through India," the NIA submitted.



Matthew Van Dyke, a US national, was among the seven foreigners arrested in March

The court has posted the matter for further proceedings on October 1.

According to the NIA probe, the accused entered Myanmar illegally via Mizoram to allegedly conduct a pre-scheduled training on drone warfare, drone operations, assembly and jamming technology for Myanmar-based Ethnic Armed Groups (EAGs) targeting the Myanmar Military Junta.

The accused persons violated Section 3 and 7 of the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025 which govern the mandatory travel documents required for entry into India.

Matthew Van Dyke, a 46-year-old American who is in judicial custody in the case, claimed on his website that he "fought in the 2011 Libyan Civil War to overthrow Muammar Gaddafi". He was arrested by the NIA from the Kolkata airport, while Ukrainian citizens Petro Hurba, Taras Slyviak and Ivan Sukmanovskyi were arrested from Lucknow airport on March 13.

Three other Ukrainians — Marian Stefankiv, Maksim Honcharuk and Viktor Kaminskyi — were arrested from Delhi airport the same day.

Sources said one group of Ukrainians stayed in hotels in Mumbai in December last year. From Mumbai, they allegedly went to Guwahati from where they "illegally" entered Myanmar. Another group of Ukrainians allegedly stayed in Delhi in a Paharganj hotel in December last year before heading to Guwahati.

As per the NIA, the accused persons had entered Mizoram without taking the mandatory Protected Area Permit (PAP).

The NIA investigation has found that several consignments of drones from Europe were allegedly delivered by the accused persons to individuals and groups in Mizoram.

According to the agency, the accused have told interrogators that they were in "direct touch and abetted in their terrorist illegal activities by unknown terrorists carrying AK47 rifles".

Five baby orangutans spotted in Odisha, cops suspect smuggling

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, September 8

LOCAL RESIDENTS roaming about a forest area near a village in Odisha's Balasore district had an unusual sighting on Tuesday — five tiny orangutans.

As the news of the rare visitors spread rapidly, thousands of onlookers gathered within an hour, forcing the forest department rescue the wild animals.

The orangutans were spotted near the Badapai village forest in Bhograi area of the coastal district around 6am.

"We have rescued five baby orangutans and brought them to the forest office. Four of the five babies are healthy and eating food and drinking ORS. Veterinary doctors are examining and treating them and they are under the care and observation of the forest officials," Balasore Divisional Forest Officer (DFO) Pratik Prakash Indalkar told *The Indian Express*.

Though the exact age of the Orangutans is not known, forest department officials said from their size — measuring 1- to 1.5 feet in height, they are likely to be juveniles. While the forest department is yet to ascertain how the apes ended up in Odisha forests, which is not their natural habitation, senior officials suspect they may have been brought into the state as part of an international wildlife-smuggling racket.

The orangutan babies spotted in a forest area in Balasore.

"The Wildlife Crime Control Bureau, a multi-disciplinary agency by the Centre, would probe the matter as the state government suspects involvement of an international smuggling racket," said the state's forest and environment minister Ganesh Ram Singh Khuntia.

Orangutans are Asia's only great apes and are the largest tree-dwelling (arboreal) mammals on earth. Native only to the rainforests of Borneo and Sumatra, these highly intelligent primates are facing a survival crisis, with all three species classified as Critically Endangered on the IUCN Red List.

"Chances of their natural migration to the Balasore forest is less as there is no corridor link. It must be a human-induced act. We have launched an investigation through field officials to ascertain how the primates arrived in the Odisha jungle," said the Balasore DFO.

A formal complaint has also been lodged under the relevant provisions of wildlife laws. The forest department is taking help of the police to find out involvement of any individual or racket. They have also launched a combing operation in nearby forest areas to find out if any other wild animals are present there or if there is any sign of evidence of smuggling. "The details, as to whether there is involvement of any individual or a racket, would only be known after a thorough investigation," said an official.

Cases of orangutan trafficking involve a multi-million-dollar criminal industry, said officials. Forest officials said the orangutans will most likely be brought to the Nandankanan Zoological Park in Bhubaneswar after following necessary procedures.

Tour guide stabbed to death near Amer Fort

Parul Kulshrestha
Jaipur, September 8

A 40-YEAR-OLD tour guide, who was stabbed following an altercation near Jaipur's Amer Fort on Monday, died at SMS Hospital on Tuesday morning, triggering protests and a shutdown of the Amer market.

Manish Kumar Soni, a resident of Amer, had been taken to the ICU after being stabbed in the abdomen on Monday.

According to ACP (Amer) Prateek Singh, the incident took place near Maota Lake around 9.30 am when a group of tourists arriving in a private car asked for directions to Amer Fort.

Azam, a jeep driver stationed in the area, allegedly told the tourists that private vehicles could not go up to the fort and suggested that they hire a jeep.

But Manish, who was at the spot, explained the route to the tourists, after which they proceeded to the fort in their private vehicle. This allegedly led to an argument between Manish and Azam.

"There has been an ongoing dispute between the jeep drivers and the tourist guides in the Amer area. Manish and Azam got into an argument over this, and the former was stabbed... We have arrested the accused and due process will be followed," said Singh.

The victim, Manish Kumar Soni

Manish died around 7 am on Tuesday while undergoing treatment in the ICU, police said.

News of his death spread quickly through Amer, with shopkeepers voluntarily shutting the local market and residents gathering on the streets. Several people, including members of Manish's family, staged a sit-in protest and raised slogans demanding justice.

Protesters demanded compensation of Rs 1 crore and a government job for a member of his family. Some also demanded that the accused's house be demolished.

Residents of Amer had on Monday blocked the road for nearly one-and-a-half hours. Following Manish's death, police from Amer police station and nearby areas were deployed in the locality as crowds gathered.

Police officials said the situation was brought under control after discussions with the protesters. Further action in the case is underway.

• THE STUDY HAS IDENTIFIED 21 GENETIC REGIONS LINKED TO ENDOMETRIOSIS, OFFERING NEW CLUES TO WHY SOME WOMEN MAY BE MORE PRONE TO THE DISEASE

Endometriosis could be genetic, reveals 1st Indian genome study

Anuradha Mascarenhas
Pune, September 8

FOR YEARS, women with endometriosis — a condition in which tissue lining the uterus overgrows outside it — have been telling doctors the same story: severe period pain, chronic pelvic pain or infertility, often after years of suffering and sometimes with a mother or sister reporting similar symptoms.

Now, India's first genome-wide study of the disease has found evidence that genetic susceptibility may play a role in Indian women, while also identifying genetic signals that could be particularly relevant to the Indian population.

The study, published in Scientific Reports, identified 21 suggestive genetic regions associated with endometriosis in Indian women. Researchers also found genetic signals with previously identified endometriosis triggers and found that a risk score developed from European populations showed relevance in the Indian cohort.

The findings are not ready for clinical use or individual risk prediction. But researchers say they provide an important starting point for larger studies, particularly among South Asian populations that have been underrepresented in genetic research on endometriosis.

"When I started working on endometriosis research nearly two decades ago, I was struck by how many women had lived for years with severe period pain, chronic pelvic pain or infertility before receiving a diagnosis," said Dr Rahul Gajbhiye, Scientist and Head, Clinical Research Laboratory, ICMR–National Institute for Research on Women's Health (NIRWoH), Mumbai, and principal investigator of the study.

"Some women also told me that their mother or sister had suffered from very similar symptoms but had never been diagnosed. At that time, I could see a possible familial pattern, but I did not have the scientific tools or Indian genetic data to answer why this was happening," he said.

Indian genetic dataset

Dr Gajbhiye began examining the genetic basis of endometriosis more systematically during his INSA postdoctoral fellowship at the University of Queensland, Australia, in 2017–18, where he received training in the genetics and genomics of the disease. After returning to India, he was awarded a DBT Wellcome India Alliance Clinical and Public Health Intermediate Fellowship in 2019. The fellowship enabled the establishment of Endometriosis Clinical and Genetic Research in India (ECGRI) initiative and the creation of a clinical and genomic dataset of Indian women.

E. EXPLAINED

Potential for early diagnosis

According to researchers, the study could eventually help scientists understand why some women are more susceptible, identify biological pathways involved in the disease and explore new approaches to earlier diagnosis and treatment.

The study involved 18 centres across India, bringing together gynaecological laparoscopic surgeons, clinicians, researchers and laboratory teams. Women with surgically confirmed endometriosis and control participants were recruited from different regions and ancestry backgrounds.

Dr Sandhya Anand, lead author of the study, said the 21 suggestive genetic regions provided new leads for understanding endometriosis in Indian women. "Our findings are not for immediate clinical testing, but they provide an important foundation for future South Asian studies on endometriosis biology, genetic risk and early recognition," she said.

Endometriosis affects about 10% of women of reproductive age, according to widely cited estimates. Despite its prevalence, diagnosis is often delayed for years, with symptoms such as severe menstrual pain frequently normalised or dismissed.

Researchers say the problem is particularly important in India, where awareness, access to specialised care and population-specific research proof remain limited.

Much of the existing genetic research on endometriosis has been based on populations of European ancestry. The new Indian dataset, therefore, adds an important South Asian component to global research into the disease.

The study comes as the World Health Organization (WHO) is developing new guidelines on endometriosis management, reflecting the growing recognition of the disease as a major public health concern.

Court discharges seven men booked in post-Pulwama stir

Arun Sharma
Jammu, September 8

NOTING THAT the court was not a mere post office to frame a charge at the behest of the prosecution, a court in Jammu has granted relief to seven men who were booked for allegedly indulging in rioting and arson during a protest against Pakistan in the aftermath of the 2019 Pulwama terror attack.

The court said the accused cannot be connected with an offence committed by a mob unless there is evidence they had the "common unlawful object" with all its members.

Those discharged by the court include Rohit Sharma, Kailash Kumar, Manat Kumar, Sajan Kumar, Sukhdev Singh alias Rinku, Sahil Sharma and Jagdish Kumar.

According to the FIR registered at Jammu City Police Station, a mob of nearly 600-700 people had taken out a procession in the city. On being stopped by police, they had turned violent and damaged vehicles parked on the roadside, setting six of them on fire, the FIR added.

The court rejected the prosecution plea that it could not do roving inquiry at the stage of filing of challan, saying that it is "not to act as a mere post office to frame the charge at the behest of the prosecution, but has to exercise its judicial mind to the facts of the case" in order to determine whether a case for trial has been made out or not.

After assurance from govt, J&K medical interns call off strike

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, September 8

MEDICAL INTERNS in Jammu and Kashmir, who were on strike since August 31 seeking an increase in their monthly stipend, have called off their stir after assurance from the government that the issue will be addressed within a month keeping in view their "legitimate interests".

The decision to call off the strike was taken after the representatives of the interns met Health Minister Sakina Itoo on Tuesday. The meeting was also attended by the Principal of the Government Medical College, Srinagar, and Deputy Director, Planning, representing the Directorate of Health.

"After detailed deliberations, it was decided that the matter shall be finalised within a period of 30 days on the basis of the recommendations of the Stipend Enhancement Committee ... and keeping in view the legitimate interests and concerns of medical interns," read the record note of the meeting. "In view of the above, the medical interns agreed to call off their strike and resume their duties forthwith..." it added.

STAINES MURDER

Take a call, don't keep it lingering: SC to Odisha on Dara remission plea

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, September 8

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday pulled up the Odisha government for failing to take a decision on the remission plea of Ravindra Pal alias Dara Singh, who is serving a life sentence for the murder of Australian missionary Graham Stuart Staines and his two minor sons in 1999.

Questioning the delay, a bench of Justices Manoj Misra and Vijay Bishnoi warned that it would summon the state's top officials if no decision was taken by the next date of hearing on September 17.

As the bench took up the matter on Tuesday, the state's counsel sought four more weeks, citing the ill health of the Advocate on Record, and said he was still awaiting instructions.

Justice Misra said the state had sought an adjournment at the last hearing too. The bench referred to its August 29 order directing the State Sentence Review Board to take a decision and apprise the court by September 2.

Saying that the matter has been pending for over two years, the bench said it cannot be kept "lingering" forever and a decision would have to be taken.

"Why are you unnecessarily adjourning the matter? Take a decision. You want to reject it, reject it. We will deal with it," Justice Misra said.

> **"Why are you unnecessarily adjourning the matter? Take a decision. You want to reject it, reject it. We will deal with it"**
> JUSTICE MANOJ MISRA, SUPREME COURT JUDGE

"Seek instruction or else we will summon your Secretary," Justice Misra said, before finally agreeing to hear the matter on September 17.

The court said that if his plea was rejected, the convict would have the option to challenge it, and if accepted, the petition would become infructuous.

The Supreme Court had issued notice on the remission plea on July 8, 2024. Saying that he had been in jail for 26 years, Dara Singh had asked that his plea for premature release be considered by the relevant committee of the Odisha government.

"This matter has been adjourned time and again to enable the respondents to take a decision on the plea of remission of sentence awarded to the petitioner who is incarcerated for a period exceeding 26 years." the court had said on August 19.

It then further noted, "It appears that when the matter was adjourned last, the State Sentence Review Board was in the process of taking a decision on the plea of the petitioner. Based on that, the matter was adjourned. Today, the learned counsel representing the respondent has placed before us a letter of the Directorate of Prisons and Correctional Service, Odisha, addressed to the counsel representing the respondent wherein it is stated that the report from District Jail Kendujhar (Keonjhar) is yet to be received."

"We are not informed about the decision of the Sentence Review Board. List this matter on 02.09.2026. By which date, the Sentence Review Board shall take a decision and apprise us about the decision," the court had said.

Day before PM event, 2 held for entry into BKC venue with fake PMO ID, licenced gun

Two men detained with fake PMO identity card and gun in Bandra-Kurla Complex area, Mumbai. GANESH SHIRSEKAR

Manish Kumar Pathak & Mohamed Thaver
Mumbai, September 8

A DAY before Prime Minister Narendra Modi arrived in Mumbai to inaugurate the Global Fintech Fest 2026, two men were arrested for allegedly using a fake Prime Minister's Office (PMO) identity card to gain entry into Jio World Plaza in Bandra-Kurla Complex, police said on Tuesday.

The PM was in Mumbai on Tuesday for the Fintech event in BKC area.

However, police clarified that the incident has no connection with Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Mumbai.

The incident occurred on Monday, and there is no evidence at present linking the accused or their actions to the PM's programme, they said.

The accused have been identified as Rohan Premal Parikh, 24, a businessman and share broker from Khar, and Dilip Rajaram Kunde, 49, a retired Army personnel from rural Nashik who works as Parikh's bodyguard. Their associate, Prathamesh Bagul, 26, of Worli, has also been named as an accused and is absconding.

The bodyguard was carrying a licensed revolver and six live cartridges, police said. Investigators are examining the circumstances in which the firearm was brought into the premises and whether its possession there violated prohibitory orders.

According to police, the three men arrived at Jio World Plaza around 4.50 pm on Monday, amid tight security ahead of PM Modi's Tuesday visit. During a security check, one of them allegedly produced an identity card claiming to have been issued by the PMO, Government of India, and identified himself as a PMO official.

The security personnel alerted the police after noticing the suspicious identity card and a firearm. Police subsequently examined CCTV footage, traced the vehicle used by the men and identified Parikh.

A police team reached Parikh's residence in Khar later that night and detained him, while another police team traced and arrested Kunde from Kalyan.

The two were produced before a Bandra court on Tuesday and remanded in police custody till September 11. The case has been transferred to the Mumbai Crime Branch's Crime Intelligence Unit (CIU).

EXPRESS special

15 killed after consuming hooch in MP: Victims saved Rs 20, were assured booze not spurious

Police find similarities in accounts from 2 villages in Sagar — cheaper product made using branded liquor's 'formula'

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, September 8

THE FIRST deaths that alerted Madhya Pradesh Police to the suspected spurious liquor racket in Sagar district began with what appeared to be ordinary purchases of cheap liquor in two villages.

In Nauraj, 25-year-old Rajendra Lodhi bought a quarter of "Bambaiya" liquor for Rs 70 after being assured it was not fake. In Patan, 32-year-old Roshan Lodhi bought a quarter of "Sagar Gold" for Rs 60 after receiving a similar assurance. Both fell critically ill soon after drinking and died during treatment.

The police investigation has begun piecing together what investigators suspect was a supply chain linking village-level illegal sellers with people allegedly involved in procuring, manufacturing, transporting and distributing cheap liquor.

Police have found strikingly similar accounts in Nauraj and Patan, where victims allegedly consumed liquor after being assured that the cheaper product was genuine and had merely been made using the "formula" of the branded liquor.

"So far, 14 people have been arrested; they were produced before the court, and police remand has been obtained for their interrogation. One more accused is in our custody; he is being questioned, and the investigation is ongoing. We had two suspects undergoing treatment; one of them has died... the official death toll is 15," said Sagar SP Anurag Sujaniya.

In Nauraj, police have linked the deaths of Rajendra Lodhi, 25, Kartar Singh Lodhi, 30, and Digvijay Lodhi, 28, to liquor allegedly sold by Jujhar Lodhi and other local sellers.

According to investigators, Jujhar told Rajendra and his uncle, Anup Singh, on September 4 that a "new cheap brand" had arrived and was being supplied through licensed liquor contractors Yashwant Singh, Manish Lodhi and Ashish Sahu of Banda. Police said the liquor was then moved through a chain of local sellers involving Akash Rai, Rahim Khan, Satyam, Asharam, Arvind, Ravindra, Rohit, Aniket and Makhan.

According to the police account, the liquor was being offered for about Rs 20 less than at licensed shops. When Rajendra reportedly asked whether it was fake or poisonous, Jujhar allegedly assured him it was the same brand and claimed that Manish and Ashish had made it using the liquor's "formula".

A man being discharged after treatment from Sagar district hospital.

Rajendra bought a quarter of country liquor described in the FIR as "Bambaiya" for Rs 70 and consumed it, according to the police.

Family accounts provide a picture of how rapidly some of the victims' condition deteriorated. Kartar Singh Lodhi's family said he drank liquor on Saturday afternoon and began vomiting after returning home. By around 8 pm, he was repeatedly losing consciousness. He was taken first to Banda hospital and then to Sagar when his condition worsened.

His niece, Kirti Lodhi, said his condition became so critical he was unable to recognise family members.

"My uncle had vision problems first. He had turned blue," she said. Kartar, the youngest of four brothers, died at the medical college in Sagar. His family said he left behind his wife and two young children and that the family depended on farming.

Rajendra Lodhi, meanwhile, had been preparing to leave for Indore for work but stayed back after his sister returned home for Raksha Bandhan. He fell ill after consuming the liquor and died after being taken to hospital.

When his body was brought home, his sister repeatedly fainted, and his father collapsed on seeing his son's body, according to the family.

Police say Digvijay Lodhi, 28, was another Nauraj resident who consumed the allegedly poisonous liquor and died at Banda hospital.

The Nauraj case names Jujhar, Dinesh Lodhi, Saurabh Lodhi, Govind Lodhi and Manohar Lodhi as the principal local accused, allegedly responsible for preparing, selling or supplying the liquor.

The investigation has produced a second trail in Patan around the death of 32-year-old Roshan Lodhi.

Police say Roshan drank at Ram Singh Lodhi's premises on September 5 and returned home vomiting. According to his uncle, Surendra Lodhi, Roshan said Ram Singh told him that a new, cheaper liquor had arrived and that it had been manufactured through Chandu alias Chandrabhan Rajput of Tatarwara and licensed liquor contractor Siddharth Kushwah.

The police case alleges that Rohit Shivhare of Chhatarpur and Raghvendra, Dharmendra and Sohan of Tatarwara were involved in getting the liquor manufactured and moving it onward. Roshan had reportedly asked whether the liquor was fake or poisonous. Ram Singh allegedly assured him it was not fake and claimed it had been made using the same liquor formula.

Roshan bought a quarter of "Sagar Gold" for Rs 60, drank it and returned home. His health then deteriorated sharply, and he was taken to Banda hospital, where he died during treatment.

MP police orders inquiry into action on protesting medical interns

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, September 8

THE MADHYA Pradesh Police has ordered an inquiry into the use of a water cannon on protesting intern doctors at Hamidia Hospital in Bhopal, after videos of the incident went viral.

The intern doctors were protesting to demand an increase in their monthly stipend from around Rs 14,000 to Rs 30,000. Some protesters were reportedly injured during the police action.

An order issued by Bhopal Police Commissioner Sanjay Kumar on Tuesday appointed Deputy Commissioner of Police (DCP), Zone-2, Vikas Sahwal as the inquiry officer.

Additional Police Commissioner (Law and Order) Shailendra Singh Chouhan said the inquiry would establish facts surrounding incident and examine all issues."If anything wrong was done to anyone... an independent probe will be conducted." Chouhan said.

Would rather die than be called a coward: Judge who handed death to 17 in 3 months

Vineet Upadhyaya
New Delhi, September 8

WEEKS AFTER 97 murder cases were withdrawn from his court, Muzaffarnagar judge Ravi Kumar Diwakar sentenced a man to death for burning his wife alive in a dowry case — and declared that he would rather die than be called a "coward judge."

"If I become fearful of other forces... it would be appropriate for me to resign from this sacred judicial institution," Diwakar wrote in a September 7 order. "I would rather die, but would not like to be called a coward judge... As long as I am on the judge's chair, the authority to take decisions will be mine alone." He credited his parents with teaching him to fear only God, adding that yielding to strongmen or criminals would betray the trust of litigants who expect courts to be fearless and impartial.

The 97 murder cases were "recalled" and reassigned under an August 18 administrative order issued by the Muzaffarnagar District and Sessions Judge.

Judge Diwakar, who heads Fast Track Court No. 3, had sentenced 17 of 22 accused to death across seven murder trials between April 6 and July 17. All the death sentences require confirmation by the Allahabad High Court before they can be carried out.

Diwakar's latest order also referred to case files being removed from his court, which he said left him "deeply hurt". He alleged this was meant "to protect mafias, gangsters and criminals", adding that he knew the reason but would not disclose it, citing the dignity of his office.

He recounted a message he said was conveyed by "a gangster from western UP," warning that if he continued to pursue such cases, contacts "at higher levels" would be used to have his court changed or have him transferred out of the district.

He also questioned the practice of transferring serious cases without hearing the state's side and asked whether victims' families and the government had no standing when courts were reassigned in ways that benefited the accused.

The criminal justice system, he said, exists to secure justice for victims as much as to protect the rights of the accused.

Sar Tan Se Juda slogan challenges authority of law: HC rejects Bareilly cleric's bail petition

Bhupendra Pandey
Lucknow, September 8

REJECTING THE bail plea of Maulana Tauqeer Raza Khan — the alleged mastermind of last year's violence in Bareilly — the Allahabad High Court said records show he indulged in such activity admittedly to satisfy his religious and private political interests.

A single bench of Justice Ashutosh Srivastava, in its Monday order, also endorsed the state government's contention that the 'Sar Tan Se Juda' slogan raised by the mob amounted to a challenge to the authority of law and incited people for armed rebellion. "The court also finds force in the submission of the counsel for the state to the effect that the slogan '*Gushtakh-e-Nabi Ke Ek Hi Saja, Sar Tan Se Juda, Sar Tan Se Juda*' is nothing but a challenge to the authority of law... [and] sovereignty and integrity of India... and incites the people for an armed rebellion, which is punishable under the law."

The court said it could not be compared with religious slogans such as 'Jai Shri Ram', 'Har Har Mahadev' and 'Allahu-Akbar'. These slogans, it stated, express respect to the God or Guru concerned.

In its order, the court further stated that Khan's conduct after the incident, when he gave a speech thanking the masses for responding to his call in large numbers and applauding acts of indulging in violence, cannot be approved.

On September 26 last year, clashes broke out during a protest in support of the "I love Muhammad" campaign. Khan, president of social and political organisation Ittehad-e-Millat Council (IMC), was arrested in separate cases related to the violence and has been lodged in jail since September 27, 2025.

He, along with others, was booked on charges including rioting, promoting enmity on ground of religion, attempt to murder and sections of Prevention of Damage of Public Property Act. A prominent face of the Barelvi Sunni community, Tauqeer wields considerable influence in religious and social spheres in the Bareilly region.

Khan's counsel, in their submissions to court, said he has been falsely implicated in the case. They claimed that Khan is an influential public figure and on account of his political influence, he has been a soft target.

The counsel stated that on September 19, 2025, the IMC had given a call during a public meeting to assemble on the grounds of Islamia Inter College, Bareilly, to protest against the alleged atrocities being faced by the Muslim community and false cases being lodged against them by the state government.

They argued that Khan did not organise any gathering with the object of inciting anyone, and there is no direct allegation of causing violence or damage against him. The government counsel opposed the bail plea, alleging that Khan was the kingpin and mastermind.

Man who questioned Punjab minister over 'chitta' dies by suicide; kin say 'humiliated' by villagers

Raakhi Jagga
Patiala, September 8

A 53-YEAR-old man from Sangrur allegedly died by suicide with his family claiming that he took the extreme strep after being asked to apologise and subjected to casteist slurs for questioning Finance Minister Harpal Singh Cheema over easy availability of 'chitta' in his village.

This triggered a political controversy, prompted the National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC) to seek a report from the state government even as the police arrested five villagers, including the sarpanch, on charges of abetment of suicide and relevant sections of the SC/ST Act.

Gulzar Singh, a resident of Toor Banzara village in Dirba constituency, allegedly consumed poison on Monday after claiming in a video recorded before his death that he had been threatened and humiliated for raising the issue of drug availability with Cheema during a public meeting in the village on September 6. Gulzar, who described himself as unemployed, said in the purported video that his son was addicted to drugs and had been selling household belongings to sustain his addiction.

Family members of Gulzar Singh in Toor Banzara village in Dirba. HARMEET SODHI

"Finance Minister Cheema had visited the village on Sunday to hear public grievances, where I raised the issue of easy availability of 'chitta' (heroin). My son is addicted to drugs and has sold household belongings to sustain his addiction...*Chitta band nahi hoya* (Supply of chitta has not stopped)," he is heard saying in the video.

He alleged that the following morning, some people came to his house and threatened him for questioning the minister. He claimed they told him the village sarpanch and panchayat members wanted to meet him near agricultural fields. "If I die, they all will be responsible for it," Gulzar said in the video.

According to his family, Gulzar was scared after the alleged threats and consumed poison instead of going to meet the panchayat members.

His nephew, Karanvir Singh, said Gulzar was taken outside the venue after raising the issue with Cheema and was pressured by villagers to apologise. Gulzar's son, Lakhwinder Singh, alleged in his police complaint his father subjected to casteist slurs when police came to their house.

Rupinder Kaur Bajwa, DSP, Dirba, said Gulzar's death was being treated as a suicide. "We will take action based on the family's statement," she said. The DSP said police had not received any statement from the family linking Gulzar's death to his interaction with Cheema or the alleged threats.

Minister subsidy row: Horticulture board pauses fresh scheme applications

Harikishan Sharma
New Delhi, September 8

THE NATIONAL Horticulture Board (NHB), an autonomous body under the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare, has temporarily suspended acceptance of fresh applications for grant of clearance (GoC) under two schemes for one month, effective September 4.

The development comes days after the board amended guidelines of a scheme, under which a Union minister and a serving central government secretary's relative availed subsidies for cucumber farms.

The NHB issued a circular on September 3 stating that no new GoC applications will be accepted for a month for the Scheme for Development of Commercial Horticulture through Production and Post-Harvest Management of Horticulture Produce (Scheme 1) and Capital Investment Subsidy Scheme for Construction/Expansion/ Modernization of Cold Storages (Scheme 2).

The Indian Express had reported on June 27 that Bhagirath Choudhary, Minister of State in the Union Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare, and the wife, mother, and son of IAS officer Naresh Pal Gangwar, who is currently serving as the secretary, Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying, availed subsidy under the first scheme.

Following the *Express* investigation, Choudhary returned Rs 99 lakh subsidy to NHB. The government subsequently changed the scheme guidelines, with effect from August 21.

"In order to facilitate the orderly implementation of the revised guidelines, including necessary verification of pending cases and updation of the online application system, it has been decided to temporarily suspend the receipt of fresh applications for Grant of Clearance (GoC) under Scheme No. 1 and Scheme No. 2 of NHB Schemes for a period of one month with effect from 4.9.2026. During the above period, the online facility for submission of fresh GoC applications under the aforesaid Schemes shall remain temporarily unavailable," reads the NHB circular, approved by the "competent authority".

The GoC is mandatory for the applicant to avail the credit-linked back-ended subsidy for the project under National Horticulture Board schemes.

"This temporary suspension shall apply only to the submission of fresh GoC applications. The cases already submitted to NHB prior to the commencement of the temporary suspension shall continue to be dealt with in accordance with the applicable provisions of the revised scheme guidelines and other instructions issued by NHB from time to time," the circular clarified. It added that the date for resumption of receipt of fresh GoC applications would be notified by the NHB.

The Development of Commercial Horticulture through Production and Post-Harvest Management of Horticulture Crops Scheme is aimed at promoting commercial farming (for profit) of horticultural crops on a large scale.

The crops that fall under the scheme are capsicum, cucumber, and tomato, and eight varieties of flowers including rose, lilium and chrysanthemum. The scheme offers a maximum subsidy of 50 per cent, capped at Rs 1 crore per family, of the project cost.

On August 21, the government revised the scheme's guidelines by changing the definition of 'family' and barring holders of constitutional posts, serving ministers, MPs, MLAs, mayors, district panchayat chiefs and government employees from availing financial assistance under National Horticulture Board schemes.

The 'family' definition was revised to comprise "the applicant's spouse, father, mother, sons and daughters." As per the old guidelines, the term 'family' was defined as "the husband, wife, and dependent minor children."

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The safety of the people shall be the highest law.
— *Cicero*

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RAMNATH GOENKA
IN 1932
BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

For ISRO, expanding ecosystem is way forward

THE DEBATE that began with the Indian Space Research Organisation tightening its norms for resignation and voluntary retirement of senior scientific personnel has now expanded to questions over the role of the private sector in space, and the future of the space agency itself. Some employee associations of ISRO have written to the leadership asking whether recent remarks by Pawan Kumar Goenka, chairman of IN-SPACe, the nodal agency that promotes and guides private-sector participation in space, represented official policy. Goenka had said that eventually ISRO would not manufacture any launch vehicles, a job that would be done by private companies. This comment forced ISRO chairman V Narayanan to categorically say that there was no move to privatise the space agency, even as he welcomed the increasing role of private companies.

The government seems to be preparing ISRO to go the NASA way — focusing primarily on big-ticket space projects, scientific and exploration missions, while leaving the routine launches to private industry. ISRO is also being asked to handhold private industry, and help them achieve a level of maturity. Much of this process is already unfolding. Most private space companies have retired ISRO scientists as advisors or mentors. It is also offering its launch pads and related services to these companies. ISRO developed a small rocket (SSLV) over the years, but has now transferred the technology to HAL, a public-sector unit. This model can be fruitful. The private space ecosystem can do a large number of commercial launches, bring in much-needed revenue, develop a large talent pool and spur fresh employment opportunities. Capabilities in space products and services are also becoming a powerful diplomatic good. Of course, the concern amongst sections of the ISRO staff and many old-timers is that the space agency should not just be a provider, but also a beneficiary. By stepping away from commercial launches, for example, ISRO is foregoing an important source of revenue. Becoming entirely dependent on government budgets will constrain its capabilities. Neither R&D nor ambitious exploration projects are cheap. These would also require ISRO to be able to attract and retain top-tier talent.

The ISRO community also seems concerned about the independence that the space agency has enjoyed thus far. That Prime Minister Narendra Modi is personally interested in, and excited about, the space sector is evident. It has helped ISRO receive steady government support for its plans and projects. The success of ISRO is often attributed to the fact that it has been relatively immune to government interference. That needs to continue, as ISRO embarks on a more ambitious journey.

Punjab stand on judge sets disturbing precedent

JUSTICE ASHWANI Kumar Mishra took oath as Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court on Monday, with an empty chair in the front row, reserved for Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann. A day earlier, in an unusual step, the Punjab Cabinet met and asked Governor Gulab Chand Kataria to hold off the oath-taking, arguing that the Centre had notified the appointment without the state's consent. Punjab says that the Centre breached the Memorandum of Procedure (MoP) that governs the appointment of judges, which requires the Centre to consult states before high court appointments. But that is not the end of this story.

The Supreme Court Collegium recommended Justice Mishra and three other judges for appointment as chief justices of four high courts on August 6. The delay in Punjab's response held up all four chief justice appointments. The Centre notified the appointment on September 5. Punjab is right to point out that the MoP fixes no deadline for a state's response. But that flexibility is because judicial appointments are a consultative process. If the Mann government had reservations about Justice Mishra, it had weeks to put them on file, where they could be examined. It doesn't help Punjab's case that Justice Mishra's court has lately been an uncomfortable place for the state government. As Acting Chief Justice, his bench pulled up Punjab in August for withholding dearness allowance dues even as it found ample money for advertising. His court also heard a Mohali case in which allegations were made against the Chief Minister's wife, which the AAP has described as politically motivated.

Earlier in Delhi, the AAP sought to have Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma taken off the appeal in the excise policy case in which party leaders are arraigned as accused. Treating adverse orders as a personal affront cannot become a template for political parties. Certainly, there is a case for bringing defined timelines into the MoP. The SC has set the Centre a benchmark for names reiterated by the Collegium — they must be cleared within three to four weeks. A comparable window for state responses — after which consent is deemed given — would remove the ambiguity this episode exposed. Governments at the Centre and in the states can disagree with each other. What none of them is entitled to do is to let political bickering hijack judicial appointments.

Satwik-Chirag are doing something special

WHILE SAINA Nehwal and P V Sindhu have elevated women's badminton, Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty are slowly but surely achieving the same for doubles. At clubs across India, in neighbourhoods and corporate parks alike, the doubles is the competition format played by millions of amateurs. The sport was already popular, but Satwik-Chirag are acquiring a loyal fanbase because they keep contesting the top titles, and stay in the hunt — with the Singapore Open and China Masters fetching up this year.

It wasn't long back, though, when, after a lukewarm reception to their Thomas Cup second medal, a disappointed Satwik had declared he wouldn't let his kids play the sport. Satwik had asked Indians to watch them play, and acknowledge that they were doing something special — which was remarkable for a country that worshipped the singles stars, but had very little 20 years ago to boast of in terms of doubles. Jwala Gutta and Ashwini Ponappa won a World's bronze and a CWG title in 2010-11, but India wasn't quite registering on the circuit. The powerhouses of badminton — China, Japan, Korea, Indonesia, Malaysia — churned out doubles talent in a sport that doesn't prioritise singles like tennis would. Satwik-Chirag proved they can go toe to toe with those big names, and even reach the World No. 1 ranking.

They keep fans and even trolls invested, converting some of the latter into the former — won over by the hard-working and winsome doubles pairing.

Questions for Bhagwat, and how he can easily lay debate over his remarks to rest

PRATAP BHANU MEHTA

MOHAN BHAGWAT'S Western outreach has elicited a variety of reactions. To his critics, his apparent inclusiveness and the claim that "any Hindu who believes Muslims should not live in India ceases to be a Hindu" are window dressing or worse. His own supporters have two reactions. Some are tempted to say, "We are not as intolerant as we have been made out to be. We have always been misunderstood." Others on the Right are wondering if he might be sounding a bit too much like a liberal who has walked into the wrong *shakha*. Others still are welcoming this as a sign of RSS evolution, a transition from hate to humanism.

It is worth reiterating that there is nothing new in Bhagwat's remarks in New York. He has been saying the same things for years. He used the identical sentence in a speech to the Muslim Rashtriya Manch in 2021. The mystery is why both critics and friends are astonished by it. Such is our state of colonisation, even the RSS chief has to go to New York for his words to be noticed. Even more amazing is that many erstwhile critics think this is the perfect excuse to make peace with the RSS. They were looking for a pretext to make peace. The RSS chief's reiteration provided it.

History is full of ironies. Well-intentioned and moral actors can sometimes produce catastrophic consequences. Narrow or opportunistic agents can sometimes produce good. Organisations can overcome the traces of their origin. The RSS faces two challenges. First, it has to think of a future beyond Narendra Modi. Modi's rise facilitated its growth, and it has to ensure it does not sink with him. Second, internally, the RSS's authority rested on being a special organisation. It was built on cadres, a discourse of sacrifice and discipline. But it is no secret that the more power it has acquired, the pathologies of normal organisations have begun to afflict it, including careerism and corruption. It may have to reinvent its self-image. This context may provide some room for ideological contention within the RSS.

But Bhagwat can easily lay to rest the debate over his remarks by acting institutionally and publicly. There are lots of low-hanging fruit. Just take recent events. Bhagwat once chided Hindus for looking for *shivling*s everywhere. Yogi Adityanath recently announced the goal of building temples in Mathura and Vrindavan. Can Bhagwat say he will oppose any moves that violate the spirit of the Places of Worship Act, 1991, and oppose communal triumphalism? Will Bhagwat ask for a repeal of anti-conversion legislation in Maharashtra that is shifting the burden of innocence even in ordinary acts of worship by minorities? Will he display his moral leadership and the might of his organisation by, on the ground, opposing and resisting attacks on Christian prayer meetings and burial grounds in West Bengal (both the Maharashtra and Bengal stories were reported by this newspaper)? Will he ensure that the law will not be weaponised to target minorities, whether the filing of an FIR against a political leader offering *namaz*, or the alacrity with which bulldozers are being used against a mosque in Saharanpur, without the possibility of an appeal? Will he use the RSS's power to sanction a minister or even the Prime Minister for hate speech? Will he perhaps share his anguish: Why, despite his apparently inclusive remarks over the last decade, has the communal atmosphere become more poisonous?

> The RSS apparently values education. Delhi University is India's most important public university. It's a low-hanging fruit for the RSS to display its evolution

Perhaps Bhagwat's inclusiveness is sincere. But most of us Hindus have little idea what it means. The mission statement on the RSS website says that, even as the struggle for political independence was being pursued, there were "few or no sustained efforts for restoration of the Hindu psyche to its pristine form. Indeed, it is the latter which should constitute the content or core of freedom."

For those Hindus who are neither pristine nor even particularly sure what a "Hindu psyche" is, should we worry? I doubt even deep readers of the *Yoga Vasishtha* or Abhinavagupta can decode what the pristine Hindu psyche means. This alignment for freedom and identity is hardly reassuring for the safety of Hindus, let alone minorities. Rather than constantly searching for benchmarks of civilisational identity, would it not be simpler to say one's religious, cultural, or even civilisational identity is irrelevant to one's standing as a free and equal citizen?

The RSS apparently values education. Delhi University is India's most important public university. It's a low-hanging fruit for the RSS to display its evolution. Apart from its abysmal lack of infrastructure that forms the backdrop to the horrific deaths in Satya Niketan, the university is becoming a poster child for the RSS. Bhagwat's critics allege that V-Cs and teachers have to flaunt their relationship with the RSS to get appointments; the threat of disruption by the ABVP leads to seminars being cancelled. Decolonisation has become, to put it mildly, a pretext for anti-intellectualism and destruction of the university. Perhaps Bhagwat could inspire us by reminding everyone that knowledge should keep political power away. Indian traditions were so radical that they made even the conditions of knowing an object of sceptical inquiry. Subordinating knowledge to civilisational identity is to betray its essence.

Bhagwat rightly sensed that at the Jantar Mantar protest, students were agitated. They should not be termed anti-national. Yet the Prime Minister used an ever-expansive understanding of "*dimagi* Naxal". The RSS, perhaps of the old variety, believed in German-style ideological solutions to the nationalism problem. But the Prime Minister has discovered a German remedy of another sort: Homeopathy. It can cure a pathology called criticism and freedom. But this is not just a joke. The irony seems to be that while people are welcoming Bhagwat's apparent turn to inclusiveness, his party has not got the message. So, either Bhagwat does not mean what he says. Or he is ineffective. Either way, those applauding Bhagwat are revealing something about themselves: Their own complicity, delusion, or fear.

The writer is contributing editor, The Indian Express

India's young can power the world's ageing economies

AJAY KHANNA

ARNAB BHATTACHARYA

THE GLOBAL economy is entering a period of profound demographic transition. Across advanced economies, declining fertility rates, ageing populations, and shrinking workforces are creating structural labour shortages that curtail economic growth. Healthcare systems are struggling to recruit nurses and caregivers. Infrastructure programmes require skilled technicians and tradespeople. Digital economies continue to demand engineers, coders, and specialised professionals.

India is placed uniquely. For decades, countries have leveraged their natural resources as instruments of economic and geopolitical influence. The Gulf economies used oil. Australia built strength around coal, iron ore, and uranium. China leveraged its control over rare earth minerals. India's greatest strategic resource may well be raw talent. In a rapidly ageing world, India has the largest reservoir of young human capital. There are 450 million Indians currently aged between 18 and 35 years, as per the UN's population estimates. A significant share of this generation is English-speaking, digitally literate, culturally adaptable, and globally connected. Most importantly, they possess a level of collective aspiration unmatched in modern economic history. However, raw talent alone is not enough. Language capability, technical training, certification, cultural preparedness and professional discipline are needed for Indian talent to thrive in global markets.

If India can prepare its youth for global workforce participation, Indian workers can become catalysts of economic growth across ageing societies, through flows of remittances and talent, while simultaneously strengthening India's soft power and international influence. This is why global skills mobility must now be viewed not simply as migration policy, but as a strategic pillar of economic diplomacy, workforce development, and international cooperation.

The significance of this opportunity is already visible. India received over $110.47 billion in worker remittances in FY 2025-26, a 26 per cent increase compared to the previous year. The outdated narrative of "brain drain" is increasingly giving way to a more sophisticated reality of "brain circulation".

> The outdated narrative of 'brain drain' is increasingly giving way to a more sophisticated reality of 'brain circulation'

But this opportunity cannot be built on fragmented recruitment systems or opaque intermediaries. The future must rest on trusted institutions, ethical mobility frameworks, worker protection, transparent standards, and international partnerships. None of this can be built without confronting an uncomfortable reality: Political appetite for migration is shrinking in the economies that need workers most. Across much of Europe, parties running on explicitly anti-immigration platforms — from Germany's AfD to Austria's Freedom Party — have moved from the margins into government, and "remigration" has entered political vocabulary.

Circular mobility — temporary, socially accretive, and economically expansive — offers a genuinely different proposition, distinct from the OECD's recent migration experience, and the evidence that it works politically as well as economically already exists. Singapore's work-permit system, Hong Kong's helper and skilled-worker system, and the Gulf's *kafala*-linked systems recognise that temporariness, not restriction, is what has made large-scale labour mobility politically sustainable. Governments have a critical role in negotiating mobility agreements, harmonising standards, and ensuring worker welfare. Industry must move beyond short-term placement targets toward long-term workforce development.

India's ambition should be to become the global hub for trusted talent mobility. In the coming decades, nations that can reliably produce globally employable talent at scale will possess a decisive strategic advantage. India has the demographic strength, the aspiration, and the human capability to lead this transformation. The question is how quickly it can build the institutions, standards, and strategic frameworks required to convert this demographic moment into a lasting national advantage. The answer will shape not only the future of millions of Indians overseas and at home but also the influence India will wield going forward.

Khanna is founding chair, Global Skills Mobility Association of India. Bhattacharya is CEO, Global Access to Talent from India Foundation

Safety in Delhi needs a regulatory reset

ASHOK KUMAR JAIN

THE RECENT collapse of a building in Satya Niketan and similar incidents in Saidulajab, Hauz Rani, Tughlakabad Extension, Palam and Vivek Vihar raise concerns about building safety in the Capital. In Delhi, planned development coexists with informal growth — slums and unauthorised colonies. Both are plagued by building violations along with a lack of oversight and enforcement.

Illegal construction violates Delhi's Master Plan, the Unified Building Byelaws, the Delhi Fire Service Act, DD Act and DMC Act, 1957 and stresses transport, services and civic amenities. Frequent fire incidents and structural failures in illegal constructions have endangered lives. Delhi falls in Seismic Zone IV, where earthquakes may be severe. Ensuring safety is a fundamental imperative, and safety is a basic human right. The city cannot afford unsafe buildings, irrespective of the type of development, land ownership or land use. Every building without a structural and fire safety certificate should be sealed, and a safety-related warning should be displayed. Various courts, commissions (such as those headed by G T Nanavati and Baleshwar Prasad), and high-level committees (such as the one headed by Tejendra Khanna) have underlined building safety, but with very little impact.

Delhi faces severe challenges from haphazard development and weak monitoring systems, resulting in inefficiencies, delays and loss of accountability. To combat this, the city introduced an online single-window system for building proposals. It used the Automated Development Control Regulations (Auto DCR) and Building Plan Approval Management System to verify mandatory documents. Once the documents are submitted, the system issues a scrutiny fee challan for online payment and sends an SMS informing the building inspector and architect with details of the site visit. These documents are then scrutinised for compliance with building bye-laws and development control (DC) rules. Auto DCR creates entities such as plots, building layouts, and roads from drawings derived from layers, geometrical mapping and reports. AutoCAD and other software are used to analyse the compliance of building plans with the DC Regulations, and the status is available online. These are examined for approval.

However, the reform has not been successful. Unauthorised constructions are left out, and the software needs to be updated to handle modern urban planning complexities, such as those related to redevelopment, green buildings, transit-oriented development and approvals under mixed land use.

It is time to consider whether the regulatory function of buildings can be made independent of the political apparatus and can be "demunicipalised". Building departments mainly deal with the plans they receive — massive illegal and risky constructions are left out. This calls for radical reforms to ensure that structures in informal settlements, urban villages and resettlement colonies receive attention. New technology can help. Geospatial AI with high-resolution satellite imagery and LiDAR can monitor and detect unauthorised construction. Spatial data-driven Real-Time Morphological Tracking can change the approval processes of building and layout plans and improve compliance with building bye-laws, the Fire Services Act, and land-use stipulations with minimum human interface, reducing corruption.

> Building departments mainly deal with the plans they receive — massive illegal and risky constructions are left out

The writer worked as commissioner (planning), Delhi Development Authority, and UN Habitat

40 YEARS AGO

September 9, 1986

INDIAN EXPRESS

Pinochet escapes bid on life

Death for hijackers if convicted: Zia

Extradition to US ruled out

Zia says death for hijackers

PRESIDENT ZIA-UL-HAQ has said that the four gunmen who hijacked a Pan Am jumbo jet would be hanged if convicted of murder and hijacking. "They will receive the punishment that such a crime deserves," he sais. Gen Zia said the hijackers would not be extradited to the US. He dismissed suggestions that the security forces had botched the operation by not storming the plane fast enough.

Pan Am death toll rises

THE DEATH toll in the Pan Am hijack rose to 19 as controversy over the bloody end to the siege continued and police launched a hunt for any accomplices of the hijackers. A hospital spokesman said another three people had died of wounds received when the four gunmen began spraying bullets around the darkened Boeing 747.

AFRICA Fund

THE ACTION for Resisting Invasion, Colonialism and Apartheid Fund (AFRICA Fund) that the non-aligned summit has decided to set up will have limited application. Even though leaders of non-aligned countries have rejected the appeal of the Libyan leader, Muammar Gaddafi, for armed support to frontline states, the proposed fund will be utilised to create a limited self-defence security system.

Pinochet escapes attack

THE CHILEAN President, Gen Augusto Pinochet, escaped with only a slight hand-wound when left-wing guerrillas attacked his motorcade last night with machine-guns, hand grenades and rockets. Five of his bodyguards were killed and six others wounded.

● WHAT THE OTHERS SAY

With thousands dead across Europe, it's time to recognise heatwaves as the major natural disasters they are.

— The Guardian

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A possible G3 is casting a shadow over BRICS

RAJA MANDALA

BY C RAJA MOHAN

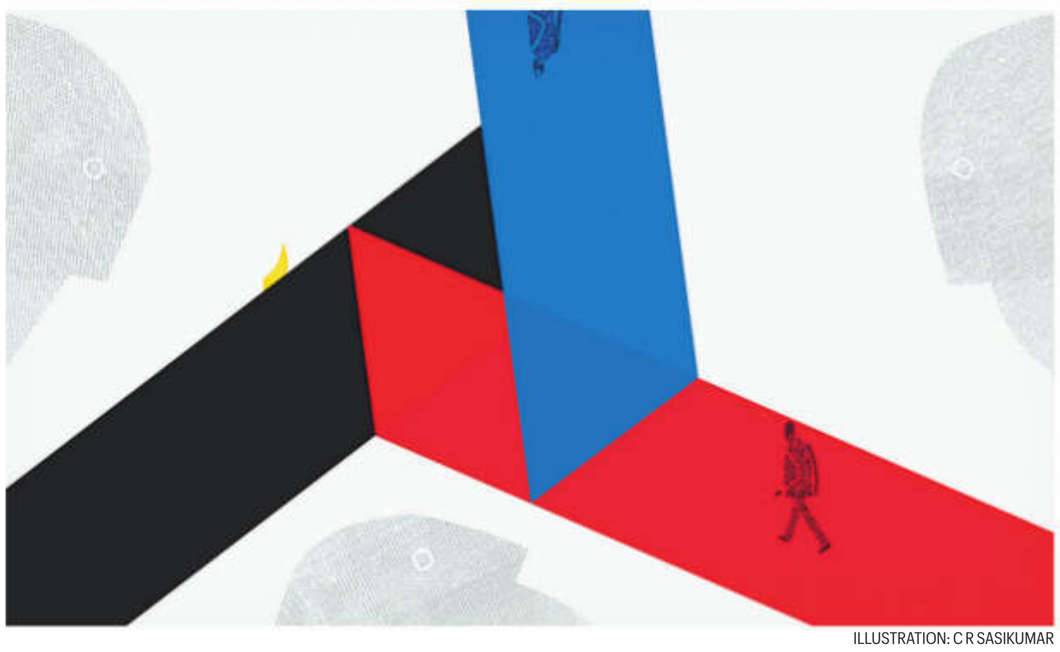

ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

WHEN ITS leaders meet in Delhi this week, BRICS will add more layers of cooperation, ranging from agriculture and health to digitalisation. While BRICS moves slowly, the larger political world around it is changing fast. Even as the forum seeks to counter American domination of the world, its principal driving forces, Russia and China, are exploring separate and joint accommodations with the United States.

International interest in the BRICS summit is less about the lengthy declaration it will produce. The last summit, in Rio de Janeiro, issued a declaration of 126 paragraphs but did not set the world on fire. In Delhi, the focus will be on the presence of leaders such as China's Xi Jinping, Russia's Vladimir Putin and Iran's Masoud Pezeshkian.

The Indian media will focus on Prime Minister Narendra Modi's bilateral meetings. Expect particular attention to his potential meeting with Xi, who is visiting India for the first time since 2019. The two leaders are expected to stabilise the boundary situation and reset economic relations.

BRICS may be the god of small things, but its problems with big issues are becoming harder. Its expansion has made it less coherent. The Iran war has opened a sharp divide between Tehran and Abu Dhabi, now fellow members of BRICS. Iran wants the grouping to condemn American and Israeli military action. The UAE, which has suffered Iranian attacks and disruption to commerce through the Strait of Hormuz, stresses sovereignty, the protection of civilian infrastructure and freedom of navigation. Their differences prevented the BRICS foreign ministers from issuing a consensual joint statement in Delhi in May.

Meanwhile, engagement among the US, China and Russia is entering a new phase and casting a shadow over BRICS. US President Donald Trump has long believed that good personal relations with Putin and Xi could reduce global strategic tensions and produce major political and economic deals.

That instinct has repeatedly encountered resistance from the American foreign-policy establishment, Congress and US allies. The Europeans worry that an accommodation with Moscow could be made at their expense. Asian allies fear that a bargain with Beijing could weaken American commitments to regional security. Trump has not yet transformed either relationship, but his preference for leader-driven diplomacy keeps the possibility of movement open.

Putin has reasons to explore a deal. Four-and-a-half years of war have not produced a decisive victory. The front remains costly and difficult to move. The latest shuttle diplomacy by American envoys between Moscow and Kyiv has reopened the diplomatic channel, but it is not clear whether the fundamental differences between Russia and Ukraine are narrowing. While supporting Trump's new peace initiative, both Moscow and Kyiv are also preparing for escalation.

> The Europeans worry that an accommodation with Moscow could be made at their expense. Asian allies fear that a bargain with Beijing could weaken American commitments to regional security

Unlike Putin, Xi approaches Washington from a stronger position. His diplomatic journey from the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit in Bishkek, through Cairo and Delhi, and then to the White House later this month will help present China simultaneously as the leader of the Global South and a co-equal manager of the international order.

At their second summit this year, Trump and Xi could emphasise an extension of the trade truce, additional Chinese purchases from the US and negotiations over technology restrictions. Yet their differences remain structural. Washington accuses China of relying on subsidised exports and industrial overcapacity. Beijing uses rare earths, market access and its control of important supply chains as leverage. Xi will continue to press Trump to reduce American support for Taiwan. Trump might be tempted to treat Asian security questions as part of a larger bargain with Xi.

Meanwhile, the Kremlin has confirmed that Putin and Xi discussed a possible trilateral meeting with Trump at the APEC summit in Shenzhen in November. For many, the idea of a "G3" will seem outlandish. But Trump has shown interest in it and explored the possibility of such a meeting last summer, during the 80th anniversary of the end of World War II.

A G3 global directorate is not imminent. Russia and China are closer than ever and share concerns about the US. But both also seek a reasonable relationship with Washington. For all their anti-Western rhetoric, both claim a place at the high table with the US.

Russia was once part of the G8, the group of Western industrial states, and engaged directly with NATO. China now sees itself as America's peer. Both Russia and China lay claim to shaping the global order established after 1945. A Trump-Xi-Putin summit could mark the beginning of triangular global leadership as a successor to the Yalta System that produced the UN Security Council and the five-power concert.

For an Indian strategic community that jumps at the thought of a G2, the idea of a G3 will generate even greater political anxiety. Despite promoting BRICS and celebrating multipolarity in partnership with Moscow and Beijing, Delhi might find itself excluded from the new three-cornered table.

There are three answers to a potential G3 world for India. The first is internal reform and accelerated economic development.

Second, Delhi should stop confusing multipolarity with anti-American bloc politics. Russia and China use BRICS to expand their diplomatic options while preserving the freedom to negotiate with Washington. India must approach the emerging order with the same realism.

Third, India must intensify its bilateral and minilateral cooperation with the Anglosphere, Brazil, Europe, Japan, Korea, and other middle powers that have no enthusiasm for a G3 world. As India's work in BRICS continues, its place in the changing global architecture will depend on how rapidly it builds national power and how deeply it develops partnerships beyond BRICS.

The writer is a contributing editor on international affairs for The Indian Express. *He is also associated with the Motwani Jadeja Institute of American Studies at the Jindal Global University and the Council on Strategic and Defence Research*

How to appoint judges: A view from South Africa

Z M YACOOB

THE PROMPT for this article came from the Supreme Court of India's judgment in *Arvind Malhotra v. High Court of Himachal Pradesh*. The verdict concerned the elevation of a high court judge to the Supreme Court. This can and should be done through a process that elevates experienced and competent judges who are not aligned with a particular political position or the government of the day.

In *Arvind Malhotra*, the applicant, an experienced judge of the Himachal Pradesh High Court, was aggrieved that a judge junior to him had been elevated to the SC in preference to him. He alleged that the appointee was seen as supporting the current government.

The SC judges were not sympathetic to the applicant. They pointed out that the high court collegium had recommended the elevation and that the apex court's collegium had approved the decision. The SC cautioned that confidentiality in the judicial appointment process was necessary to preserve its integrity. This reasoning inspired me to write this article.

I am a retired judge of the Constitutional Court of South Africa. I was also involved in the process that led to the drafting of South Africa's new constitution and advised the Constitutional Assembly on the appointment process for judges.

Here, judges at all levels are appointed, confirmed or recommended by a constitutional entity, the Judicial Service Commission (JSC). It consists of senior judges, lawyers and legal academics. Political parties have limited representation. There is nothing secret about the process. The proceedings are broadcast on national television and radio channels. Indeed, these broadcasts are extremely popular and avidly watched.

The process begins with calls for nominations by the commission, followed by the drafting of a short list. Public comments are sought on the candidates. An interview conducted in public determines their suitability for appointment to various levels of court. If the Commission's members cannot agree on who to appoint, the matter is put to a vote. The only aspect of these proceedings kept confidential is the identity of who votes for whom and who votes against a particular nominee.

Sometimes, during an interview, it becomes clear that a nominee is not competent, impartial or independent and, therefore, should not be appointed. This is because the nominees face tough scrutiny over their lifestyles, allegations against them, views they expressed as lawyers and, if they have served as judges, the quality of their work. Judges in South Africa do not enjoy special immunity. There have been cases of judges being accused of improper conduct. The JSC conducts an investigation and, if appropriate, a public enquiry is held. One example will suffice. A relatively senior high court judge was subjected to a public enquiry after a sexual harassment complaint. The proceedings were broadcast on radio and television. Ultimately, the JSC's Judicial Conduct Committee found him guilty of gross misconduct and recommended his impeachment (by parliament). The impeachment is still pending, but the judge has been suspended.

The first issue that arises from a comparison of the appointment and disciplinary processes in India and South Africa relates to transparency. Is openness the best approach, or should everything be cloaked in secrecy? I have a strong preference for transparency. A transparent process enables public and professional confidence in the system and is the key to preserving the very integrity that the Supreme Court of India refers to.

The second question relates to the appointing authority. Should it be a collegiate or a more representative structure reflecting society, political parties, the legal profession and judicial officers? Because judges perform a public function, the public must have confidence in the judiciary. An appointment process cloaked in secrecy cannot generate the respect essential for the proper execution of judicial functions.

The next matter is whether any complaint process against a judicial officer should be determined in an open public enquiry or in secret. Here too, I prefer South Africa's constitutional provision.

The final question is what should be done to fix the problem. Issues should be raised and debated publicly and fearlessly among lawyers, politicians, legal academics and the judiciary itself. An open and vigorous debate is a precursor to the judicial system's independence. It will not be an easy road to traverse. But it is essential for a truly democratic society.

The writer is a retired judge of the Constitutional Court of South Africa

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Restoring safety

THIS HORRIFIC tragedy is the latest in a long line of systemic failures ('Jantar Mantar to Satya Niketan: Join the dots', *IE*, September 8). In just a short span of five years, for example, hospital fires, stampedes, train accidents, water-inundated basements and more. There is a crying need to strengthen basic systems of planning, inspection, maintenance, regulation, emergency response and accountability in all areas, starting with urban living and transport. The *jugaad* we take so much pride in needs to be put to rest. Only then can we hope to see improvement on the ground.

Rahul Gaur, Gurgaon

THE TRAGIC loss of young lives to flooded basements, structural neglect and commercial greed is an unpardonable institutional failure ('Jantar Mantar to Satya Niketan: Join the dots', *IE*, September 8). Tragedies born of regulatory laxity and unchecked profiteering cannot be dismissed as accidents. Stringent accountability measures, rigorous safety audits for coaching hubs and structural reforms in higher education governance must be enforced.

Chavi Vohra, Delhi

Shame and sham

TENS OF thousands of students come to the capital city to give wings to their dreams ('What do we call these student deaths? "Accident" reeks of both shame & sham', *IE*, September 8). However, the recent incident involving the collapse of a boys' PG at Satya Niketan in Delhi has exposed the city's threadbare infrastructure, which is collapsing like a pack of cards by the day. Apparently, the triple-engine sarkar of the BJP is feckless despite its tall claims. Corruption is rampant, and the authorities concerned are delinquent, giving owners free rein to run their illegal PGs with impunity. Until and unless enforcement agencies are held accountable and perpetrators are given exemplary punishment, these unfortunate incidents will keep happening.

Aanya Singhal, Noida

The feminist flame she lit still burns

LAKSHMI PURI

GLORIA STEINEM'S greatest contribution to one of humanity's most vital and noble projects is that she called out injustices and kindled the fires of discontents. Most importantly, she gave us reason to make it into a global public good, not a partisan project, when she defined a feminist as one who recognises the equality and humanity of both women and men. She helped generations of women see patriarchy for what it is, to name it and challenge it. When I entered Lady Shri Ram College in 1970, second-wave feminism was in ferment. Kate Millett's *Sexual Politics*, Shulamith Firestone's *The Dialectic of Sex* and Germaine Greer's *The Female Eunuch* were unsettling inherited certainties. My generation of Indian women with feminist parents were assimilating these ideas and beginning to embody them.

In my chapter on feminism in *Delhi University, Celebrating 100 Glorious Years* (2022), I described "the three streams of feminism — liberal or mainstream feminism calling for more thorough integration of women into male-dominated power structures everywhere, radical liberalism calling for revolutionary revamping of society itself along with non-hierarchical and equitable reordering of organisation and politics and even the cultural or difference feminism which advocated valuing the distinct qualities of women". My parents defined their feminism as the Hindu belief in *nari shakti*, the Tridevis and Ardhanarishwar.

> I remember visiting her New York home, steeped in Indian art, artefacts and colours of sisterhood across continents

They never made us feel secondary, and my father presented me with Simone de Beauvoir's *The Second Sex* on my 15th birthday. Yet the one personality who fired my imagination the most was Steinem.

Her writings, speeches and clarion call to wage "a million mutinies every day in every way to assert their equal rights" made us brave — in our homes, in the university and in the wider world. Steinem showed how patriarchy had been normalised until inequality could masquerade as tradition. She helped women name structural discrimination, violence, unequal pay, political exclusion and denial of reproductive freedom. Bodily autonomy was foundational.

Serendipitously, India had entered Steinem's life before she entered mine. She came to India on a Chester Bowles Asian Fellowship, lived at Miranda House and travelled widely. Encounters with Gandhians and Indian women activists became part of her intellectual formation. India travelled into Steinem; years later, she travelled back to India through her ideas.

Yet Indian feminism was never merely a Western transplant. Alongside Beauvoir and Steinem stood Ahilyabai Holkar, Rani Lakshmibai, Savitribai Phule, Sarojini Naidu, Kamaladevi Chattopadhyay, and the legion of Indian women activists who led the Global South's *nari shakti* movements.

Four decades after LSR, life completed an extraordinary circle. As founding deputy executive director of UN Women, I spent seven years helping build up the UN's first consolidated global entity dedicated to gender equality and women's empowerment. Steinem strongly supported UN Women. She became almost a presiding spirit — a source of inspiration, validation, guidance and solidarity. I worked alongside my icon in our "Mission Possible" of gender equality and got to know her. I remember visiting her New York home, steeped in Indian art, artefacts and colours of sisterhood across continents. Inspired by her 1972 cover of *Ms.* magazine of a multi-armed multitasking Kali, I spoke to her about going beyond provoking outrage to weaponising good traditions that empower women in religion, culture and civilisational values.

Steinem lived long enough to see astonishing advances — and fierce reversals. Bodily autonomy is again contested, misogyny has acquired new megaphones and patriarchy has proved disturbingly inventive. Yet backlash cannot erase breakthroughs. Her place in history — and in the "herstory" she helped script — is undeniable. The fierce winds may buffet the flame she lit, but not extinguish it. It burns now in movements, institutions, laws and generations of women carrying the Mission Possible forward.

The writer is former assistant secretary general, United Nations, and former deputy executive director, UN Women

Disaster preparedness must put communities at centre

RANJAN DATTA

THE CATASTROPHE unfolding across Nepal is no longer only a national disaster. It is a warning for the Himalaya — and for mountain regions worldwide. Mountains store snow and ice, feed major rivers and sustain societies far beyond their slopes. From the Hindu Kush Himalaya to the Andes, Alps and Rocky Mountains, warming is altering glaciers, snowpack, permafrost and water flows. Environmental change in the highlands can cascade into downstream social, economic and health crises.

My perspective comes not only from studying disaster policy, but from fieldwork with disaster-affected communities in Nepal. I work directly with communities to understand lived impacts, recovery, preparedness failures and locally identified priorities. In Kharapani in the Pokhara Valley, I have sat with flood-affected elders, women, men and local leaders and listened to their experiences of the Seti River flood. They described a long relational disaster: Loss of relatives, homes, livestock and businesses, alongside grief, disrupted livelihoods and frustration with institutions. They also described inadequate warning, limited preparedness and delayed recovery support.

Yet communities were not rejecting science or technology. They wanted functioning warnings, local flood-information centres, communication technologies, rescue equipment and preparedness training. Their message applies across mountain regions: A warning that does not reach people, is not trusted, or is disconnected from evacuation and response plans cannot provide meaningful protection. My field research on earthquake recovery in Kathmandu points in the same direction. They are not merely victims waiting for experts; they are knowledge holders and leaders. Five responsibilities deserve urgent attention.

> My perspective comes not only from studying disaster policy, but from fieldwork with disaster-affected communities in Nepal

First, mountain hazards require transboundary monitoring and data sharing. Glaciers, rivers, landslides and flood pathways do not respect political borders. Nepal, India, China, Bhutan and other Himalayan countries need faster sharing of upstream observations, satellite information, river conditions and warnings. Scientific cooperation should be treated as life-saving regional infrastructure. Second, warnings must be community-centred. Sensors and models are only part of preparedness. Information must reach people in trusted languages and forms; warnings must be tested; communities must know where to go; and women, elders, youth and marginalised groups must have meaningful authority in preparedness decisions.

Third, preparedness must become a permanent public responsibility. Local information centres, evacuation plans, shelters, community response teams, health-system continuity and rescue equipment require sustained investment. Fourth, mountain development must become ecosystem-sensitive. Roads, tourism, hydropower and mining bring benefits, but poorly planned development can amplify exposure.

Fifth, mountain adaptation requires international climate responsibility. Nepal has contributed only a tiny share of historical emissions yet faces profound risks from a changing cryosphere. Climate finance, loss-and-damage support, scientific capacity and locally controlled adaptation are matters of justice, not charity.

The measure of preparedness is not simply whether we can see the next hazard coming. It is whether knowledge reaches people in time, communities have the authority and resources to act, and institutions remain accountable after the cameras leave.

The writer is Canada Research Chair in Community Disaster Research, Mount Royal University, Calgary, Canada

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• GLOBAL

Behind Nepal's compensation demand for devastating flood

EXPERT EXPLAINS

MANJEEV SINGH PURI
FORMER AMBASSADOR OF INDIA TO NEPAL

NEPAL HAS suffered a catastrophic flash flood, with more than 1,000 dead, thousands still missing nearly 10 days later, and whole villages, bridges and roads swept away. The impact appears to have been heightened as the Himalayas now stand much impacted by heavy infrastructure development by the Chinese in Tibet.

And then there is climate change.

The big emitters

The Himalayas are referred to as the third pole given their huge reservoirs of ice and water. For years, melting of their glaciers has been noticed, with climatologists warning of severe consequences.

The US is the leading contributor, at 25%, to the key cause of climate change, CO_2 accumulated in the atmosphere. Europe is next at around 20% with the Chinese now fast catching up at15% of the global stock. India's contribution, on the other hand is under 4%. Moreover, India's per-capita CO_2 emissions at around 2 tonnes per year are half of the global average of 4.5 tonnes.

After the floods, Nepal, whose own emissions are very little, said it is bearing the consequences of a problem it did not create.

• THE UN FUND

- The UN's loss and damage fund was set up in 2022 to help countries respond to economic hits from extreme events.
- Around $822 million has been pledged to this fund, but around $350 million is allotted for disbursement. Contributions are voluntary.

Aid vs compensation

Nepal's foreign minister, Shishir Khanal, said the country has written to the UN's fund for responding to loss and damage. It was set up in 2022 to help countries respond to economic hits from extreme events, in addition to financing mitigation and adaptation.

Khanal had earlier said that the Himalayan country had decided to shift its diplomatic position to claim 'compensation' for natural disasters instead of aid.

"Nepal's greenhouse gas emissions are virtually negligible. Yet, we are paying the ultimate price for a global crisis we did not create. The rapid melting of glaciers and these catastrophic mountain tsunamis are direct consequences of global climate change... This is not a matter of charity; it is a matter of legal and moral liability," Khanal had said.

He had also named India. "The major industrial emitters – such as China, which is the world's top emitter, the United States at number two, and India at number three – have a historical responsibility to compensate vulnerable nations like Nepal," he had said in an interview with *The Kathmandu Post*.

After Khanal's remarks, Nepal's Prime Minister, Balen Shah, quickly thanked India and China for their assistance in the aftermath of the floods. Khanal also walked back, later saying the issue was not about "shifting the blame to one or the other country" but about "working together".

The enormity of the rehabilitation ask makes it imperative for Nepal to access international funding. An approach of eschewing 'aid', the go-to of previous times, and instead seeking international solidarity fits in with the new Nepal with a young and globally aware government.

The US and China, as the largest emitters, seemed obvious inclusions in the compensation demand, but why India? To many, this appeared to follow the usual Nepali quest of balancing its two neighbours, India and China.

Status of the loss and damage fund

Around $822 million has been pledged to the UN's loss and damage fund, but around $350 million is allotted for disbursement.

The UAE has provided $100 million. Much of the other contribution has come from Europe.

• SCIENCE

Why a flat map fails to accurately depict Earth

There are many ways of portraying a 3-D shape on a 2-D surface, and each comes with tradeoffs. The new map adopted by the UN is no different

BHASKAR SARMA

THE UNITED Nations has adopted a resolution to shift away from the 16th-century Mercator map of the world towards one that more accurately depicts Africa's vast size.

At a recent UN General Assembly session, 164 countries (including India) voted to adopt the 2018 Equal Earth design — with the US voting against the Togo-led resolution, and six countries abstaining. Since UN resolutions are not binding, it remains to be seen if or when governments, organisations and classrooms adopt it.

The Mercator layout has been the world's most widely used projection for centuries. But it has also long been criticised for exaggerating the size of regions towards the poles relative to those closer to the equator. The most infamous example of these distortions is the depiction of the African continent, which appears similar to Greenland — an island 14 times smaller and about the size of the Democratic Republic of the Congo.

The 2018 Equal Earth design, developed by an international team of cartographers, has its own limitations. But its supporters say it will help reverse "colonial" perceptions of Africa.

No flat map can accurately portray the three-dimensional Earth. Every projection involves trade-offs, depending on its purpose.

The Earth is not a sphere

Earth is not a sphere, though it is sometimes treated as one to make mathematical calculations easier. It bulges in the middle due to its spin, the Moon's gravity warps it, and the continents and oceans distort the shape, Maj Gen (Dr) Siva Kumar Rachapudi (retd), a scientist who has served in the Department for Science and Technology, told *The Indian Express*.

Projection refers to the transformation of a three-dimensional space onto a two-dimensional map. There are many different types of projections, including conformal projections (which preserve angles); equal-area projections (which preserve areas, such as the newly adopted map); equidistant projections (which maintain distance); and compromise projections (balance distortions in area, shape, distance and direction rather than preserving any one of them exactly)

The Mercator layout is a conformal projection.

• WHICH PROJECTION TO PICK?

Choosing a projection depends entirely on the purpose of the map. According to Dr Siva Kumar, these are the ideal use-cases of different projections:

Equal Earth

THEMATIC AND STATISTICAL DATA
Use equal-area projections (like the Equal Earth map) which show correct relative sizes of landmasses, making them ideal for population density, climate, or land-cover maps.

Robinson

GENERAL REFERENCE AND WORLD MAPS
Use compromise projections, such as the Robinson projection or Winkel Tripel. They do not perfectly preserve any single dimension, but they balance shape and area distortion to create a visually natural view of the whole Earth.

NAVIGATION AND DIRECTION
Use conformal projections (like the Mercator projection). They preserve true angles and local shapes, allowing pilots and sailors to plot straight-line compass courses, though they severely distort high-latitude sizes.

POLAR OR SINGLE-POINT STUDIES
Use Azimuthal/Planar projections. They project the earth onto a flat plane from a central point, making them best for polar regions or flight-distance routes.

Origins of the Mercator projection

The Mercator layout was introduced by the Flemish (present-day Belgium) geographer and mapmaker Gerardus Mercator in 1569 to help sailors navigate the world.

It is a conformal, cylindrical map. This means Mercator projected the Earth's surface as if unwrapped from a cylinder around the globe.

So, if you drew a straight line from Mumbai to Muscat on a Mercator map, you could point your ship in the same compass direction throughout the journey and reach your destination. This was a major advantage over other map projections, where a constant-direction route would appear curved.

The Mercator's colonial lens

The Mercator projection has a grid pattern with longitudes and latitudes at 90-degree angles. The longitudes (vertical lines) are evenly spaced, but the distances between the latitudes (horizontal lines) increase as one moves away from the equator towards the poles.

This is deliberate. "To preserve shapes, the ratio of increase in the length of the parallels is kept exactly the same with respect to the increase in the length of the meridians," said Dr Bimal Kumar Kar, president of the Indian National Cartographic Association and former head of Gauhati University's geography department.

> **Mercator problem**
> The Mercator layout, the world's most widely used projection for centuries, has long been criticised for exaggerating the size of regions towards the poles relative to those closer to the equator.
> •
> For instance, the African continent appears similar in size to Greenland, an island 14 times smaller.

The result is that Mercator projection inflates the size of lands the farther they are from the equator. "Therefore, landmasses such as Greenland and Antarctica appear far larger than they actually are relative to landmasses near the equator," said Siva Kumar.

Mercator's projection helped Western cartographers easily mark towns, cities, and roads in their part of the world. "Its popularity also lies in its ease of construction, since all parallels and meridians are straight lines," said Kar.

This Western-centric view has come in for criticism.

"...if you're a humanist well versed in European imperialism's harsh imprint on the Third World, the traditional Greenwich-anchored world map becomes a clear example of Western cultural hegemony..." wrote cartography professor Mark Monmonier in his 2004 book *Rhumb Lines and Map Wars: A Social History of the Mercator Projection*.

The search for a better map

Every flat representation of the Earth distorts at least one property: area (how large a landmass is relative to others), shape (the true outline and appearance of a country), distance (the actual space between two points) and direction (the correct compass bearing from one location to another).

The one you pick depends on your purpose: representing data, navigation or general reference. This is why, as Kar cautions, one should not directly compare one type of map with another.

Attempts to create other projections began centuries ago.

In 1855, Scottish clergyman James Gall presented a new projection. In 1973, German historian Arno Peters unveiled a map that gained widespread attention. While it preserves area accurately, it makes landmasses look stretched or squashed. In 2017, schools in Boston introduced it.

In 1963, geographer Arthur H Robinson devised the Robinson projection which tried to better balance the sizes and shapes of land masses and sought to solve the "Greenland problem". It's a compromise projection, with meridians curving gently towards the poles.

In 1921, German cartographer Oswald Winkel devised the similar Winkel Tripel projection, seeking to reduce distortion across area, distance and direction. In 1998, it replaced the Robinson projection in world maps made by the National Geographic Society. Schools and textbooks followed, as did the World Bank. This is also a compromise projection.

The Equal Earth map

The Equal Earth map, developed in 2018, is an equal area projection that seeks to preserve the relative areas of landmasses. It, too, somewhat distorts shapes and distances, with meridians curving gently towards the poles.

"The Mercator projection heavily exaggerates regions closer to the poles, which visually diminishes the perceived scale of developing regions in the Global South, including South Asia. Equal Earth fixes this imbalance," said Siva Kumar.

But is the new map an improvement over previous maps such as the Robinson and Winkel Tripel? Kar said: "To me, it's nothing special. It has simply drawn attention by comparing itself with Mercator's projection, which was designed for a different purpose." But since it is an equal area map projection with limited shape distortion, it can be used by all categories of users, he said.

According to Siva Kumar, the Equal Earth map is best used to represent thematic and statistical data. "For classrooms and research, it provides a mathematically accurate depiction of area, which is vital for visualising population density, climate impacts, and resource distribution across the Indian subcontinent," he said.

• LEGAL

Inside India's problem with reporting child sexual abuse material

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, September 8

THE NATIONAL Human Rights Commission (NHRC) issued notices to two Union ministries and the Delhi Police last week over paid Instagram advertisements that allegedly used search terms like "rape video" and "child video" to direct users to Telegram channels offering child sexual abuse material (CSAM). It has directed for the Action Taken Report to be sent to the Commission within two weeks.

The notices flagged advertisements that had passed review systems of Meta, which owns Instagram, and remained available until they were brought to the company's attention.

What NHRC asked

The NHRC's order raised two questions: on whether statutory reporting obligations under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012, were complied with, and whether platforms whose AI systems actively shape content can continue to claim the legal protections available to intermediaries.

On compliance with statutory obligations, the NHRC has asked Meta whether alleged offences were reported, and if not, for it to identify those responsible for ensuring compliance. Section 19 of the POCSO Act mandates that any person "who has apprehension that an offence under this Act is likely to be committed or has knowledge that such an offence has been committed" shall report it to the Special Juvenile Police or the local police unit. This obligation, the NHRC states, "cannot be substituted by internal correspondence, grievance redressal or regulatory engagement".

A supplementary representation filed before the Commission argued that Meta's AI-assisted tools now does more than host third-party content, that is, the company's systems can generate captions, recommend posting schedules, optimise engagement, and assist monetisation. On this, the NHRC has asked the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting to examine whether such functions remain consistent with intermediary status, or whether they resemble the role of a publisher of online curated content under the IT Rules, 2021.

The limits of CyberTipline

- A CyberTipline report often identifies where CSAM was found, not where it originated — establishing that requires a separate investigation.
- The challenge is growing more complex as offenders increasingly use encrypted platforms and AI-generated content.

India's larger problem

The complaint against Meta lands inside a system that already struggles to convert reports into prosecutions. India received around 1.9 million CyberTipline reports — alerts that are generated when tech platforms detect suspected CSAM — in 2025. Yet only a fraction of these translate into police action.

According to Naresh Diwan of the Delhi Police Cyber Cell, the reports are processed by the National Crime Records Bureau and the Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre, and then routed and assigned to the relevant state and district authorities.

Before an FIR is registered, authorities conduct preliminary verification. But not every CyberTipline report progresses beyond this, as these reports vary significantly in quality and completeness.

Investigators assess whether the flagged material prima facie depicts CSAM. Once the jurisdiction is identified and the material verified, the case is forwarded to the local police station or cyber police unit.

One of the more recurring difficulties is verifying the age of the victim. Diwan said that poor image quality, blurred visuals, or uncertainty about age can present obstacles. Once an FIR is registered, investigators begin the process of identifying the individual behind the account.

Cases are generally tried before special courts designated under the POCSO Act. However, convictions depend heavily on the digital evidence. Experts say that defence arguments frequently focus on whether the accused was actually the person using the device, SIM card, or internet connection linked to the offence.

Where investigators are unable to identify the person responsible, police may file a closure report.

• CULTURE

Roots and rise of Gujarat's BAPS sect, at the centre of Eiffel Tower controversy

Leena Misra
Ahmedabad, September 8

THE GUJARAT-based Bochasanwasi Akshar Purushottam Swaminarayan Sanstha (BAPS) ran into controversy in Paris on Monday after the Eiffel Tower was closed following a staff protest. It stemmed from allegations that women employees were asked to step away from their posts during a visit by the sect's delegation. After the staff union said the women felt "humiliated", BAPS issued an apology.

Earlier on Sunday, Prime Minister Narendra Modi described BAPS' first major temple opening in France as a "new milestone in the cultural relations between India and France". A grand three-hour-long procession through central Paris preceded the temple's opening, with BAPS stating that nearly 6,000 participants attended.

History of celibacy practice

According to the book *Swaminarayan Hinduism*, edited by academics Raymond Brady Williams and Yogi Trivedi, the "enforcement of strict separation of men and women, especially during temple worship", is described as one of the "distinctive features of Swaminarayan Hinduism".

"These practices are followed differently by various orders and they are a part of the monk's personal spiritual journey. They are not meant to inconvenience or be imposed upon society, at least in practice", Trivedi, a New York-based scholar of religion, told *The Indian Express*.

He added that within the sect, only the swamis practice celibacy. "The community has also historically been known for practising the universal Hindu values of bhakti, seva and equality. Shri Swaminarayan and his community were known to advocate for women's equality and rights," he said. More than 50% of the fellowship consists of women devotees", his research shows.

Global influence

BAPS has built 1,300 temples worldwide, including the Akshardham temple complexes in Gandhinagar and Delhi. The BAPS Hindu Mandir in Abu Dhabi was inaugurated in 2024 by Mahant Swami Maharaj along with PM Modi and UAE Minister Sheikh Nahayan Mubarak Al Nahyan.

An idol consecration ceremony was held at France's first major BAPS temple in Paris. PTI

Believed to have five million followers among Gujaratis alone, the sect has a huge following in East Africa, the UK and the US. Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel visited the Robbinsville Akshardham temple in New Jersey last month.

In 2022, PM Modi inaugurated the month-long centenary celebrations of Pramukh Swami Maharaj, the fifth spiritual successor. The celebrations were so grand that an entire "city" was built on 600 acres of land on Ahmedabad's outskirts. The sect's influence is also evident in the Paris temple, which involved collaboration with French firms, including stone specialists H Chevalier, who worked on the restoration of the Notre-Dame Cathedral.

According to a chapter in *Swaminarayan Hinduism* co-authored by Swami Vivekjivandas, a prominent BAPS monk, "BAPS followers were part of the migration from Gujarat to East Africa". Patidars, among the first migrants from Gujarat, thus constitute a large following of the sect.

BAPS is known for its involvement in disaster relief, including the 2001 Kutch earthquake. In September 2002, the Akshardham temple in Gandhinagar saw a terror attack that killed 33 people.

Splits in sect

Founder of the Swaminarayan Sampraday, Sahajanand Swami was born Ghanshyam Pande in Chhapaiya village near Ayodhya in 1781. He founded the Swaminarayan sect in Gujarat after being initiated in 1802 as a disciple of Swami Ramanand.

The late historian Makrand Mehta once observed that Gujarat, being "comparatively prosperous and religion-oriented, attracted a large number of aspiring saints to establish their careers."

Seen as one of Hinduism's many bhakti traditions and as reestablishing "Sanatan dharma", the sampraday then branched out into the Vadtal (Nadiad) and Ahmedabad sects (Gadi), founded by two of Sahajanand Swami's nephews. Sahajanand Swami was celibate, but the Acharyas of the Ahmedabad Gadi marry and follow a dynastic leadership tradition, while their sadhus practice celibacy.

In his book *A New Face of Hinduism: The Swaminarayan Religion* (1984), Williams calls Sahajanand Swami "a reformer" who "forged a new form of Hinduism well suited for the modern period."

Shastri Maharaj founded BAPS in 1907 after breaking away from the Vadtal diocese. It takes its name from Bochasan village in Anand district and is said to be the largest sect. The Vadtal diocese believes it is the parent body from which at least six splinter groups were formed, most of which believe in Sahajanand's supremacy.

In the late 1960s, the sect split again when a group of disciples, led by Hariprasad Swami, wished to initiate women disciples into the fold, going against tradition. The then-BAPS guru, Yogiji Maharaj, refused, and Hariprasad went on to form the Sokdha sect in 1966.

The 92-year-old Mahant Swami Maharaj is the sixth spiritual successor of Swaminarayan and the present guru of BAPS.

'PERHAPS WE SHOULDN'T DISMISS GDP DATA BECAUSE IT DOESN'T CONFORM TO PRIOR EXPECTATIONS'

'Surprised by furore over GDP; methods, data already public'

According to MoSPI Secretary Saurabh Garg, any comparison between the old and new GDP series is "unwarranted"

Siddharth Upasani & Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, September 8

THE ONGOING furore over the new GDP series is surprising as it comes six months after it was originally released, said Saurabh Garg, Secretary, Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI). Garg further said the old numbers — that have now been revised down — should not be termed overestimates.

"Saying overestimation gives the impression that there was a systematic bias. That's alluding a bit much," Garg told *The Indian Express* in an interview. "...it's not an overestimation. GDP is an estimation and you make estimations based on the best data available. When the 2011-12 and 2004-05 series were estimated, certain indicators were used and later changed, leading to better estimates. Now you have even better estimates."

On August 31, MoSPI released GDP data for the first quarter of 2026-27, which showed growth was 7.8%, well above what most economists had anticipated. According to Garg, this higher-than-expected growth print may be the reason for the criticism.

"Maybe my sense is that no one expected a 7.8% number. When your a priori assumption does not meet the data, and the data is showing that there is no reason to doubt the numbers, perhaps we should not dismiss the GDP data simply because it does not conform to prior expectations."

When asked about comments that India's rapid growth is not being 'felt' on the ground, Garg argued that while GDP is an important indicator, there are "other factors, uncertainties, the global situation" which determine how each individual 'feels' about economic indicators.

"It's like someone mentioning 'We don't feel the inflation, we feel inflation (rate) should be higher'. So, individually, how you see the prices might be different from when they are aggregated across the country

Saurabh Garg. MoSPI

and across different areas," he said. Pointing to several high-frequency, or monthly, consumption and production indicators such as those for steel, cement, electricity, and automobiles, Garg said any comparison between old series and new series was "unwarranted". The new GDP series is built on a wider set of indicators and surveys which provide a more comprehensive picture of the economy. This, he said, makes the new series the best so far.

"Every series, at that time, is the best series. There is no doubt (that the new series is the best) because we are using the best available data," Garg said, adding that the last 10 years have seen numerous new data sources. This is unlikely to be repeated in the next five years or so when the next GDP base revision is done.

"Earlier, Goods and Services Tax, Periodic Labour Force Survey, Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE), and Public Financial Management System were not there... Digital data like e-Vahan was not there."

Dismissing the criticism from former Chief Economic Advisor Arvind Subramanian that MoSPI does not have good and timely data on the informal economy, Garg said ASUSE and PLFS figures, not proxies, are being used even for quarterly GDP estimates. While released in February 2026, the new GDP series has come under fire from various quarters, sparked by comments from former finance secretary Subhash Chandra Garg that the 7.8% real growth rate in April-June was only possibly because of a reduction in the year-ago GDP data. According to Subhash Chandra Garg, nominal GDP growth in April-June should have been 2.6%, and not 10.3%, and real growth close to zero. He arrived at these numbers after comparing data from the old and new GDP series.

Calling this debate "unnecessary", MoSPI Secretary Garg said he cannot think of any reasonable criticism of the new GDP data as the government had "made the best use of data, digital data, and surveys".

The primary reason for the downward revision in nominal GDP in previous years, he said, is the transition from proxy-based estimates in old series to direct, empirical annual surveys for the informal sector in the new series. Rejecting criticism that MoSPI has not disclosed various aspects and methods of calculating the new GDP series, Garg said all the relevant data and technical issues were made public months ago and the keenly-awaited 'Sources and Methods' document would only be a compilation.

The new IIP series was released in May and output PPI data starting 2022-23 was made public in June. Before that, in February, MoSPI had released three reports by sub-committees of the Advisory Committee on National Accounts Statistics. These reports were on 'Methodological Improvement for the Base Revision of GDP', 'Constant Price Estimates', and 'Incorporation of New Data Sources, Rates and Ratios'.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Nifty, Sensex hit 3-month low as high crude prices spook investors

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, September 8

THE INDIAN stock market fell to a near 3-month low on Tuesday as heightened turmoil in West Asia, rising crude oil prices and a busy IPO market kept the secondary market under pressure.

On Tuesday, the National Stock Exchange's (NSE) Nifty 50 index ended the session at 23,635.10, down 144.05 points or 0.6%. The BSE's Sensex closed down 0.7% at 75,577.58. Following a rally of around 4.2% in around a week till August 3, the benchmark indices have since fallen 4.6%.

"The most important reason is liquidity. The renewed conflict has led to higher crude prices that have spooked foreign players, so they are not investing much. And the IPO market continues to boom, which has sucked away a lot of liquidity from the secondary market to the primary market," said G Chokkalingam, founder of Equinomics Research.

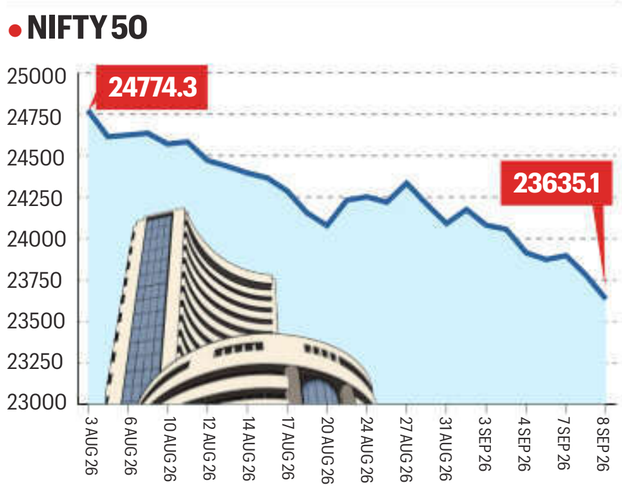
Global crude oil prices have spiked again to just below the $100-a-barrel mark, the highest since late July, as tensions between the US and Iran have intensified. After the US military struck Iranian oil tankers over the weekend, Iran threatened "economic warfare" against their American counterparts.

Since India is a massive importer of crude oil, higher crude prices due to the war put pressure on the rupee, and a weaker rupee then makes crude more expensive. The Indian currency ended Tuesday at 94.81 against the dollar, down 0.35% from its previous close. The fall was reportedly limited by intervention from the Reserve Bank of India. While benchmark indices were in the red on Tuesday, the mid- and small-cap space saw some gains. Performance was mixed at the sectoral level, with sectors such as banking and financial services, and oil and gas losing up to 1%, while healthcare, pharmaceuticals, and auto ended higher.

The IPO market has gained momentum, as at least 34 companies are looking to collectively raise around Rs 45,000 crore before their regulatory approvals expire at the end of this month. At least 12 issues are set to start or have already opened this week, looking to raise around Rs 8,000 crore. Reports also suggest that NSE's record Rs 30,000 crore issue is likely to be completed by this month. Such strong momentum in the IPO market attracts capital from both institutional and retail investors, who may divert funds that could otherwise have gone into the secondary market, either directly or through investment vehicles such as mutual funds or alternative investment funds.

This has raised concerns about a temporary liquidity squeeze in the secondary market.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM



SOURCE: NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE

Tata Trusts gets more time in Mehli Mistry case; hearing on Oct 15

George Mathew
Mumbai, September 8

THE CHARITY Commissioner of Maharashtra has given Tata Trusts time until October 15 to present their arguments on objections raised by former trustee Mehli Mistry concerning change reports recording his exit from three Tata trusts, alleged governance lapses and the eligibility of certain trustees of the Bai Hirabai Trust.

The matter was listed for hearing on Tuesday and has now been deferred as the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) sought more time citing the exit of trustee Vijay Singh.

Mistry resigned as a trustee of three trusts last October after their boards voted not to renew his appointments.

In a separate matter, Mistry has challenged the eligibility of certain trustees of the Bai Hirabai Trust. The trusts' lawyers, however, maintained that Vijay Singh is no longer a trustee, as he chose not to seek another term when his tenure expired on August 14.

The dispute traces back to Mistry's departure from the trusteeship after his term was not renewed. A longtime Tata group insider and close associate of the late Ratan Tata, Mistry's exit has since evolved into a wider controversy, with allegations touching on the governance of certain Tata trusts, potential conflicts of interest and the manner in which trustees are appointed.

Mistry has raised a series of questions before the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner, ranging from compensation and commissions received by certain trustees from Tata group companies to potential conflicts of interest arising from trustees simultaneously holding positions on the boards of group entities. Apart from questioning his own removal from the Sir Ratan Tata Trust, Mistry raised issues of governance and decision-making within the philanthropic institution.

In filings submitted to the regulator in June, Mistry has questioned trustee appointments, board-level decisions, remuneration arrangements, and governance practices across the Tata Trusts ecosystem. A key theme of Mistry's argument relates to the fiduciary responsibilities of trustees overseeing charitable institutions. He has sought an examination of whether remuneration and other benefits received by trustees from Tata group companies are consistent with those obligations. The filings further contend that compensation earned by trustees in their capacity as nominees of charitable trusts should accrue to the trusts themselves rather than be retained by individual trustees. Mistry argued that the trustees of SRTT and the SDTT had unanimously passed a resolution on October 17, 2024, to renew the tenure of existing trustees in order to ensure continuity following the death of Ratan Tata.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Govt gets 7 applications for coal gas scheme, three from Adani

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, September 8

ADANI ENTERPRISES Limited has emerged as the most prominent applicant in the first round of the government's flagship Rs 37,500-crore scheme to promote surface coal and lignite gasification projects, with three of the seven projects belonging to the company.

Other private sector applicants include Gallantt Ispat Limited and Shyam Sel & Power Limited which have applied for financial support under the scheme for one project each. State-owned NTPC Limited and Talcher Fertilisers Limited, a joint venture of four state-run companies — GAIL, Coal India Limited (CIL), Rashtriya Chemicals and Fertilizers Limited (RCF) and Fertilizer Corporation of India Limited (FCIL) — have also applied for one project each.

According to the Ministry of Coal, all three projects submitted by Adani Enterprises are for setting up coal-to-urea gasification plants. Talcher Fertilisers has also proposed a coal-to-urea project, while Gallantt Ispat's project will produce direct reduced iron (DRI) and syngas. NTPC and Shyam Sel & Power have proposed projects for producing synthetic natural gas (SNG) and syngas, respectively.

The applications received in the first round will now undergo a detailed evaluation in accordance with the scheme guidelines and the Request for Proposal (RFP), the ministry said. The government has also opened the second round of the scheme from Tuesday (September 8).

The applications received in the first round will now undergo a detailed evaluation. REUTERS

"In accordance with the RFP, the application windows will continue to open at two-month intervals, providing regular opportunities for eligible entities to participate. Several prospective applicants are presently at advanced stages of project preparation and are expected to submit proposals in forthcoming rounds," it added.

The scheme was approved by the Union Cabinet in May, following which the RFP was issued in July.

The Rs 37,500-crore scheme seeks to incentivise 25 projects for production of syngas and downstream products, targeting gasification of approximately 75 million tonne (mt) of coal/lignite.

The new scheme is an addition to the existing viability gap funding scheme worth Rs 8,500 crore approved in 2024 for incentivising coal and lignite gasification projects.

As per the government, eight gasification projects are already under implementation under the earlier scheme.

While announcing the new scheme in May, the government had said the projects under the scheme will be selected through a transparent and competitive bidding process. Under the scheme, financial incentive will be provided at a maximum of 20% of the cost of plant and machinery to be disbursed in four equal installments.

Financial incentive for any single project capped at Rs 5,000 crore; for any single product (except Synthetic Natural Gas and Urea) capped at Rs 9,000 crore; and any single entity group capped at Rs 12,000 crore across all projects.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Expand UPI's global reach, says PM

ENS Economic Bureau
Mumbai, September 8

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi on Tuesday called on the country's fintech ecosystem to connect the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) with systems in other nations and lower remittance costs for diaspora.

The PM also observed that the next chapter for the Indian fintech industry should be non-payment transactions including quality cybersecurity solutions and ethical data protection standards.

Speaking at the inauguration of the 7th edition of the Global Fintech Fest the PM observed that the focus should be on countries with large Indian populations, are among India's big trading partners or are willing to partner with us while connecting the systems.

"This is essential because Indians work in large numbers in foreign countries. They are the largest remitters of money. A part of the remittances goes away as transaction costs; UPI can help in saving on these costs and the money can also reach families faster," PM Modi said. FE

Rupee sees sharpest fall in two months

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, September 8

SOARING CRUDE oil prices rattled the markets Tuesday, leaving the rupee weaker after a three-week rally.

The surge in oil prices — after Yemen's Iran-aligned Houthis attacked four cities in the south of Saudi Arabia — revived concerns over India's import bill and inflation, even as a stronger dollar added to the pressure on the rupee.

The rupee, which logged its sharpest fall since late-July ended the session at 94.83 against the dollar, down 34 paise from its previous close, according to Bloomberg. The currency had gained about 1% in the preceding seven days.

Brent crude prices rose as high as $99.5 a barrel intra-day before easing a little to settle over $98 as hostilities in West Asia intensified after the Houthi forces attacked Saudi energy facilities. FE

Singapore defends flag carrier's Air India bet

Reuters
Singapore, New Delhi, Sept 8

SINGAPORE'S GOVERNMENT defended Singapore Airlines' stake in Air India on Tuesday, saying the flag carrier must expand overseas to grow and the investment's outcome was for the company and its shareholders to judge.

The remarks, made in parliament, cap two weeks of public scrutiny over a request by Air India for about $1.5 billion of fresh equity from owners Tata Sons and Singapore Airlines that was first reported by *Reuters*. An opposition lawmaker objected to using any funds from Temasek, the state investor that majority-owns Singapore Airlines, to back the Indian carrier. Temasek then publicly supported Singapore Airlines, which holds a 25.1% stake in Air India.

Responding to a question in parliament, the country's Transport Minister Jeffrey Siow said the flag carrier was a listed company that funds investments from its own balance sheet and it had not sought further capital from shareholders.

BRIEFLY

DoT panel approves TRAI suggestions on satcom spectrum

New Delhi: The Digital Communications Commission, the top decision-making body at the Department of Telecom, has approved most of the recommendations made by sector regulator TRAI to allocate spectrum for satellite communications services, according to sources. Starlink, Bharti Group-backed Eutelsat OneWeb and Reliance Industries Ltd's Jio Satellite Communications have received permission to start satcom services in India. PTI

CCI closes real money games-related case against Google

New Delhi: The Competition Commission on Tuesday closed a case against Google related to real money games citing "exceptional developments", including the implementation of the Online Gaming Act. In 2022, Winzo Games Pvt Ltd filed a complaint against Google alleging restrictions for Real Money Games (RMG) on Google Play and about advertisement policy, among others. The CCI in 2024 ordered a detailed probe into the matter. PTI

ANALYSTS EXPECT FOLDABLE IPHONE TO COST MORE THAN $2,500

New Apple CEO faces AI test as foldable iPhone hogs limelight

Reuters
San Francisco, September 8

WHEN NEW CEO John Ternus unveils Apple's latest products on Wednesday, Wall Street expects him to show that the company can still deliver breakthrough hardware and a Siri virtual assistant capable of competing in the AI race.

Analysts expect Apple to announce at its Cupertino, California, headquarters a new iPhone that folds open like a passport. They said it could quickly emerge as the category leader in the nascent folding phone market, despite an expected price of more than $2,500 and having cameras and processors that may not lead the market. The company has already announced a deep overhaul of Siri — in part by tapping Google's AI tech behind the scenes — and that may prove to be Ternus' first big success after years of delays.

A successful revamp by the end of this year could give Apple a good chance of pulling even with longtime rival Google's Gemini assistant, analysts said.

Investors have largely looked past Apple's slow start in generative AI because of the company's billion-plus device installed base and loyal customer base.

Ternus now faces pressure to convince consumers that Apple's devices are the best way to use AI, which could determine whether he inherits former CEO Tim Cook's momentum or plays catch-up.

CEO John Ternus will unveil latest products on Wednesday. REUTERS

NEW PREMIUM IPHONES

Apple is expected to update its premium iPhone Pro and Pro Max devices but hold off on refreshing the iPhone Air and the base and budget lines until spring. The aim is to drive interest in the real star of this week's show, the folding phone.

"Even with a $2,500 price tag, the Apple foldable is going to fly off the shelves, especially because Apple is excellent at creating an aura of exclusivity, luxury, and scarcity," Nabila Popal, senior research director at IDC, told *Reuters*.

Popal expects the phone to generate more than $45 billion in revenue for Apple by the end of next year, even as foldables overall remain a single-digit share of the phone market. The main appeal of a folding phone is the sheer newness after nearly two decades of candybar-style phones. While Samsung , Google and China's Huawei have sold folding phones since 2019, analysts expect Apple to benefit from entering late by solving key engineering challenges, such as a hinge that feels sturdy over thousands of uses and minimizing any crease in the screen when the device is open.

"They've seen what has worked and what hasn't worked with their competitors," said Anshel Sag, an analyst at Moor Insights & Strategy who has tested many folding devices.

NEW SIRI's BIG MOMENT

Ternus' key challenge will be persuading customers to adopt the new Siri and convincing them and third-party developers that Apple can keep pace with rivals such as OpenAI, which roll out big improvements every few weeks, while Apple has traditionally moved more slowly.

"If Siri still sucked, then he would have a much more difficult Wednesday," said Carolina Milanesi of Creative Strategies.

MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▲	US Dollar ▲
75,577.58	23,635.10	₹1,53,077	₹94.83
-555.23	-144.05		
-0.73%	-0.61%		
		Silver ▲	Oil ▲
		₹2,33,826	$106.26

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF SEPTEMBER 7, 2026

The photograph found in Betrawati. (Back row, from left) Chini Maya carrying a relative's child, her daughter-in-law Sunita, son Nirmal, daughter Srijana. In the front row are Nirmal's children Sakshi (blue dress), and Samriddhi

THE FAMILY IN THE PHOTOGRAPH

Days after the August 26 flood, *The Indian Express* team in Nepal spotted a rare spot of colour amid the gloom — a family of seven in a photograph from 2009. DEVANSH MITTAL and photographer TASHI TOBGYAL go looking for their stories

IF DESTRUCTION had a colour in Nepal, it would be the colour of mud. The muddy Trishuli that crashed down on homes and people, the buildings torn apart and caked with mud all the way up to the fourth floor, the trees with their exposed roots choked with shredded and clumped clothes, all covered in mud. And then, a dash of colour — a family of seven staring out of a photograph, smiling, joyous.

We found the photograph at the foot of a tree. It was the only sign of life in Betrawati, a village around 80 km north of Kathmandu that was among the hardest hit by the flash floods that struck the country on August 26. Most people here were either on the list of the dead or missing, or had left for relief camps or the homes of their relatives in the higher reaches. We took photographs of that moment and moved on.

The smiles in the photograph stayed. It's the only time since we arrived that we had seen smiles that weren't wistful or painful. The questions remained, too. Who could the family be? Were they still together? Had time, and distances, done what they do to relationships? Had the flood separated them? Where were the children? The ones in the foreground, in the red and blue dresses, with matching hair-bands? The matriarch in the back row?

The date on the photograph said July 1, 2009. There was little to go by.

The search for a family of seven

Four days later, we returned to Betrawati to look for the family.

A two-wheeler ride on the highway that usually takes less than two hours from Kathmandu took us more than six hours, as our SUV lumbered through backcountry trails of mud and stones, weaving through forests and mountain routes.

Betrawati, a village split between Nuwakot and Rasuwa districts in central Nepal, stands on the confluence of the mighty Trishuli and the gentler Falakhu river. It is home to the Uttar Gaya temple, a holy pilgrimage site for people from Nepal and India. The historical 1792 Treaty of Betrawati, which ended the war between Nepal's Gorkha Kingdom and China's Qing Dynasty, was signed here.

Little had changed at Betrawati since our last visit. Only a few buildings stood in what seemed like a vast ocean of mud. Remnants of life had been washed up onto the terrace fields where villagers once grew maize and paddy — mangled trees, a school bag, a stray slipper, pillow covers, a mannequin. An auto rickshaw was lodged precariously high on one of the trees that still stood, its twisted canopy holding the vehicle along with boulders and large portions of concrete walls. A school bus now stood nose-down in the mud.

An eerie silence had settled over what was once a bustling pilgrimage destination. Only the hiss of the muddied river as it flowed nearby, and the muffled conversations of the few police personnel on duty with their sniffer dogs, hoping to find signs of life in the rubble. The only other people were those looking for their family members. They walked around with heads lowered, eyes scanning the slush and the debris. Like us, all of them held a photograph or two, asking anyone they encountered if they had seen the people they were looking for.

According to Nepal's Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority, as of September 8, 5,326 people remain missing since the floods, and 1,357 are confirmed dead.

On the road leading to the village, we waved down a few cars and motorbikes and asked about the photo, but got no leads. Enquiries at a few open shops yielded no results. Then, someone suggested that we go to the relief camp a little down the hill, where some villagers had taken shelter.

The camp, with a dozen blue and green tents, had been set up by Chinese relief organisations on what used to be paddy terrace fields. It now sheltered around 70 people who had fled from neighbouring villages.

We approached a group of older men sitting in a circle and smoking. They shook their heads as they passed around the photograph we had printed. Our hopes sank. As we were making our way out, stopping every now and then with the photograph, someone exclaimed from behind, "Chini Maya."

Social worker Ishwar Thapa Magar, 40, it turned out, was a relative of the family. Taking a closer look at the photograph and pointing to the elderly woman in the back row, Magar said, "This is Chini Maya."

The photograph suddenly came alive. China Maya Thapa Magar, then 51, shared the frame with her daughter Srijana, son Nirmal, daughter-in-law Sunita, granddaughters Sakshi, 10, and Samriddhi, 8, and a relative's baby.

Everyone was safe, it turned out. Except Chini Maya, 68. She was missing.

A festival and a group photo

At a cafe in Tokha, on the outskirts of Kathmandu, Chini Maya's granddaughter Samriddhi, now 25, says, "My grandmother hung this photograph on the wall by her bed. I remember the day it was taken."

October 9, 2009, was a busy day at Chini Maya's house, which stood on the other side of the Trishuli river in Rasuwa district. It was the festival of Dashain, one of the biggest festivals in Nepal, a variation of the Dussehra celebrations in India. Her son Nirmal Pyakurel and his family had come down from Kathmandu to celebrate the festival.

The women were racing against time for the morning puja. Srijana, Chini Maya's daughter, then unmarried, and daughter-in-law Sunita were cleaning and decorating the house, while Chini Maya supervised a simmering pot of *khasi ko masu* (goat curry). Sakshi, in a blue Chinese silk dress, and Samriddhi, in a blood red one, had got into a fight over their eyeliners.

Everyone was in their best clothes, except Chini Maya, who was still fussing over the *khasi* curry. An uncle asked them to assemble for a group photo. Nirmal wore a pair of sunglasses, and Srijana put a strand of *gajra* in her hair. Sakshi and Samriddhi ended their fight just in time and managed to smile. Chini Maya, still in her nightie, picked up Siyana, a relative's child whose family was visiting them. The family assembled on the street outside their house and the uncle clicked the photo on a cyber-shot camera. The camera, however, got the date wrong: 1.7.2009, said the photo when it was finally printed.

Afterwards, the families of Chini Maya's sisters as well as other relatives and friends came over, and everyone had a good time eating goat curry, drinking Chini Maya's home-brewed *raksi*, and playing rounds of the card game *teen patti*.

At the camp in Betrawati, 60-year-old Dil Bahadur Magar, who is from the nearby village of Kuvindi, says Chini Maya's father used to run the village flour mill and the family had a prominent house.

"I remember going to their house to get our grains cleaned and sifted," says Dil Bahadur.

The family had eight daughters, so the girls, including Chini Maya, "grew up like boys". Chini Maya, the third of the siblings, never went to school, but learnt to be useful around the house, cutting grass for the cattle and collecting firewood.

She married at 21, but her marriage didn't last. She later built a three-storeyed house by the river and ran small businesses — a utensils shop on the ground floor and rooms for rent on another floor. She would generously hand out her home-brewed *raksi*, but also sold some part of it.

Chini Maya's granddaughter Samriddhi says she has always known her grandmother and her sisters to be fiercely independent — "at times, even aggressive".

She recalls an incident from the 2000s, when the country was under Maoist rule. "Soldiers used to bully villagers a lot those days. Once, at a weekly market in our village, my grandmother got furious when she saw a soldier hitting a villager, so she chased him across the bridge, entered the bus he had fled into, brought him out and thrashed him in public, before the villagers calmed her," says Samriddhi, who works as a Class 3 teacher while also pursuing a postgraduate degree in sociology.

Samriddhi's mother Sunita, who lives in Japan with her elder daughter Sakshi, spoke to *The Indian Express* from Tochigi prefecture about how Chini Maya's house in Betrawati was a huge draw. "All her children and grandchildren, as well as her sisters and their families, used to gather at her place during festivals. Local politicians would come to her house to eat the fish she cooked and discuss village matters. Her house was where everything happened since it was so large and she loved cooking for everyone," says Sunita Onta Shreshtha of her mother-in-law.

In 2017, Sunita, her husband Nirmal and elder daughter Sakshi, moved to Japan, where they did a series of odd jobs. Two years later, Nirmal moved back to Betrawati to take care of his mother Chini Maya. Sakshi, now 27, works as a tattoo artist in Japan.

Talking to *The Indian Express* from her home in Jackson Heights, New York, Chini Maya's daughter Srijana Deuja, now 40, says her mother and the rest of the family shared a special relationship with the Falakhu river that's barely 100 metres from the house.

"When Sakshi and Samriddhi were young and came visiting from Kathmandu, they would spend all their time by the river, swimming and making mud houses on the banks," says Srijana, who works in a beauty salon.

Samriddhi remembers those holidays by the river fondly. "It used to flood then too, but we were never scared. Floods just meant more fish to catch and cook," she says.

Day of the flood, afterwards

Days before the August 26 flood, five of Chini Maya's sisters had come to Betrawati for the festival of Gain Jatra.

That day, Samriddhi says, Chini Maya's nephew called from Kathmandu and alerted the family of a massive flood that was coming their way. The nephew once worked at a hydropower project, so he knew what he was talking about. Chini Maya shouted out to her son Nirmal, who was on the floor below, and told him to run. Nirmal ran out, believing his mother, aunts and their elderly domestic help were behind him.

Minutes later, a barrage of water and debris thundered down the Trishuli, surging into the Falakhu. Within minutes, the valley witnessed something unprecedented: a whirlpool of brown water, boulders, and debris, four storeys high, stood churning where the two rivers met.

Samriddhi says that when Nirmal finally reached higher ground, he looked around for the rest of the family. His mother and their help was missing.

Days later, Chini Maya's house in the village, though battered, is among the few that still stand. The ground floor is buried under mud. The room on the first floor, where the fridge would always be stocked with her famous *raksi*, is now bare and knee-deep in mud. Only the ceiling fan, its wings twisted out of shape, remains. A mangled bike has made its way to the second floor, deposited there by the waves.

Days after the tragedy, with no trace of Chini Maya, the family had to make the difficult decision of carrying out her last rites. They had spent the last few days scouring websites with lists of survivors, the missing, and the unidentified dead.

Despite that, says Samriddhi, she hopes her grandmother will turn up one day at Betrawati, walk up to her house by the river. "When you called and asked about Chini Maya, I thought for a minute that she had been found," she tells us.

Samriddhi says Chini Maya knew the river better than most people. "She used to say, '*Dui phan ma khola paari pugchu* (In two jumps, I'll cross the river).' She would also say, '*Moh maareyo bhani, khola ma morchu* (When I die, the river will take me)."

(Clockwise from above) Samriddhi, second from left, with a copy of the family photograph; Chini Maya's blue-and-white house, with the green water tank on top, stands battered by the floods; social worker Ishwar Thapa Magar, who identified Chini Maya from the photograph, at the Betrawati camp

> **Chini Maya's children and grandchildren, as well as her sisters and their families, would gather at her place during festivals. Local politicians would come to her house to eat the fish she cooked. Her house was where everything happened since it was so large and she loved cooking for everyone**
>
> SUNITA ONTA SHRESHTHA
> CHINI MAYA'S DAUGHTER-IN-LAW
> FROM HER HOME IN TOCHIGI PREFECTURE, JAPAN

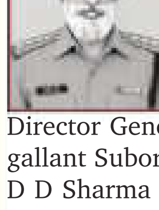
SALUTE THE SOLDIER

GORKHA RIFLES

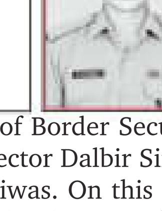
Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, JC-45151 Late NB/Sub Chabi Lal Limbu of 1/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice during Naga Hills on 09 Sep 1968.

Colonel 11 GR & Sikkim Scouts and All Ranks

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

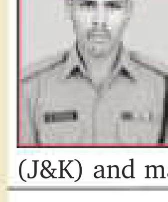


INSPETOR DALBIR SINGH, PPMG
91 BN BSF
12.12.1947 – 09.09.2004



HEAD CONSTABLE D D SHARMA, PPMG
91 BN BSF
20.06.1965 – 09.09.2004

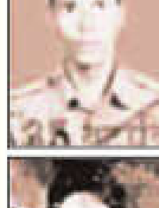
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate officer Inspector Dalbir Singh and Head Constable D D Sharma on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal bullet injuries in Counterpart firing in area of Kalakot, Rajouri (J&K). They fought bravely and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. Their sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding them with PPMG (Posthumously).



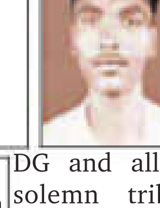
LANCE NAIK S H SANESHWAR
39 BN BSF
01.07.1962 – 09.09.1994

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Lance Naik S H Saneshwar on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries during a Counter terror Operation in area of Rajwar, Kupwara (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

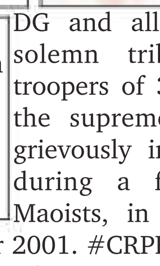


Veer Balidani Head Constable Sarajul Ansari
35 BN
8-10-1951 To 9-9-2001



Veer Balidani Constable Hira Singh
35 BN
10-6-1968 To 9-9-2001

Veer Balidani Constable Suresh Yadav
35 BN
10-1-1971 To 9-9-2001

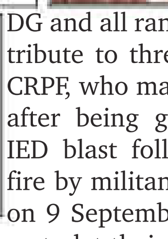


Veer Balidani Constable Rabindra Behera
35 BN
2-7-1975 To 9-9-2001

Veer Balidani Constable Bichitra Kumar Sahoo
35 BN
5-5-1973 To 9-9-2001

DG and all ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to five valiant troopers of 35 Bn CRPF, who made the supreme sacrifice after being grievously injured in an IED blast during a fierce encounter with Maoists, in East Godavari district, Andhra Pradesh on 9 September 2001. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Constable Rupesh Kumar Singh
81 BN
7-5-1982 To 9-9-2004



Veer Balidani Constable Santanu Sarkar
81 BN
18-1-1982 To 9-9-2004

Veer Balidani Constable Pawan Kumar
81 BN
14-10-1980 To 9-9-2004

DG and all ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to three bravehearts of 81 Bn CRPF, who made the supreme sacrifice after being grievously injured in an IED blast followed by indiscriminate fire by militants in Doda district, J&K, on 9 September 2004. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifices go in vain.

Sep(Late) Prem Singh

Sep(Late) Jarnail Singh,SM

Sep(Late) Chotu Ram

In proud memory of "BRAVE HEARTS" of 6th BATTALION THE DOGRA REGIMENT, who made the supreme sacrifice while serving the Nation at South of Hajipir Pass (INDO PAK WAR) on 09 Sep 1965. Their act of valour, raw courage & devotion to duty will always remain a source of inspiration and motivation to all of us.

"**BRAVES DIE, BUT ONLY ONCE**"

Remembered by Commanding Officer and All Ranks 6 DOGRA

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	GMDA GURUGRAM	PLANTATION AND MAINTENANCE OF PLANTS IN GREENBELTS OF SECTOR DIVIDING ROAD BETWEEN SECTOR-30/31, 40/41 AND 31/40 (ASSET ID-52, 51 AND 54), GURUGRAM, COMPLETE IN ALL RESPECT.	05.09.2026 14.09.2026	1,67,33,120/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8595330024 xen1.gmda@gmda.gov.in
2	GMDA GURUGRAM	ROAD CLEANING, TREE PRUNING AND GREEN BELT MAINTENANCE ALONG MASTER ROADS IN SECTORS 29-41,88 TO 98 AND 99-115, GURUGRAM AND ALL OTHER WORKS CONTINGENT THERETO	05.09.2026 14.09.2026	4,19,53,579/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8595330024 xen1.gmda@gmda.gov.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 49022/HRY

TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF ANDHRA PRADESH LIMITED
(A Government of Andhra Pradesh Undertaking & An ISO 27001-2022 Certified Company)

e-Procurement Tender Notice

The **APTRANSCO** invites bids online for Spec No.PMMTC2-e-42 /2026, **Work:** "Supply and laying of 96F OPGW at certain LILO locations, earth wire replacement, and bottom cross arm works under RMI 2025-26 and RMI 2026-27 schemes (Including both Inter-state and Intra-state lines)", **Date & Time of availability of Tender: 09.09.2026 at 17:00 Hrs, Web: http://tender.apeprocurement.gov.in , Contact No.8332949383.**

R.O.No.GMCC/APTRANSCO/129/26-27 **Sd/- CHIEF ENGINEER/Telecom & IT**

Government of Andhra Pradesh
Samagra Shiksha

Proposals are invited through the e-procurement platform for Hiring of an Agency for Deployment of Non-teaching staff across KGBV schools in Andhra Pradesh (as per section 2.2).
RFB downloading starts from: 08.09.2026 @ 11.00 AM
Last date for receipt for of RFB: 21.09.2026, 11:00 AM
Note: Further details can be viewed at **https://tender.apeprocurement.gov.in or contact: 6281229206, 7993329115**

Sd/-Secretary, KGBV Samagra Shiksha, Andhra Pradesh.
RO. No : 5404PP/CL/ADVT/1/1/2021-22 Dt: 08/09/2026

GREATER VISAKHAPATNAM MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
VISAKHAPATNAM

RFP Tender Notice No.43 / 2026-27 / EE (East Zone) / GVMC / Dt: 28-08-2026

01. No.of Works : 1 (One) (RFP Tender)
02. Downloading Starting Date : 28-08-2026 @ 8.00 PM
03. Downloading End Date : 16-09-2026 @ 04.00 PM
04. Last date for Submission of bid : 16-09-2026 @ 05.00 PM

Further details at http://www.apeprocurement.gov.in
O/o The Executive Engineer (East) Division 8187897572

Sd/- For Commissioner, GVMC

Rajasthan State Mines & Minerals Limited
e- Notice Inviting Tender

Date :- 07/09/2026

NIT No. & Date	Description of Work
e-Tender no. RSMM/CO/ GGM/(Cont)/Cont-18/ (i to iii)2026-27 Dated 19.08.2026 UBN No. MML2627SLOB00108	Providing Hard Top Seven-seater covered body Jeeps (taxi permit) on hire with Drivers, having minimum seating capacity of 07 persons including driver of 2026 & onward model with AC; to operate in Mines premises and as per requirement at SBU & PC–(RP), JKT 'to & fro' from Udaipur to Jhamarkotra Mines. Contract value Rs. 404.00 Lacs, EMD in Rs. 2.59 Lac, 1.86 Lac, 3.62 Lac, Tender Fees Rs. 4720/-
e-Tender no. RSMM/CO/ GGM/(Cont)/Cont-19/ 2026-27 Dated 20.08.2026 UBN No. MML2627WSOB00109	Supply of ROM Gypsum from Jhakharda Gypsum Mines, Tehsil-Dhorimanna, District-Barmer for Consumers/Traders. Contract value Rs. 222.00 Lacs, EMD in Rs. 4.44 Lac, Tender Fees Rs. 4720/-

Other terms & conditions have been given in detailed tender for which please visit us at our website **www.rsmm.com or www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in or eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** or contact Sr. Manager (Contract) on above address.

Raj.Samwad/C/26/10541 **DGM (P & A)**

Rajasthan State Road Development And Construction Corporation Ltd., JAIPUR.

अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या/353/2026-27

निम्नलिखित परियोजनाओं पर पथकर वसूली हेतु ई-टेन्डिरिंग प्रक्रिया से ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है:-

कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की कुल अनुमानित लागत (रु०)
Selection of Bidder for Collection of User Fee on the basis of competitive bidding through e-procurement basis for the following:-	
On Sikar-Jhunjhunu-Luharu Road SH-08 for a period of 01 Year. **UBN: RRC2627SLOB00581**	4068.06 Lakh
On Udaipur-Salumber BOT Road (SH-32) for a period of 01 Year. **UBN: RRC2627SLOB00580**	1521.45 Lakh
On Pratapgarh-Mandsaur BOT Road for a period of 01 Year. UBN: **RRC2627SLOB00582**	312.28 Lakh

निविदा से सम्बन्धित प्रपत्र में निविदा शुल्क, धरोहर राशि, डाउनलोड करने व खोलने की तारीख सहित सम्पूर्ण विवरण एवं संशोधन वेबसाईट: **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in**, **http://sppp.rajasthan.nic.in** तथा **http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in/rsrdc** पर देखा जा सकता है। इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाईट **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** पर रजिस्टर्ड करवाना आवश्यक है।

महाप्रबंधक

No. NIT/2026-27/6873-85 **Date: 07.09.2026**

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For and on behalf of the President of India, Dy. Chief Mech. Engineer (Carriage) South Eastern Railway, Kharagpur — 721301 invites e-tender for the following work before 15.00 hrs on the date mentioned against items and will be opened after 15.30 hrs. **e-Tender Notice No. :** SER-KGPW-DPOH-T211r3-02-R; **Name of Work:** Overhauling of Transmission Model T211r.3, Make-Voith of HS-SPART by OEM or Authorised dealer of OEM. **Approx. cost of work:** ₹1,01,23,060.00; **Earnest money:** ₹2,02,500; **Date & Time of closing e-tender:** 28/09/2026 at 15:00 Hrs.; **Type of Tender:** Single; **Website particulars & details: www.ireps.gov.in**; Interested tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details /description/specification of the Tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these works will be accepted. **(PR-733)**

EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PHED DIVISION BHIWADI (NCR)
D- Block Bhagat Singh Colony, Bhiwadi, District Alwar (Raj.)
E-Mail- eephedncr-alw-rj@gov.in

No-1350-1362 **Date- 18/08/2026**

NOTICE INVITING BID
(Nit No. 82-89/2026-27)

Bids for Annual Rate Contract for Construction of 200 mm Dia Tubewell In Sub Division's Tijara, Khairthal, Bhiwadi-Ist and Bhiwadi-IInd and **Annual Rate Contract for Varisous Sizes of HDPE Pipe. Line Laying & Jointing Under Sub Division Tijara, Kotkasim, Mundawar, Khairthal & Bhiwadi-Ist and Bhiwadi-IInd** are invited from interested bidders upto 06:00 PM on Date 22.09.2026. Other particulars of the Bid may be visited on the procurement portal (**http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.raj.nic.in**) of the state and **https://phedwater.rajasthan.gov.in** departmental website. The approximate value of procurement is Rs. 310.00 Lacs.

UBN:-
PHE2627WSRC04576
PHE2627WSRC04577
PHE2627WSRC04578
PHE2627WSRC04579
PHE2627WSRC04580
PHE2627WSRC04581
PHE2627WSRC04582
PHE2627WSRC04583

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
PHED Dn. Bhiwadi (NCR)

DIPR/C/15622/2026

कार्यालय सक्षम प्राधिकारी
भूमि अवाप्ति एवं उपखण्ड अधिकारी,
रामगढ़ जिला अलवर (राज०)

क्रमांकः भूमि अवाप्ति/248ए/2026/2060 दिनांकः 27.08.2026

-: सार्वजनिक सूचना :-
खातेदार/हितधारक व्यक्तियों के लिए

सभी सूचित होवे कि राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग संख्या 248ए पर तहसील रामगढ़ क्षेत्र में (अलवर-नूँह सेक्शन) रेलवे पुल एवं एलएचएस (रेलवे क्रॉसिंग स० 95) के कार्य में आ रही भूमि बाके ग्राम नंगला बलैया, सरहेटा, रामगढ़ की अवाप्ति किये जाने के बाद धारा-3जी के तहत नियमानुसार मुआवजा निर्धारण कर अंतिम अवार्ड दिनांक 12.08.2026 को अधोहस्ताक्षरकर्ता द्वारा जारी कर दिया है। उक्त भूमि अवाप्ति के बारे में निम्न प्रकार समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशन करवाया जा चुका है:-

धारा	दिनांक	अखबार
3ए	26/02/2026	दी इंडियन एक्सप्रेस
	28/03/2026	जयपुर महानगर टाईम्स
3डी	09/07/2026	दैनिक भास्कर अलवर
	06/06/2026	दी इंडियन एक्सप्रेस

इस सार्वजनिक नोटिस के द्वारा सभी खातेदार / हितधारको का ध्यान आकर्षित करने के मुख्य उद्देश्य निम्न प्रकार हैः-

- मुआवजा निर्धारण के अंतिम अवार्ड की घोषणा की जानकारी।
- मुआवजा निर्धारण के अंतिम अवार्ड की घोषणा के 60 दिवस के अन्तर्गत सभी हितधारक व्यक्तियों को अपना मुआवजा प्राप्त करने हेतु सूचना।
- सभी हितधारक व्यक्तियों को अधोहस्ताक्षरकर्ता को भूमि का कब्जा-सुपुर्दगी हेतु अनुरोध ।
- अवाप्तशुदा भूमि के रहन होने पर संबंधित बैंक द्वारा मुआवजा हेतु दावा प्रस्तुतीकरण।

अतः सभी खातेदार / हितधारकों को सूचित किया जाता है कि आप उक्त निर्धारित 60 दिवस की अवधि से पूर्व अधोहस्ताक्षकर्ता के कार्यालय पर राजकीय अवकाश के अलावा किसी भी कार्यदिवस में कार्यालय समय प्रातः 9.30 से सायं 6.00 बजे तक उपस्थित होकर अपना मुआवजा निम्न दस्तावेजों को जमा करवाकर प्राप्त कर सकते हैः-

1. खातेदार / हितधारक की जमाबंदी की सत्यापित / ई-साइन्ड प्रति।
2. खातेदार / हितधारक के पट्टा / स्वामित्व दस्तावेज की सत्यापित प्रति।
3. खातेदार / हितधारक के निर्माण के संबंध में स्वामित्व / एन.ओ.सी की सत्यापित प्रति।
4. खातेदार / हितधारक बैंक खाते की पासबुक की प्रति।
5. खातेदार / हितधारक का पैन कार्ड व आधार कार्ड की प्रति।
6. खातेदार / हितधारक द्वारा 50 रुपये के स्टाम्प पर शपथ-पत्र ।
7. भूमि के रहन होने की स्थिति में संबंधित बैंक का नो-ड्यूज प्रमाण-पत्र या जिस बैंक / शाखा में भूमि रहन है उसी बैंक / शाखा में बैंक खाते की पासबुक की प्रति।

उक्त निर्धारित 60 दिवस की अवधि से पूर्व अपना मुआवजा प्राप्त करना सुनिश्चित करें। दिनांक 12.08.2026 के पश्चात उक्त मुआवजे पर कोई ब्याज देय नही होगा। दिनांक 12.08.2026 के पश्चात मुआवजा प्राप्त करने की जिम्मेदारी आपके स्तर पर लंबित मानी जावेगी।

इसी प्रकार सभी खातेदार / हितधारक धारक को को दिनांक 12.08.2026 से तुरन्त प्रभाव से अवाप्त शुदा भूमि से अपना कब्जा अधोहस्ताक्षरकर्ता या सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग के कार्मिकों को सुपुर्द करने हेतु सूचित किया जाता है। इसमें असफल रहने पर राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग अधिनियम 1956 की धारा-3ई की उपधारा-2 के अधीन पुलिस बल की सहायता ली जाकर सुपुर्दगी अमल में लाई जावेगी।

(सुभाष यादव) RAS
सक्षम प्राधिकारी भूमि अवाप्ति
एवं उपखण्ड अधिकारी रामगढ़ (अलवर)

DIPR/C/15764/26-27

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — CORRIGENDUM

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP. /AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/ NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE ROHTAK CO OP MILK PRODUCERS UNION LTD. ROHTAK	2026_HBC_539064_1	THE LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS 07.09.2026 AT 16:00HRS. IS FURTHER EXTENDED UP TO 10.09.2026 AT 11:30HRS.	vitaindia@gmail.com	9896401185 vitarohtak@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 49020/HRY

BRIDCUL (ब्रिडकुल)

ब्रिज, रोपवे, टनल एण्ड अदर इन्फ्रास्ट्रक्चर डेवलपमेंट कॉरपोरेशन ऑफ उत्तराखण्ड लिमिटेड
(उत्तराखण्ड सरकार का उपक्रम) पूर्व में उत्तराखण्ड राज्य अवस्थापना विकास निगम लिमिटेड
प्रधान कार्यालयः अवस्थापना भवन, 583-3, राजकीय आई0टी0आई0 निरंजनपुर के सामने, माजरा, सहारनपुर रोड, देहरादून- 248001
CIN No - U45203UR2008SGC032591 टैलीफैक्सः- 0135-2522941, ई-मेल - bridcul@gmail.com

Ref : - 1440/BRIDCUL – 1093/26 Dated: 08/09/2026

E-Tendering

On behalf of Hon'ble, Governor of Uttarakhand, E-Tenders are invited by Managing Director BRIDCUL, from the Contractors registered with BRIDCUL only in Category-I (Rs. 05 to 10 Cr.) for the work given as below:-

S. No.	Ref No.	Name of Project	Estimated Cost (In Lac including GST)	Earnest Money (In Lac)	Cost of Tender Document (In Rs.)	Time Period
1	BRIDCUL/HQ HLD/34/ 2026-27	Construction of additional classrooms & Upgradation of Existing building at Lal Bahadur Shastri Government Post Graduate College, Haldudhani (Nainital). (Civil Work)	641.38	12.83	5000 + 18% GST	15 Month

For above tenders, document download start date is 11.09.2026 and Bid submission end date is 25.09.2026 at 1500 Hrs. The details of e-tender of above works can be obtained directly from website **https://uktenders.gov.in**

Changes, if any will be intimated only through website **https://uktenders.gov.in**

DGM (HQ)

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक, यूनिट-35
कन्स्ट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज
उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय)

मकान नं0 798, सेक्टर-7 (जैन मंदिर के पास)
आवास विकास कालोनी, सिकन्दरा, आगरा-282007
ई-मेलः cdsupjn35@gmail.com

L.No.: 1251 / E-Tender / 103
Dated : 07.09.2026 (3rd Call)

अति-अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम की ओर से अधोहस्ताक्षरी द्वारा **जनपद फिरोजाबाद** के विकास खण्ड मदनपुर के ग्राम उरावर हस्तफर में गौ-संरक्षण केन्द्र के निर्माण कार्य, अनुमानित लागत रू0 **123.71 लाख (जी0एस0टी0 रहित एवं लेबर सेस सहित)** हेतु सी0एण्ड डी0 एस0 के अन्तर्गत यथोचित श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से **दिनांक 14.09.2026** के **अपराह्न 17:00 बजे** तक अति-अल्प कालीन ई-निविदा आमन्त्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र **दिनांक 07.09.2026 से दिनांक 14.09.2026 के मध्य** उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की e-procurement वेबसाइट **https://etender.up.nic.in** से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते हैं तथा ई-निविदा **दिनांक 15.09.2026 को 14:00 बजे** परियोजना प्रबन्धक, यूनिट-35, सी0एण्ड डी0एस0, उ0प्र0 जल निगम (नगरीय), आगरा में खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य **रू0 10,000.00+GST (18%)** कुल **11,800.00** देय होगा। निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट **www.cdsupjn.org** एवं प्रोक्योरमेन्ट पोर्टल **https://etender.up.nic.in** पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धि पत्र (Corrigendum) **https://etender.up.nic.in** पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा। निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाईट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

उ०प्र०शासन का हार्ट सर्जरी में सेन्टर आफ एक्सीलेन्स
चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं प्रशिक्षण उ०प्र०शासन
कार्यालय निदेशक, हृदय रोग संस्थान, कानपुर।

संख्याः हरोस/2026-27/4178 दिनांकः 08.09.2026

निविदा सूचना

हृदय रोग संस्थान, कानपुर में निम्नलिखित उपकरणों के क्रय हेतु मूल निमार्ता / एक मात्र भारतीय डिस्ट्रीब्यूटर अथवा उनके अधिकृत स्टाकिस्ट / डीलर्स/प्रोपराइटरशिप/पार्टनरशिप फर्मो से निम्नलिखित मुहरबन्द निविदायें (टैक्निकल एवं प्राइस बिड अलग-अलग मुहरबन्द लिफाफों में) Government-e-Marketplace पर आमंत्रित की गयी हैं। जिनका विवरण निम्नवत है:-

क्र०सं०	जेम बिड संख्या व दिनांक	उपकरण का नाम	मात्रा	बिड अपलोड किये जाने की अन्तिम तिथि	बिड खोले जाने का दिनांक व समय
1	GEM/2026/B/8006038 दिनांकः 08.09.2026	High End ICU Ventilator	10	30.09.2026 12:00 बजे तक	01.10.2026 12:00 बजे
2	GEM/2026/B/8005874 दिनांकः 08.09.2026	Intra Aortic Balloon Pump (IABP)	4	30.09.2026 18:00 बजे तक	01.10.2026 18:00 बजे
3	GEM/2026/B/8005494 दिनांकः 08.09.2026	High End Monitor	40	30.09.2026 18:00 बजे तक	01.10.2026 18:00 बजे

बिड की विस्तृत जानकारी तथा बिड प्रपत्र उपरोक्तानुसार भारत सरकार की **Website: https://gem.gov.in** से डाउनलोड़ कर प्राप्त कर सकते है। ईएमडी "डायरेक्टर, इन्स्टीट्यूट ऑफ कार्डियोलाजी कानपुर" के पक्ष में बनवा कर जमा की जायेगी। बिड डाक्यूमेन्ट एवं उसकी समस्त नियम व शर्ते इस बिड/ई-निविदा सूचना का भाग माना जायेगा। बिड/निविदा को स्वीकार अथवा अस्वीकार करने का अधिकार अधोहस्ताक्षरी को एकमात्र है।

निविदा सूचना DGME website: www.updgme.in & Institute website: www. Lpscardiology.org &UP Govt website https://gem.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

हस्ता./-
(डा० राकेश कुमार वर्मा)
निदेशक

WESTERN RAILWAY
Material Management Department
VARIOUS MATERIALS SUPPLY
E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE No. S/52/2026 Date 04.09.2026

S.N.	TENDER NO	SHORT DESCRIPTION OF ITEMS	QUANTITY	T.O.D.
417	23263954	Cast Steel Side Frame For BLC Wagon	59 Nos	20-Oct-26
418	26261019	Running Contract of One year for supply of Glued Insulated Rail Joints for BG UIC 60/60E1 G3(L) Drg:(RDSO) RDSO-T-2572 Alt-5 Spec: (RDSO) Manualfor GIRJ-2024	2070 Nos	12-Oct-26
419	11265020	EOT CRANE CAPACITY 10/5T	2 Nos	9-Oct-26
420	26267029	Running Contract for One Year for Supply of various types of PSC sleepers (i) Isolated PSC sleeper for 1 in 12 Turnout (in RM) RDSO Drg. T-4218 (ii) Isolated PSC sleeper for 1 in 8.5 Turnout (in RM) RDSO drawing No. T-4865 (iii) PSC Sleeper set for 1 in 8.5 Diamond Crossing to RDSO Drg. No. T-6492 Alt 1(iv)PSC Sleeper set for 1 in 8.5 Diamond Crossing to RDSO Drg. No. T-6493 Alt 3 (v) PSC Sleeper set for 1 in 8.5 Diamonds Crossing to RDSO Drg. No. T-6494 Alt 4 (vi) PSC sleeper for 1 in 16 B.G. Turnout to RDSO Drg. No. T-10070 Alt. Nil	87000 Metre 40 Set	5-Oct-26
421	15262560	Set of TPU Ring for primary suspension	51663 Set	5-Oct-26

Regarding detailed notice EMD, Purchase restrictions and detailed tender conditions, please visit website www.ireps.gov.in and wr.indianrailways.gov.in. **0563**

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विद्युत वितरण मण्डल उत्तराखण्ड पावर कारपोरेशन लि०
हाईडिल कालोनी रानीखेतः 263645 (जि०-अल्मोड़ा, उत्तराखण्ड) दूरभाषः (05966) 220620

पत्रांक :-5488/वि०वि०म०(रा)/ई-निविदा दिनांक :- 07/09/2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

विद्युत वितरण मण्डल रानीखेत निम्न ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करता है :-

क्र. सं.	ई-निविदा संख्या	कार्य का नाम	ई-निविदा क्रय/जमा करने की ऑनलाइन अन्तिम तिथि एवं समय	ई-निविदा (भाग-1) खुलने की ऑनलाइन/ ऑन लाइन तिथि एवं समय
1	वि०वि०म० (रा०) 67/2026-27	वि०वि०ख०, भिकियासैंण के अन्तर्गत 33/11 के०वी० उपसंस्थान शशिखाल (सल्ट) का अनुरक्षण सम्बन्धी कार्य।	28.09.2026 15:00 बजे तक	29.09.2026 12:00 बजे
2	वि०वि०म० (रा०) 68/2026-27	वि०वि०ख०, भिकियासैंण के अन्तर्गत 33/11 के०वी० उपसंस्थान मानिला का अनुरक्षण सम्बन्धी कार्य।	28.09.2026 15:00 बजे तक	29.09.2026 12:30 बजे
3	वि०वि०म० (रा०) 69/2026-27	वि०वि०ख०, भिकियासैंण के अन्तर्गत 33/11 के०वी० उपसंस्थान मछोड़ का अनुरक्षण सम्बन्धी कार्य।	28.09.2026 15:00 बजे तक	29.09.2026 01:00 बजे
4	वि०वि०म० (रा०) 70/2026-27	वि०वि०ख०, भिकियासैंण के अन्तर्गत 33/11 के०वी० उपसंस्थान स्यालदे का अनुरक्षण सम्बन्धी कार्य।	28.09.2026 15:00 बजे तक	29.09.2026 01:30 बजे
5	वि०वि०म० (रा०) 71/2026-27	वि०वि०ख०, भिकियासैंण के अधीन जल जीवन मिशन योजनाओं के अन्तर्गत ओगलिया-नुणागांव पम्पिंग पेयजल योजना के विभिन्न स्टेजो में नये विद्युत संयोजन निर्गत करने हेतु विद्युतीकरण सामग्री की आपूर्ति सम्बन्धी कार्य।	29.09.2026 15:00 बजे तक	30.09.2026 12:00 बजे
6	वि०वि०म० (रा०) 72/2026-27	वि०वि०ख०, भिकियासैंण के अधीन जल जीवन मिशन योजनाओं के अन्तर्गत ओगलिया-नुणागांव पम्पिंग पेयजल योजना के I, II एवं V स्टेजो में नये विद्युत संयोजन निर्गत करने हेतु विकेन्द्रीकृत निर्माण सम्बन्धी कार्य।	29.09.2026 15:00 बजे तक	30.09.2026 12:30 बजे
7	वि०वि०म० (रा०) 73/2026-27	वि०वि०ख०, भिकियासैंण के अधीन जल जीवन मिशन योजनाओं के अन्तर्गत ओगलिया-नुणागांव पम्पिंग पेयजल योजना के III स्टेज में नये विद्युत संयोजन निर्गत करने हेतु 11 केवी लाईन निर्माण सम्बन्धी कार्य।	29.09.2026 15:00 बजे तक	30.09.2026 01:00 बजे

उक्त ई-निविदाओं की अन्य नियम व शर्तें वैबसाईट www.uktenders.gov.in पर देखी जा सकती है। उक्त ई-निविदाओं का शुद्धि पत्र/ विस्तारीकरण/निरस्तीकरण आदि की सूचना वैबसाईट www.uktenders.gov.in में ही प्रकाशित / उपलब्ध होगी।

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Customer Toll Free No- 1800 419 0405

हस्ता./-
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

Office of the Superintending Engineer, Moradabad Circle, P.W.D. Moradabad
E-Procurement Notice Inviting Tenders

No. 5130 /E-Tender/MBD Circle/26-27 **Dated :- 27.08.2026**

1. On behalf of the Governor of UP, tenders for following work are invited by the Superintending Engineer, Moradabad Circle, PWD Moradabad online on website **http://etender.up.nic.in** & Prahari website **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/prahari** from registered contractors from 18-09-2026 at 10.00 am to 24-09-2026 at 12:00 Hrs. Technical bid /Prequalification of tenders shall be opened on 24-09-2026 at 12:30 Hrs. in office of undersigned by tender committee in presence of authorised representatives/bidders who wish to be present. Financial bid of the tenders' who qualify in technical bid shall be opened on date and time as specified by a notice in the office of undersigned. In case of Government holiday the required process shall be carried out on next working day. Amount mentioned in column 7 & 9 shall be mandatory deposited by net banking only on E-Tender Portal.

Sl. No	DISTRICT	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.in Lac)	Cost of 5-year maintenance (in Rs. lac)	Total Cost of Work (In Lac.)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lacs) ncluding rainy season)	Time of completion of the work	Cost of tender documents including GST	Category of road contractor eligible
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	Moradabad	New Construction work on the link road from Ghonda Mustaqam to Milk Gosainwali.	100.70	2.52	103.22	7.17	12 Month	2354.00	"A, B" (Road Category)
2		New Construction work on the Hasanganj to Mudia Bhaypur link road.	123.30	3.09	126.39	8.32	12 Month	2354.00	"A, B" (Road Category)
3		New Construction work on the Dalpatpur Alinganj road via Mangal Bazaar from NH-24 in village Dalpatpur.	114.35	2.86	117.21	7.87	12 Month	2354.00	"A, B" (Road Category)
4		New Construction work from near Chandausi Road Nursery to Milk of Noorpur via Raj Farm House.	123.12	3.08	126.20	8.31	12 Month	2354.00	"A, B" (Road Category)
5		New Construction work in village Udaipur Chandan from Junior High School to Basera Khas PWD Road.	134.10	3.36	137.46	8.88	12 Month	2354.00	"A, B" (Road Category)
6		New Construction work in village Nanpur from Bhukan's house to Kundarki Bilari Highway.	140.70	3.52	144.22	9.22	12 Month	2354.00	"A, B" (Road Category)
7		New Construction work from Jaitiya Sadullapur Modh via Kharagpur Baje Kutto Wali Milk to Hadypur Sikandarpur Patti Road.	122.80	3.07	125.87	8.30	12 Month	2354.00	"A, B" (Road Category)

The terms and conditions and details of the tender are available on the website **http://etender-up-nic**. In accordance with Government Order No. 879(1)/23-7-2020 dated 25-08-2020 and Chief Engineer (Development) and Head of Department's letter No. 4650/4N-LC/2020 dated 27.08.2020, the bidder will have to upload the necessary documents by logging on to the Prahari URL **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/prahari/**.

(Mohit Kumar)
Executive Engineer,
Construction Divison-1
PWD Moradabad

UPID-255585 Date 07/09/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(S.P. Singh)
Superintending Engineer
Moradabad Circle, PWD
Moradabad.
For and on behalf of Governor of UP
Mail ID:- semoradabad14@yahoo.com

कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता
केन्द्रीय भण्डार खण्ड-3, कालागढ़

ई-निविदा सूचना सं.- 42 / ई.ई./ के.भ.ख.-3/2026-27

महामहिम राज्यपाल महोदया उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से निम्नलिखित कार्यों हेतु सिंचाई एवं जल संसाधन विभाग उत्तर प्रदेश द्वारा ऑनलाइन http://etender.up.nic.in के माध्यम से प्री-क्वालीफिकेशन टेक्निकल बिड/प्राईस बिड/फाइनेंशियल बिड बजट वित्तीय स्वीकृति की प्रत्याशा में सिंचाई एवं जल संसाधन विभाग में वगीर्कृत श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से दिनांक 16-09-2026 को अपरान्ह 02:00 बजे तक आमंत्रित की जाती है।

आमंत्रित निविदा की सूचना निम्नानुसार है :-

क्र.	कार्य का विवरण	अनुमानित लागत (लाख रुपये में)	धरोहर राशि (रुपये में)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य	पंजीकृत श्रेणी
1	भीमगोडा बैराज हेतु केबल ट्रे आपूर्ति एवं स्थापना का कार्य ।	21.30	42,600.00	60 दिवस	300.00+18% जी.एस.टी. + (500 रु. स्टेशनरी चार्ज)	निविदा शर्तो के अनुसार

A	वेबसाइट पर बिड डाक्यूमेंट की उपलब्धता की तिथि एवं समय	11-09-2026 को समय 10-00 बजे से
B	बिड अपलोड करने की अवधि, जिसके साथ बिड डाक्यूमेंट शुल्क, बिड सिक्योरिटी/रजिस्टेशन प्रमाण पत्र एवं अन्य आवश्यक डाक्यमेंटस पी०डी०एफ०/ एक्स० एल० एस०	11-09-2026 को समय 10-00 बजे से 19-09-2026 को अपरान्ह 02:00 बजे
C	निविदा प्रपत्र शुल्क, बिड सिक्योरिटी, रजिस्ट्रेशन प्रमाण-पत्र, एवं अन्य वांछित अभिलेख मूल रूप में, अभियन्ता, केन्द्रीय भण्डार खण्ड-3, नई कालोनी, कालागढ़ कार्यालय में जमा	19-09-2026 को अपराहन 02:00 बजे तक
D	ऑनलाइन पार्ट-'ए' प्री-क्वालीफिकेशन, टेक्निकल-बिड (धरोहर धनराशि व तकनीकी भाग) खोले जाने की तिथि एवं समय	19-09-2026 को अपराहन 03:00 बजे
E	ऑनलाइन पार्ट-'बी' (वित्तीय भाग) प्राइस बिड/फाइनेंशियल बिड खोले जाने की तिथि एवं समय	पार्ट- "ए" खोलने के उपरान्त
F	बिड खोले जाने का स्थान	कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता केन्द्रीय भण्डार खण्ड 3 कालागढ़

निविदा सूचना, सूचना विभाग की वैब-साइट http://information.up.gov.in व सिंचाई विभाग की वैब-साइट http://idup.gov.in पर उपलब्ध है। निविदा प्रपत्र ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट वैबसाइट http://etender.up.nic.in से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते हैं, परन्तु निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य, धरोहर धनराशि कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता, केन्द्रीय भण्डार खण्ड-3, नई कालोनी, कालागढ़ के नाम केवल इन्टरनैट बैंकिंग के माध्यम से ऑनलाइन देय होगी, जो निविदा के भाग-ए के साथ आवश्यक रुप से जमा किया जायेगा। निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य, निविदा के भाग-ए के साथ संलग्न न किये जाने की स्थिति में ऐसी निविदा पर विचार नहीं किया जायेगा।

निविदा सूचना में कोई भी संशोधन / परिवर्तन किया जाता है तो संशोधन / परिवर्तन उक्त साइट पर अपलोड कर दिया जायेगा। कृपया उक्त साइट को समय-समय पर चैक करते रहें ।

नोट-निविदा डालने से पूर्व ठेकेदार को साइट की विजिट स्वयं कर लेनी चाहिए। बजट एवं साइट की आवश्यकतानुसार कार्य की मात्रा घट/बढ़ सकती है। वर्क साइट तक ढुलाई का कार्य ठेकेदार को ही वहन करना होगा। ठेकेदारों को कार्य करने हेतु टी.एण्ड पी. एवं अन्य सामग्री की स्वयं व्यवस्था करनी होगी।

UPID-255663 Date 07/09/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(मनोज कुमार गौड़)
अधिशासी अभियन्ता
केन्द्रीय भण्डार खण्ड-3, कालागढ़

INDEL MONEY — GOLD AUCTION NOTICE

Corporate office: **Indel Money Limited,**
IIIrd Floor Indel House, Changampuzha Nagar,
South Kalamassery, Ernakulam -682033 ,
Ph: 0484-2933999 E:customercare@indelmoney.com

The pledges in specific and the public in general are hereby notified that public auction of the gold ornaments pledged in the below accounts is proposed to be conducted at the following branches on 09-10-2026 at 11:00 am We are auctioning the gold ornaments of the defaulted customers who have failed to make the payment of his/her loan amount despite being notified through various communication. Unauctioned items shall be auctioned on any other days without further notice of changes in venue or date and the same shall be displayed at concerned branches without any further notice.

ADHYAPAK NAGAR - 32904800003688, 32905130006679, 0513/06692, **BADARPUR -** 40104790001403, 40104800001376, 0480/01391, 0480/01418, 0480/01460, 0480/01485, 40105120003143, 0512/03144, 0512/03181, 0512/03198, 0512/03231, 40105130003226, 0513/03227, 0513/03241, 0513/03244, 0513/03249, 0513/03250, 0513/03255, 0513/03258, 0513/03259, 0513/03266, 0513/03268, **KARAWAL -** 33904540003567, 33904790003539, 0479/03734, 33904800003516, 0480/03653, 33904850003756, 33905130006745, 0513/06775, 0513/06778, 0513/06779, 0513/06794, **KIRARI -** 33404790001847, 0479/01869, 33404800001925, 33404800001929, **MAYUR VIHAR -** 35005130003165, 35005130003167, 0513/03174, 0513/03175, 0513/03188, 0513/03190, **MOHAN GARDEN -** 33004790002166, 0479/02221, 33004800002110, 0480/02233, **NAJAFGRAH -** 36104790000838, 36105120002050, 36105130002069, 0513/02083, **PANKHA ROAD -** 33304720001385, 33304790001373, 33304800001376, 0480/01393, 33305130003111, 0513/03122, 0513/03124, 0513/03127, 0513/03136, **POOTHKALAN -** 34004790003301, 34005090006389, 34005120006309, 0512/06360, 34005130006452, 34005130006454, 0513/06460, 0513/06469, 0513/06477, 0513/06478, 0513/06479, 0513/06480, 0513/06483, **RANIBAGH -** 46804800000214, 46805120000983, 46805130000981, 0513/00997, 0513/01000, 0513/01006, 0513/01009, **SHAHABAD DIARY -** 33104790001752, 0479/01757, 0479/01791, 33104850001801, **SHAKURPUR-** 44905120001112, 0512/01137, 44905130001164, 0513/01167, **UTTAM NAGAR -** 34204790001238, 34205130002693, 34205130002695, **VISHNU GARDEN -** 35405130002804, 0513/02816, 0513/02817, **BETUL -** 34904790001751, 34904800001720, 0480/01834, 0480/01841, **BIAORA -** 42705130001659, **IMAMI GATE -** 32204790001606, 32204850001586, 0485/01675, 32205130002963, 0513/02978, **ITARSI -** 32104800002863, 0480/02931, 0480/03042, 32104850002858, 32105130005935, 0513/05945, 0513/05946, 0513/05961, **KAMLA NAGAR -** 34804790003957, 0479/04028, 0479/04031, 34804800004029, 34805090007171, 34805120007269, 34805130007246, 0513/07247, 0513/07283, 0513/07292, **MANDIDEEP -** 35204800001889, 0480/01971, 0480/02011, 0480/02013, 35205090003945, **MARIMATA -** 32304790002382, 0479/02463, 32305130004042, **PIPARIYA -** 46104540000267, 46104800000262, 46105090000919, 46105120000933, 0512/00937, **RAISEN -** 35805130006078, **SAGAR -** 35904800001548, 35905130003363, **BHANGEL -** 33204540001733, 33204800001762, **HOSIARPUR -** 43604800000695, 0480/00701, 0480/00720, 43605090002434, 43605120002397, 43605130002470, **SHALIMAR GARDEN -** 36204790000845, 36205130002448, **FARIDABAD -** 33804790002187, 33804800002307, 33805130004262, 0513/04264, 0513/04268, 0513/04293, 0513/04299, 0513/04301, 0513/04304, **JAWAHAR COLONY -** 38904540001291, 38904850001294, 38905090002386, 38905130002419, 0513/02421, 0513/02426, 0513/02427, 0513/02428, 0513/02429, 0513/02430, 0513/02438, 0513/02442, 0513/02443, **FARIDABAD NIT 2 -** 43805130001220,

In case we are unable to complete the auction at the branch on the notified date, the same will be conducted through Shriram Automall India Limited (SAMIL) on their online e- auction platform https://gold.samil.in or e-Procurement Technologies Limited (AuctionTiger) on their online e- auction platform https://egold.auctiontiger.net on 12-10-2026 between 12.30 PM to 3.30 PM. Please note if the e- auction does not completed on 12-10-2026 the same will be re-auctioned on subsequent working days on the same terms and conditions.

By Authorized Officer,
Indel Money Limited

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sajan @ Kalu, S/o Sheikh Ainul R/o N-38/B-116, CD Park, Jahangir Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in case **FIR No.764/2021 u/s 380/392/394/411/34 IPC, Dated 14.08.2021 P.S. Jahangir Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sajan @ Kalu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sajan @ Kalu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sajan @ Kalu** of **FIR No.764/2021 u/s 380/392/394/411/34 IPC, Dated 14.08.2021 P.S. Jahangir Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.10.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, North
Room No. 6, Ground Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/12679/NW/2026

GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR
AGRICULTURE PRODUCTION DEPARTMENT
MISSION DIRECTORATE, HADP/JKCIP

Rajbagh, Srinagar/Narwal, Jammu,
Email: Accounts.hadp.jkcip@jk.gov.in

NOTICE INVITING e-BIDS

No.: MD/HADP/JKCIP/Acctt/2026/20 Dated: 07.09.2026

The Employer, Mission Directorate, HADP / JKCIP, invites electronic proposals from eligible and interested consulting firms for the following consultancy assignment, financed by the International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD):

RFP No.	RFP-14-JKCIP-2026-27/IND-2000005021-0289-CS-QCBS
GeM Bid No.	GEM/2026/B/7974916
Name of Assignment	Conducting Policy Studies under JKCIP
Bid Security (EMD)	Not required
Cost of Bidding Document	Nil
Bid submission starts	01-09-2026
Last date and time of bid submission	22-09-2026 at 21:00 hours IST
Opening of technical bids	22-09-2026 at 21:30 hours IST

The complete Request for Proposals, eligibility criteria, terms and conditions and corrigenda, if any, are available on the Government e-Marketplace Portal and may be downloaded free of cost. Bids shall be submitted online only. The Employer reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids without assigning any reason.

Sd/-
Accounts Officer
Mission Directorate,
HADP/JKCIP

DIPK-NB-1569/26 DATE 08 SEP 2026

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE
HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F), email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Mubashir Ahmed S/O Nazir Ahmed R/O Hamdeen Seer District Anantnag Kashmir is evading his arrest / wanted in case FIR No. 202/2020 U/S 8/15/21 NDPS Act of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name	:	Mubashir Ahmed
S/O	:	Nazir Ahmed
Address	:	Hamdeen Seer District Anantnag
Age	:	40-45 Years

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1. DPO, Jammu	:	0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D	:	sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu	:	0191-2605949
4. SP City South	:	0191-2430002
5. SDPO City East	:	01912433778
6. P/S Bahu Fort	:	0191-2475133

Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

No. DIP/J-9807/26- DATE 08 SEP 2026
Date:- 08.2026

Kolhapur Municipal Corporation, Workshop Department

Public Tender Notice No. 64, First Extension for Serial Nos. 1 to 35

Tenders have been invited via Public Tender Notice No. 64 for the work mentioned from Serial No. 1 to Serial No. 35, for purchasing spare parts and accessories, and carrying out repairs for various types of vehicles used by the Kolhapur Municipal Corporation. These tenders are invited from manufacturing companies and authorized dealers of companies in the local market. The submissions must include detailed information, factoring in discounts on the respective company's price list, all taxes, packing, forwarding, handling charges, etc. The first extension for this has been granted up to **17/09/2026.** Detailed information regarding this will be available on the website www.mahatender.gov.in.
Office Ref. No.
08/09/2026.

Sd/-
City Engineer
Kolhapur Municipal Corporation

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Raghuvinder Mishra, S/o: Dev Lal Mishra, R/o: H.No. C-30, Gali No. 6, New Usmanpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 552/2022, U/s: 420/34 IPC, Police Station Burari, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Raghuvinder Mishra** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Raghuvinder Mishra** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Raghuvinder Mishra** of **Police Station Burari, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.10.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Payal Singal
JMFC-09, Central, Room No. 286
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/12618/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Ajay Kumar Sharma S/o** Sh. Rajiv Sharma, **R/o** H.No. R-35, Gurpreet Nagar, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 001223/2023 U/s 411 IPC.**, has been registered at **PS: Hari Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Ajay Kumar Sharma** namely cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Ajay Kumar Sharma** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Ajay Kumar Sharma** of under **FIR No. 001223/2023 U/s 411 IPC.**, Registred at: **PS: Hari Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Moksha Bains
JMFC-II, Room No. 31
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/12627/WD/2026
(Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mohd. Shehzad, S/o:** Mohd. Yonus, **R/o:** C-184, Gali No. 4, Chauhan Banger, New Seelampur, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 357/2019, U/s 419/425/34 IPC, P.S.: Kalyanpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mohd. Shehzad** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mohd. Shehzad** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mohd. Shehzad** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 357/2019, U/s 419/425/34 IPC, P.S.: Kalyanpuri, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Prigya Gupta
Chief Judicial Magistrate, (East)
Room No. 29, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/12708/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

UJVN Ltd.

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O. "UJJWAL" Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone-0135-2763808 Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

RO No. 780 **e-TENDER NOTICE** Date: 07.09.2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Generation), Vyasi HEP, UJVN Ltd., Dakpathar, invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

e-Tender No: 08/EE(Generation)/Vyasi/2026-27: Annual General Cleaning of 2 × 60 MW Vyasi HEP at Hathiyari
Estimated cost : ₹ 38,70,000/- GST extra
Availability of bid document on website: 08.09.2026, 18:00 hrs.
Last date for submission of e-tender: 03.10.2026 up to 11:00 hrs
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "http://uktenders.gov.in"

Executive Engineer (Generation)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Avinash S/o.** Ram Kishan, **R/o:** B-4/455, Mandoli Nand Nagari, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 53/2023, U/s: 380/411/34 IPC,** registered at **P.S.: GTB Enclave, Delhi,** and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Avinash** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Avinash** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Avinash, FIR No.: 53/2023, U/s: 380/411/34 IPC,** registered at **P.S.: GTB Enclave, Delhi,** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.10.2026.**

By Order
Sukriti Jha
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
Room No. 54, Second Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts Delhi

DP/12669/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Matender, S/o: Late Ravinder, R/o: Village Mathura Pur, P.S. Muradnagar, Distt. Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 183/2017, U/s: 420/406 IPC, P.S. Timar Pur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Matender** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Matender** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Matender** of **P.S. Timar Pur, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.10.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Karanbir Singh
JMFC-02, Central, Room No. 26,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/12672/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **1. Ajay and 2. Shivlal both R/o Premises in Opposite H. No. 337, Near NSG Including Colony, Ground Floor, Samalka, Near Pole No. VKJ-V 297, New Delhi-110037** have Committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in **Court Case No. 234/2019 U/s 135 Indian Electricity Act, P.S. Kapashera, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **1. Ajay and 2. Shivlal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **1. Ajay and 2. Shivlal** have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **1. Ajay and 2. Shivlal** of case **Court Case No. 234/2019 U/s 135 Indian Electricity Act, P.S. Kapashera, Delhi** are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.10.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Harleen Singh
Additional District and Session Judge (South West)
Special Court Electricity, Court No. 609
Dwarka Courts, New Delhi

DP/12741/SW/2026 (Court Matter)

ANNUAL REPAIRING CONTRACT

E-Tender No.: SNT-16-LMG-2026-27; Dated: 28-08-2026; E-Tender are invited by the undersigned for the following work; **Name of work :** Annual repairing contract of defective PDH/SDH equipment cards (make-Tejas, Webfil & Puncom) installed under the jurisdiction of Sr.DSTE/Lumding in Lumding division for a period of two years. **Tender Value:** ₹59,58,331.80/-, **Bid Security**: ₹1,19,200/-; Date & time of **closing** of tender at **15:00** hrs and **opening** at **15:30** hrs. on **22-09-2026**. Complete information alongwith the tender document of above e-tender are available in the website **www.ireps.gov.in**

DSTE, Lumding
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Serving Customers With A Smile

कुटेशन नोटिस

हरियाणा राज्य परिवहन कुरुक्षेत्र में वाहनों की मुरम्मत के लिए Hardware, Petty Items, Misc Items की अगले छः माह (Six Month) के लिए खरीद की जानी है। इच्छुक सप्लायर दिनांक 20-09-2026 तक अपनी सील बंद कुटेशन डाक द्वारा महाप्रबंधक हरियाणा राज्य परिवहन कुरुक्षेत्र के नाम भेज सकते हैं। जिस पर स्टोर आइटम कुटेशन लिखा होना अनिवार्य है। स्टोर आइटम की लिस्ट व अन्य शर्तों के लिए कार्यालय महाप्रबंधक कुरुक्षेत्र में सम्पर्क कर सकते हैं। कुटेशन संबंधित सभी दस्तावेज किसी भी कार्य दिवस में आकर 200 रुपए जमा करवाने उपरांत कार्यालय, महाप्रबंधक हरियाणा राज्य परिवहन, कुरुक्षेत्र से प्राप्त कर सकते हैं।

महाप्रबंधक,
No.49012/HRY हरियाणा राज्य परिवहन कुरुक्षेत्र

BENGALURU METROPOLITAN TRANSPORT CORPORATION

CENTRAL OFFICE: STORES & PURCHASE DEPARTMENT
K.H. ROAD, SHANTHINAGAR, BENGALURU-560 027
NO: BMTC/CO/COSP/TENDER/12/2026-27 Date: 08.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

B.M.T.C invites tender for procurement of the following Goods & Services through Kpp Portal:

Sl No	Tender No.	Description	Approx. Tender Value (Rs. in Crores)	Last Date for Bid Submission in KPP Portal
		Short -Term Tender		
1	BMTC/ 2026-27/ IND0348	Procurement of Tyres, Tubes & Flap sets, Tubeless Radial Tyres and extra tubes and flaps.	19.00	15.09.2026 at 11:30 Hrs

Note: Tender No: BMTC/2026-27/SE1428 invited for Selection of Project monitoring consultant for the Comprehensive Smart Ticketing Solution Project has been recalled as Call-2 and due date is on 15.09.2026 at 11:30 Hrs. The above mentioned tender details can be obtained from **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** Further, any addendum/ corrigendum in respect of change in calendar of events, specification, other tender terms and conditions etc. will be uploaded /published through KPP-Portal only.

Note: Interested Bidders need to register in the KPP Portal. For further information visit BMTC Central Office or Log on to **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in**

Sd/- CONTROLLER OF STORES & PURCHASES (Tender Inviting Authority)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Meena, W/o Mohar Singh, R/o H.No. F-1/38, Sultan Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 131/2016, U/s 279/338/201/509/34 IPC, P.S. Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Meena** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Meena** has absconded (or is concealing herelf to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Meena** accused of **FIR No. 131/2016, U/s 279/338/201/509/34 IPC, P.S. Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.10.2026.**

By Order - Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrat First Class-07
Room No. 06, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/12698/ON/2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

Mahila Samarth Sansthan Award Scheme 2026-27

The Women & Child Development Department, Haryana is introducing the **"Mahila Samarth Sansthan Award Scheme"** for the financial year 2026-27.

The objective of the scheme is to identify, recognize and encourage institutions providing a safe, respectful, equal and supportive working environment for women employees in Haryana. Under the scheme applications are invited from all Government/Semi-Government/Non-Government offices/institutions/ Government Universities, Private Universities, Deemed Universities and Central Universities. Interested institutions are required to submit their application online through department website www.wcdhry.gov.in under Mahila Samarth Sansthan Award.

Last date for submission of applications: 20 September 2026

Detailed guidelines, eligibility criteria, prescribed parameters and the application process are available on the Department's website **www.wcdhry.gov.in**.

Sd/-
Deputy Commissioner
Panchkula

No.49028/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	ONLINE TENDER FOR THE RATE CONTRACT FOR THE SUPPLY OF HEPATITIS B IMMUNOGLOBULIN (HBIG) 100 IU TO VARIOUS HOSPITALS OF GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA FOR A PERIOD OF TWO YEARS FOR GROUP A	08.09.2026 29.09.2026	1,44,90,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	0172-478822 hmscltenders@gmail.com
2	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF 16 SLICE DUAL HEAD SPECT/CT SCANNER FOR PGIMS, ROHTAK ON ONE TIME PURCHASE BASIS AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	08.09.2026 22.09.2026	12,00,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
3	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF AUTOMATED VISUAL FIELD ANALYZER ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	08.09.2026 29.09.2026	60,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No.49054/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, AMBALA	SPECIAL REPAIR BY PROVIDING STG. FOR VARIOUS 3 NOS. LINK ROADS (I.E. ROAD ID 374, 381 AND 382) UNDER THE JURISDICTION OF PROVINCIAL DIVISION NO.2, PWD BANDR BR., AMBALA CANTT IN AMBALA DISTRICT (UNDER WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) (MULLANA CONSTITUENCY) (GROUP-3) + 1 WORKS	04.09.2026 14.09.2026	728.57 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9417362462 pwd-eepd2-ambala@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, HISAR	SPECIAL REPAIR OF ROB AT LC-112 AND SERVICE ROAD ON AGROHA TO ADAMPUR ROAD (SH-10) (ROAD ID 4794) IN HISAR DISTT. (ADAMPUR CONSTITUENCY OF WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27)	CLOSING DATE 14.09.2026	96.11 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9878384499 pwd-eepd1-hissar@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, HISAR	CONSTRUCTION OF 200 BEDDED HOSPITAL IN SECTOR-9 FATEHABAD (PDG 6000 LTR LMO, COMPRESSED AIR AND VACCUM SYSTEM, BALANCE MGP AND ALLIED WORK). + 2 WORKS	03.09.2026 11.09.2026	1055.74 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662225651 pwd-eeed-hissar@hry.nic.in
4	PWD B&R, HISAR	WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING OF GAWAR TO MEHRIAN UPTO RAJASTHAN BORDER ROAD RD 0.00 TO 3.400 (ROAD ID 4952) IN HISAR DISTT. (PDG. SHIFTING OF HT/LT LINES ONLY) + 2 WORKS	03.09.2026 10.09.2026	95.02 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662225651 pwd-eeed-hissar@hry.nic.in
5	PWD B&R, HISAR	WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING OF ROAD FROM KAIMRI TO PATTAN ROAD RD 0.00 TO 3.720 (ROAD ID 10423) AND MANGALI TO DEVA ROAD RD 0.00 TO 6.00 (ROAD ID 10417) IN HISAR DISTRICT. (PDG. SHIFTING OF HT/LT LINES ONLY)	03.09.2026 10.09.2026	49.79 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662225651 pwd-eeed-hissar@hry.nic.in
6	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, HISAR	LAND DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME OF WATER LOGGED AND SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT AT VILLAGE - CHULI KHURD / CHULI KALAN	03.09.2026 14.09.2026	326.20 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9813562162 ascohisar@gmail.com
7	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, HISAR	LAND DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME FOR WATER LOGGED AND SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT AT VILLAGE -DEPAL / DHANDERI / UMRA , BLOCK - HANSI-I , DISTT. - HANSI	03.09.2026 14.09.2026	462.75 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9813562162 ascohisar@gmail.com
8	PANCHAYATI RAJ, CHARKHI DADRI	PAVEMENT OF LINK RASTA (PAINTAWASS KALAN TO MADHWA-MADHVI) WITH IPB AT VILL.PAINTAWASS KALAN.	24.08.2026 11.09.2026	209.47 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9582622008 xenprcharkhidadri@gmail.com
9	PANCHAYATI RAJ, CHARKHI DADRI	SUPPLY OF STREET LIGHTS FOR PHIRNI (90 WATTS) IN DISTRICT CHARKHI DADRI	01.09.2026 10.09.2026	25.96 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9582622008 xenprcharkhidadri@gmail.com
10	PANCHAYATI RAJ, KARNAL	CONSTRUCTION OF COMMCONSTRUCTION OF COMMUNITY CENTER AT VILLAGE - UPLANA , BLOCK - ASSANDH , KARNAL	29.08.2026 12.09.2026	67.30 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896634422 prexeeng.krl@hry.nic.in
11	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, HISAR	RAISING AND LOWERING OF EXISTING SEWER MANHOLE UPTO ROAD LEVEL AND REPAIR OF DAMAGED MANHOLES AT VARIOUS LOCATION IN HISAR CITY.	CLOSING DATE 18.09.2026	85.93 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662-247033 eephisar@gmail.com
12	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, SIRSA	REPAINTING OF M-TYPE QUARTERS IN CANAL COLONY, HISAR ROAD, SIRSA (21 NOS. M-TYPE QUARTERS I.E. M-1 TO M-8 AND M-11 TO M-23) + 4 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 14.09.2026	8.14 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9996665761 xensrs.swd1925@yahoo.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in No.49056/HR

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — CORRIGENDUM

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP. /AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/ NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE ROHTAK CO OP MILK PRODUCERS UNION ITD. ROHTAK	2026_HBC_539417_1	DATE. EXTENDED UPTO 14.09.2026 AT 16:00 PM OPENING ON 15.09.2026 AT 11:30 AM	vitaindia@gmail.com	9896401185 vitarohtak@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 49030/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSAMB KAITHAL	SPECIAL REPAIR OF 3 NOS. LINK ROADS IN PUNDRI CONSTITUENCY G-1, ROAD ID-148,228 AND 301 (WORK PLAN 2026-27) + 1 WORKS	03.09.2026 18.09.2026	6,48,53,734/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9416178720 xenkaithal4.hsamb @gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 49024/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — CORRIGENDUM

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP. /AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/ NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	UHBVN PANCHKULA	27/2026-27/HEWP	CONST OF CONTROL ROOM BUILDING AND ALLIED CIVIL WORKS, FURNITURE AND ELECTRICAL APPLIANCES AT 33 KV S/STN.CHEEKA. CLOSING DATE 15.09.2026 OPENING DATE 16.09.2026	http://etenders.hry.nic.in	9356063248 xenciviluhbvnpanchkula @gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 49031/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION GURUGRAM	REHABILITATION OF ROAD WITH RMC M-40 AND BM AND BC ALONG WITH INTERLOCKING TILES AT BERMS OF ROADS IN SEC 17C, WARD 25 DIV 4B UNDER MCG. + 1 WORKS	07.09.2026 18.09.2026	9,54,88,046/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9999716115 ee8@mcg.gov.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 49032/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSAMB SONIPAT	SPECIAL REPAIR OF 03 NO. LINK ROAD I.E. FROM 1) GUHNA TO BILBILAN (ID-8706), 2) KASANDI TO BAJANA PWD ROAD VIA KHANPUR PGI ROAD (GOHANA) (ID 9636) AND 3) LATH TO KHERI (ID-9486), IN GOHANA CONSTITUENCY, DISTT. SONIPAT (GROUP NO.2) (WORK PLAN 2026-27).	07.09.2026 18.09.2026	2,15,87,296/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8059716084 hsambsonipat@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 49033/HRY

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,MUKHTYAR SINGH FATHER OF PANKAJ KUMAR,R/O-VILLAGE-KOYALPUR,POST-KHETAWAS,District-Jhajjar, HARYANA -124109,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM MUKHTYAR SINGH TO MUKHTAIR SINGH VIDE AFFIDAVIT, DATED-08/09/2026 BEFORE NCT DELHI 0040877408-9

I, Siddhartha Agarwal S/o Shyam Sunder Agarwal R/o C-898A 2nd Floor Sushant Lok1 Vyapar Kendra Sector-43 Chakarpur(74) Gurgaon Haryana-122002,have changed my minor Son's name Reyanssh Agarwal to Krishwin Agarwal aged 5 years 0071059586-1

I,Jeenender Jain,S/o-Late Bal Krishan Jain,R/o-401 Near Mother Dairy,Sector-17 Faridabad Haryana-121002, have changed my name to Jinender Kumar Jain for all purposes. 0040877434-2

I,ANUGYA CHAUDHARY W/o Vishal Gupta R/o U-26A, Upadhyay Block Shakarpur East Delhi-110092,have changed my name to ANUGYA GUPTA 0040877409-3

I, Kanchan Bhardwaj, W/o Shri Gaurav Bhardwaj, mother of my minor daughter Gaurvikaa Bhardwaj, DOB is 22/05/2018, R/o H.No.64, Rajbagh, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201005, do hereby solemnly declare that Gaurvika and Gaurvikaa Bhardwaj are one and the same girl. Henceforth, I have changed my daughter's name from Gaurvika to Gaurvikaa Bhardwaj for all future purposes. 0040877241-1

I Nilam Kumari W/o-Jai Prakash Dubey R/o-D-63A, Amar Colony,Nangloi, Delhi-110041 have changed my name to Neelam Dubey for all purposes. 0040877244-1

I Manju Bala W/O Kapil Garg R/O G-30/139-140-141,Second Floor,Sector-3,Rohini,Delhi-110085 Have Changed my Name to Manju Garg. 0040877412-8

I, Ashish Kumar S/o Sitaram Mandal, Z-19, Hauz Khas Rd, Delhi-110016 have changed my name to Ashish Kumar Mandal. 0071059605-1

I,Rambir,S/o-Shri Banwari Lal,r/o-Village Khanda,Tehsil Kharkhoda, District Sonepat, Haryana have changed my name from Rambir to Rambir Singh for all future purposes. 0040877442-2

I,Gunita Sodhi Thukral,D/o-Mohinder Singh Sodhi,R/o-12,Western Avenue, Opp. W-3 Lane,Sainik Farm,PO. Deoli,South Delhi -110062, have changed my name to Gunita Sodhi for all Purposes. 0040877402-6

I,VISHNU S/O NIRANJAN KUMAR R/O WARD NO-03 SAMPLA ROHTAK HARYANA-124501,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO VISHNU GARG. 0040877408-2

I,Suman Singh W/O Member Chaudhary R/O 2A,First Floor,Pocket D-2,DDA Janta Flat, Kondli,Delhi-110096, have changed my name to Shashi Chaudhary. 0040877412-1

I, Shakuntla W/o Udai Bhan Singh Atri R/o Plot No 111, Second Floor, Shakti Khand 4,Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201014 have changed my name to Shakuntlaatri 0071059587-1

I,Reena,D/o-Prem Masih,R/o-H No-514 First Floor,Ashoka Enclave Part-3, Kanishka Residency,Sector-35 Faridabad Haryana-121003,have changed my name Reena to Reena Masih for all purposes. 0040877434-4

I, Lungniamlu Panmei, spouse of Army No. 13004732N, Rank L/HAV, Achun Panmei, a resident of Rengpang Village, Mongjrong Khunou, P.O. & P.S. Nungba, District-Noney, Manipur-795009, do hereby solemnly state on Oath vide Affidavit dated 7/9/2026, before the Chief Magistrate, Imphal West, Manipur, that I have changed my name from Lungniamlu Kamson to Lungniamlu Panmei, and will be used it in all future purposes. 0040877407-1

I,Savitri,D/o-Amar Singh,W/o-Bhoop Singh,R/o-H.No.G-82,Punjabi Colony, Narela,Delhi-110040,that name of my father has wrongly written in my Pan card-EGDPS2496P as Umar Singh. The actual name of my father is Amar Singh 0040877409-5

I, Md Jawaid Equbal R/o Block No.201, Quarter No.04, Sector-1, Pushp Vihar, New Delhi-110017 hereby declared that in some documents of my miner daughter namely Mahroz Fatima my name wrongly written as Mahammad Javed Iqbal instead of Md Jawaid Equbal. In future I will be known as Md Jawaid Equbal for all purposes. 0071059547-1

I,hitherto known as Anurag s/o-Sanjay Kumar, R/o-M-597, Shakurpur, JJ-Colony, Saraswati Vihar, Delhi-34, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Anurag Kumar Singh. 0040877246-2

I,Bina,W/O-Jugal Kishor Kejriwal,R/O.B-3/52,Rajasthali Apartment,Pitampura, Delhi-110034,have changed my name to Bina Kejriwal. Henceforth, i would be known by the name of Bina Kejriwal for all future purposes. 0040877412-10

I, Pratik Kumar, S/o Rabindra Prasad, R/o 92-K, Sector-4, Pushp Vihar, Delhi-110017, have changed the name of my minor daughter Prisha Ranjan aged 5 years and she shall hereafter be known as Nitara Ranjan. 0040877381-1

I RAHAT FAREED AHMED SHAIKH, W/O - NADIR JAWAID SYED,R/O - H NO- C-182, AJMAL BAGH NOOR NAGAR JAMIA NAGAR SOUTH DELHI-110025,HAVE CHANGE MY NAME,TO RAHAT FAREED SHAIKH FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040877402-8

I,NITIN CHOUDHARY @ NITIN KUMAR,S/O-BABU SINGH,R/O-1076,GROUND FLOOR,GREEN FIELD COLONY,FARIDABAD-121010 HAVE CHANGE MY MINOR SON NAME ABEER CHAUDHARY TO ABEER CHOUDHARY. 0040877408-4

I, Bhavika Sethi D/o Sunil Kumar Sethi R/o Flat No-1304, Tower-C, ACE Aspire Techzone-4, Greater Noida West, UP-201306, have changed my name to BHAVICA SETHI for all future purposes. 0071059550-1

I,Beer Pal Singh,s/o-Sarda Ram,R/o-Village Saini,Greater Noida,Gautam Budh Nagar, UP-203207 have changed my name to Beerpal for all future purposes. 0040877412-3

I, H C BEHRA S/O JAGBANDHU BEHERA born on 10/04/1966 residing at 28 Bhogal Road Jangpura New Delhi, have changed my name to HARISH CHANDRA BEHERA vide affidavit dated 03/9/2026 at DELHI 0050297236-1

I,DINESH KUMAR/ DINESH KUMAR BARI,S/O KARTAR SINGH,R/O FLAT NO- T-501 AMRAPALI SILICON CITY,SEC-76 NOIDA,GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR-201301 UP,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME,TO DINESH BARI,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040877434-6

I,Om Parkash,S/o-Gurnam Singh R/o H.No. 1850/5, Vashisht Colony, Thanesar (Haryana)have changed my name to Jasvinder Singh for all Purposes. 0040877402-1

I,MANJEET KAUR TAKKAR, W/O-KAVINDER SINGH,R/O-2/69, JANGPURA-A NEW DELHI-110014,have changed my name from MANJEET KAUR TAKKAR to MANJEET KAUR,for all purposes. 0040877409-7

I, Virendra Kumar Sirohi S/o Tej Singh Sirohi R/o-38, Chankyapuri, Meerut, UP have changed my name to Virender Kumar Sirohi. 0071059557-1

I,Rajiv Kumar,S/o Atam Prakash Minglani,R/o 426,2nd Floor,Dr. Mukherjee Nagar, North West Delhi-110009 have changed my name to Rajiv Kumar Minglani. 0040877408-6

I, Hardeep Singh alias Hardeep Singh Anand S/o Satinder Singh R/o S-1/114, G/F, Old Mahavir Nagar, Tilak Nagar, Delhi - 110018, want to declare that, my correct name is Hardeep Singh. 0040877285-1

I, Aprajita W/o Neeraj Kant Panwar R/o C-121, Radha Garden, Mawana Road, Meerut, UP-250001, have changed my name to APRAJITA PANWAR for all future purposes. 0071059552-1

I,TARUN AGARWAL,S/o-Kailash Chand Agarwal,R/o-B2/258-Upper Ground Floor Paschim Viha,near Doon Public School West Delhi,Delhi-110063,have Changed my name to TARUN KUMAR AGARWAL, permanently 0040877412-5

I MD Zamiruddin S/o Noor Mohammad R/o Vill Pelawal, Post Pelawal, Thana Katkamsandi, Hazaribagh, Po-Hazaribagh, Dist-Hazaribagh, Jharkhand - 825301, have changed my name to Mohammad Jamiruddin 0071059601-1

I,MANDEEP KUMAR,S/o-RAM PHAL R/o-KILOI KHAS (60),ROHTAK, H:R - 124401. Have Changed My Minor CHILD Name UDAY to UDAY HOODA. 0040877434-8

I,Ashok Vatwani,S/o-Sant Ram,R/o-H.No-42-43,B-9, Sector -3,Rohini, Delhi -110085, have changed my name to Ashok Kumar for all Purposes for all Purposes. 0040877402-3

I,KAMLA DEVI MOTHER OF PANKAJ KUMAR,R/O-VILLAGE-KOYALPUR,POST-KHETAWAS, District-Jhajjar,HARYANA-124109,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM KAMLA DEVI TO KAMLA VIDE AFFIDAVIT, DATED 08/09/2026 BEFORE NCT DELHI. 0040877408-8

I,Yash,S/o-Mr.Ved Prakash residing at G-271 Dakshin Puri Dr. Ambedkar Nagar New Delhi-110062,have changed my name from Yash to Yash Verma for all future purposes. 0040877434-5

I,Firoz Khan,S/o-Sh.Subeddin,R/o-B-2,Gali No.-20,North Ghonda, Subhash Mohalla,Delhi-110053,hereby declare that the name of my son,Aatif Firoz,who is studying in Class IX-B,Roll No.-3,at Gyandeep Vidya Bhawan, Yamuna Vihar, Delhi,was inadvertently recorded in the school records as "Aatif Firoz" instead of his correct name "Atif Firoz." The correct name of my son is "Atif Firoz" and the same shall henceforth be read,known and recorded as "Atif Firoz" for all purposes and in all records 0040877409-1

I, Ashok Kumar S/o late Rattan Chand R/o A-188, Pandara Road, Khan Market,Pandara Road, Lodhi Road, Central Delhi-110003, have changed my name to Ashok Kumar Dhiman 0071059584-1

I,Anshu Bakshi w/o.Mukul Sharma,R/o.193,Kautilya Apartment,Dwarka Sector-14,NSIT Dwarka,South West Delhi-110078,have changed my name to ANSHU BAKSHI SHARMA permanently 0040877434-1

I,SANJAY KUMAR JAIN,S/o-Suresh Jain R/o BE-354A, Gali No.1, Hari Nagar, Delhi-110064, have changed my name to SANJAY JAIN permanently. 0040877409-2

I, Churmanni Rana S/o Om Bahadur Rana R/o H No-UGF D-33/3, KH No-478, Flat No-A-1, Indira Enclave, Neb Sarai, PO: IGNOU, DIST: south Delhi, Delhi-110068 have changed my name from Churmanni to Churmanni Rana and father's name from Om Bahadur to Om Bahadur Rana. In future I will be known as Churmanni Rana for all purposes. 0040877239-1

I,hitherto known as DARSAN Son of Sh. DVARIKA PRASAD,R/o-H.No. 198, F-6, First Floor,Saket Block, MANDAWALI,DELHI - 110092,have changed my name,and shall hereafter be known,as DARSHAN SHARMA 0040877402-10

I Aniketa D/O Mukesh Kumar Tiwari R/O Flat No-401,Fourth Floor,A-29/1,Panchsheel Vihar,Malviya Nagar,Delhi-110017 Have Changed my Name to Annie. 0040877412-7

I, hitherto known as Pityush Kumar Tiwary, S/o Jai Prakash Tiwary, R/o Maura, P.O. Chandrakaithi, District Rohtas, Bihar-821104, have changed my name from Pityush Kumar Tiwary to Piyush Kumar Tiwary and shall hereafter be known as Piyush Kumar Tiwary for all the purposes. 0071059554-1

I Aniketa D/O Mukesh Kumar Tiwari R/O Flat No-401,Fourth Floor,A-29/1,Panchsheel Vihar,Malviya Nagar,Delhi-110017 Have Changed my Name to Annie. 0040877412-7

I, RAVI KUNDILE VEETIL S/O Koran Mappila Valappil, 1179-A, Housing Board Colony, Sector-29, Faridabad-121008, have changed my name to RAVI VEETIL KUNDIL. 0071059604-1

I, VERONICA ARORA W/o. VAIBHAV TIWARI R/o. Y-172, DLF CAPITAL GREENS, MOTI NAGAR, Delhi-110015 have changed the name of my minor SON from KRISHNA ARORA TIWARI to KRISHNA TIWARI. 0040877442-1

I,Gagan Verma,W/o-Jitender Sharma,R/o-Flat No.-789,GH-14,Paschim Vihar, Delhi -110087, have changed my name to Gagan Varma for all Purposes. 0040877402-5

I,Jasnil Singh,S/O.Surinder Singh Gujral,R/O.WZ-7A/1A,First Floor, Plot no. 46,Santgarh, Tilak Nagar,New Delhi-110018,have changed my name to Jasnil Singh Gujral for all Purposes 0040877408-1

I,Pooja Rani,W/o-Jabar Singh,R/o-House No-570,Lado Bagri,Jatto Gate,Karnal, Haryana-132001,have changed my name to Puja Rani for all purposes. 0040877434-3

I Ajay Kumar S/o Manoj Sah R/o Mayur Vihar Phase-1 Delhi changed name from Ajay Shah to Ajay Gupta DOB 06/11/2005 0130069053-1

I, SANJEEV KUMAR S/o Ram Kala R/o House No.2,Village Begumpur Delhi-110086 have changed my name to SANJEEV YADAV. 0040877409-4

I, Mohd Kaunain Iqbal S/o Md Jawaid Equbal R/o Block No.201, Quarter No.04, Sector-1, Pushp Vihar, New Delhi-110017 hereby declared that in some documents mine and my father's name wrongly written as Mohammad Kaunain Iqbal S/o Mahammad Javed Iqbal instead of Mohd Kaunain Iqbal S/o Md Jawaid Equbal. In future I will be known as Mohd Kaunain Iqbal S/o Md Jawaid Equbal for all purposes. 0071059546-1

I, Rajesh Rehani s/o-Dharamvir Rehani, R/o-B-143, Karam Pura, New Delhi-15, have changed my name to Rajesh Kumar Rehani. 0040877246-1

I,ALEXANDER LUCOSE,S/o-Lukose Kunjachan,R/o.B-55,First Floor,Jeevan Park, Uttam Nagar, Delhi-110059, have changed my name to ALEXANDER LUKOSE permanently. 0040877412-9

I,MOHAMMAD YAMEEN,S/O-ABDUL QAREEM,R/O-H NO-306,BASRA COLONY,NTPC ROAD,NEAR CHAND MASJID PIPLEHDA DISTRICT HAPUR UTTAR PRADESH-245301, HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO YAMEEN FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040877402-7

I,NIRANJAN DAS S/O BRAJLAL R/O AGRAWAL COLONY WARD NO-3 SAMPLA ROHTAK HARYANA-124501,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO NIRANJAN KUMAR 0040877408-3

It is for general information that I,Tenzin Thinley,S/O Kesang Phunsok,R/O-House No-82,Tibetan Colony,Nalapani,Dehradun, Uttarakhand-248001,declare that name of mine and my father have been wrongly-written as Tenzin Tyenly and Kelsang Phunsok in my IC bearing-No.Y012226849. The actual name of mine and my father are Tenzin Thinley and Kesang Phunsok 0040877242-1

I,KAVINDER SINGH TAKKAR,S/O-LATE BHAGWAN SINGH,R/O-2/69 JANGPURA-A, NEW DELHI-110014,have changed my name from KAVINDER SINGH TAKKAR to KAVINDER SINGH,for all purposes. 0040877409-6

I,ROZY W/O PREM KUMAR KHERA,R/o-P-1501,Jaipuria Sunrise Greens Ahinsa Khand-1,Indirapuram,Ghaziabad,Utta r-Pradesh-201014,Change My Name to ROSY KHERA New Name Permanently. 0040877412-2

I, Kavita Tyagi alias Kavita Singh W/o Shri Punit Dutt Tyagi, D/o Lt. General Jageshwar Nath Singh (Retd.) R/o House No. 433, Sector-28, Near Atta MarketArun Vihar, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Kavita Tyagi. 0040877405-1

I Gaurav Srivastava S/o Late Ramesh Chand Srivastava R/o L 608 Stellar Jeevan Greater Noida West Bishrakh Sector 1 Gautam Buddha Nagar UP-201306 have changed my name from Gaurav Srivastava to Gaurav Kumar Srivastava. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Gaurav Kumar Srivastava for all future purpose. 0071059548-1

I,Narender Solanki,S/O-Virender Singh,R/O.C-1/13-14,House No.102,Chandu Lal Colony,Budh Vihar,Phase-2, Delhi-110086, have Changed my name to Narender Singh. 0040877412-11

I,Husain Bano D/o-Navi Ahamd W/o-Mohammad Miyan, R/o-A-330, Navjeevan Camp, Govindpuri, Kalkaji, New Delhi-19, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Husan Bano. 0040877386-1

I FARAH CHAWLA,W/O ZUBAIR CHAWLA,R/O - H NO- 1752,GALI MIR JUMLA LAL KUAN DELHI-110006,HAVE CHANGE MY NAME,TO REHMAT FARHA FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040877402-9

I,MD MIRAJ SHEKH,S/O-NABINAWAJ SHEKH,R/O HOUSE NO-8,THIRD FLOOR,HUMAYUN PUR SAFDARJUNG ENCLAVE NEW DELHI 110029 HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO MIRAJ 0040877408-5

I, Neha Arora, W/o Mayank Bhatia R/o CM4-1901, Supertech Capetown, Sector 74, Noida, UP-201301, have changed my name to Neha Arora Bhatia for all future purposes. 0071059551-1

I,Manan Agarwal,S/o-Saurabh Aggarwal,R/o-32,Neelgiri Apptt,Sector-9, Rohini Delhi-110085,that in my passport no.M 4165744, my mother name is wrongly written as Menakshi Agarwal instead,of Meenakshi Aggarwal.Which may be amended accordingly. 0040877412-4

I Ravikishan Kumar S/o Umesh Yadav R/o Gram Jhapaniya Thana Bounsi, Vtc-Bausi, Po-Bounsi, Sub Dist-Bausi, Dist-Banka, Bihar - 813104, have changed my name to Ravi Kumar 0071059600-1

I,ABHISHEK S/O-RAJESHWAR SHARMA R/O - E -634, GANESH NAGAR-2, SHAKARPUR, DELHI - 110092 have changed my name to ABHISHEK SHARMA 0040877434-7

I,Anita Devi,W/o Dushyant R/o H.No. -1332, Kilod Pana, Mehrana, Jhajjar (Haryana), have changed my name to Anita for all Purposes. 0040877402-2

AI, Harpreet Kour Bhatia W/o Naman Nischal R/o,WZ-66/5, Second-Floor-A, Manohar Nagar, Vikas-Puri, New Delhi-110018,have changed my name to Harpreet Kaur Bhatia. 0040877409-8

I,Anju Miglani W/o Rajiv Kumar Minglani R/o 426,Dr. Mukherjee Nagar, North West,Delhi-110009 have Changed my name to Anju Minglani. 0040877408-7

I, SACHIN CHAWLA S/O JAGAN NATH CHAWLA R/O 1C-119, NH-1, FARIDABAD, FARIDABAD HARYANA, 121001 have changed the name of my minor Son from VANSH CHAWLA to VANSSH CHAWLA for all purposes. 0071059558-1

I, Neeraj Kant Panwar S/o Shiv Charan Kant Panwar R/o C-121, Radha Garden, Mawana Road, Meerut, UP-250001, have changed my minor son's name from SHREYANSH to SHREYANSH PANWAR for all future purposes. 0071059553-1

I,SURINDER PRASAD GUPTA @ SURINDER KUMAR S/o-Niranjan Prasad R/o-Jhugi-No,B-13 Chuna-Bhatti Kirti-Nagar New Delhi-110015,both names belong to same person i.e. myself 0040877412-6

I, Km. Sadhna W/o Late Prem Singh, 80, SF(front side), Indraprastha Colony, Sector-32-33, Faridabad-121003, have changed my name to SADHANA. 0071059603-1

I,SANDEEP KUMAR,S/o-RAM PHAL R/o-KILOI KHAS (60),ROHTAK,H:R-124401. Have Changed My Minor CHILD Name GEET to GEET HOODA. 0040877434-9

I,Jitender,S/o-Ramesh Chand Sharma,R/o-Flat No.-789, GH-14, Paschim Vihar, Delhi - 110087, have changed my name to Jitender Sharma for all Purposes. 0040877402-4

I, Laxman Prasad, son of Pancham Lal, R/o Chatur Khera Gondwa Hardoi UP, hereby declare that my name was earlier written in Hindi as "लक्ष्मण प्रसाद", which has now been corrected to "लक्ष्मण प्रसाद". The correct English spelling of his name is "Laxman Prasad".

LOST & FOUND

My sale deed vide registration number 8,914 book-no.1,volume number-613 page-no.115 to 116 on dated-13/6/1972 has been lost at Delhi on dated-13/5/2025 finder contact: Prem Lata Jain,W/o-Subhash Chand Jain,R/o-M-43, Jagat Ram-Park,Laxmi-Nagar, Delhi-110092.Mobile No.9811483454. 0040877409-10

Original GPA,ATS,Will, receipt, Date-11/12/1974, and GPA,ATS,receipt,will, on DT.11/06/1975,duty attested by notary public, Delhi and sale deed registration No.2486,book no.1,Vol.No.311,pages 173 to 174,on DT.22/02/1971, has been lost at Delhi finder contact:Mohd Afzal,S/o-Mohd ikram R/o-848, Chandni-Mahal, Darya-Ganj, Delhi-110002 Mobile No.9891143015. 0040877409-9

Lost Original Property Documents,1.Sale Deed Duly Regd.No.426 in Addition Book-1,Volume No.1935, Page No.117 To 121 Dated-27-02-1987 With SR IV, Delhi. 2,GPA Agreement To Sell,Receipt Affidavit Executed By Suraj Bali Dated-21-10-1986 Attested By Notary Public. 3,GPA Executed By Mohan Lal on 27-11-1986 GPA,Agreement To Sell Receipt,Affidavit. Property Detail:145,Gali Ganga Ram, Shahdara,Delhi-110032,Area 150 Sq.Yards, Khasra No.642 0040877408-10

LOST AND FOUND

I, **SHIRSHI RAJESH W/O LATE RAJESH R/O 143 SAMMAN BAZAR BHOGAL NEW DELHI-110014** am the owner of the **ENTIRE BUILT-UP GROUND FLOOR (WITHOUT TERRACE RIGHTS) OF THE PROPERTY BEARING NO.U-91-A SHAKARPUR DELHI-110091 MEASURING 50 SQ YARDS COMPRISED IN KHASRA NO.132** hereby inform that previous chain of previous owner namely **RAM PYARI** Property **Original Registered** Sale Deed Registration No.5255 Book No.1 Vol No.206 page 92-93 dated 21.07.1970 registered in the office of Sub Registrar Delhi has been Lost, if found Contact me **+91-9540561365.**

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

IT IS HEREBY INFORMED THAT MR. ANKUSH SHARMA, WHO HAS APPLIED FOR A LOAN FROM LIC HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED (LICHFL), HAS REPORTED THE DEATH OF MRS. KALAWATI SAINI @ KALAVATI & MR. NARAIN DAS SAINI, WHO EXPIRED ON 05.06.1996 & 02.01.2000. THE LOAN PERTAINS TO THE RESIDENTIAL FREEHOLD RESIDENTIAL THIRD FLOOR, WITH ROOF RIGHTS, BUILT-UP BACK SIDE PORTION OF FREEHOLD PROPERTY BEARING NO. 29 IN BLOCK-C AREA MEASURING 211 SQ. YDS. (OUT OF TOTAL AREA 422 SQ. YDS.) OUT OF KHASRA NO. 262/258/217/4 SITUATED IN THE AREA OF VILLAGE BHAROLA, COLONY KNOWN AS ADARSH NAGAR, DELHI-110033. IT IS FURTHER INFORMED THAT THE SELLER, NAMELY (I) MR. HARISH KUMAR (HAVING 25% UNDIVIDED SHARE), (II) MR. NIKESH GUPTA (HAVING 25% UNDIVIDED SHARE), (III) MR. SANJAY KUMAR (HAVING 25% UNDIVIDED SHARE) & (IV) MRS. MANJU GOEL (HAVING 25% UNDIVIDED SHARE), DO NOT POSSESS THE SURVIVING MEMBER CERTIFICATE OF THE ABOVE-NAMED DECEASED PERSON AND HAVE STATED THAT THERE ARE NO OTHER LEGAL HEIRS IN RESPECT OF THE AFORESAID PROPERTY. IF ANY OTHER CLAIMENT HAS ANY RIGHT IN THE AFORESAID PROPERTY, HE/SHE SHOULD INFORM & GIVE INTIMATION TO THE UNDERSIGNED WITHIN 15 DAYS FROM THE DATE OF ISSUE OF THIS NOTICE.

Sd/-
B.K. MUKHERJEE
Advocate
3657/6, G.F., Narang Colony,
Tri Nagar, Delhi-110035.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to public at large that my clients **(1) SMT. RAKHA DEVI W/O SH. RAM DAS (2) SH. RAM DAS S/O LATE SH. MISHRI DHAR BOTH R/O B-6, SHIV VIHAR, VIKAS NAGAR, UTTAM NAGAR, NEW DELHI-110059**, have severed all their relations from their sons **(1) MR. SANTOSH (alongwith his wife SMT. RAJKUMARI** D/O SH. MAHENDER PAL and their children Sunny, Aniket, Nikhil and Ishu), **(2) MR. GIRIJESH (alongwith his wife SMT. SONI** D/O SH. MAHENDER PAL and their children Vishal, Alisha and Nisha) and their associates, disowned and debarred all of them from all their movable and immovable properties with immediate effect because of harassment, threaten, torture, cruelty, atrocities committed by them against my clients. Any person dealing with them shall be doing so at their own risk, cost and consequences. My clients shall not be responsible in any manner for the same.

A.K. VERMA (ADVOCATE)
Off: 319, S.R.II, District Centre, Janakpuri, ND-58

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public At Large Is Hereby Informed That My Client(s) Is/Are Interested To Buy freehold In Respect Of Freehold Property Bearing No.-168, Third Floor With Its Roof Rights, Land Area Measuring-48 Sq.Mtrs, In Block-A, Pocket-1, Sector-11, Situated In The Layout Plan of Rohini Residential Scheme, Rohini, Delhi. Presently Owned And Possessed By (1) Smt Manju Shukla w/o Sh Mahesh Shukla By Virtue Of SALE Deed, Dated-21.06.2023, Regd No.-7169, SR-VI-NEW DELHI/DELHI, And As Per Present Owner Version The Said Property/Flat/Floor/Apartment Is/Are Free From All Sorts Of Encumbrances. Link Documents. 1. Allotment Letter-1988, 2. Handing Over Possession-14.01.1992, 3. Possession Certificate-26.03.1992, 4. Sanction Letter-03.09.1996, 5. Perpetual Lease Deed-27.03.1996, 6. Surviving Member Certficate, 7. Mutation Letter-22.11.2013, Are Missing And Duly Informed Vide LR No.-615313/2026, Dated-08.09.2026, (With SHO PRASHANT VIHAR).
It is hereby notified that any person or entity, firm/company, Bank, HUF/member of HUF, financial institution having any claim,any charge,interest or lien or claim in the above said property the basis of documents and/or objection to thereof, he/she/they may lodge/notify the same to the undersigned with documentary proof/court judgment within 15 days from the day of publication of this public notice, failing which any further/future claim/objection(s) shall be rejected and my client/prospective buyer(s) as a **bona-fide** purchaser conclude the title/Sale Deed proposed to be executed in favor of my client(s) or in the name of his/her/their nominees shall be deemed to be clear and marketable without any defect, encumbrance, flaw and impediment.

MITHILESH KUMAR (ADVOCATE)
Ch. No. 717, Rohini Court, Delhi-85. Mob. 9810593109

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client Mrs. Mahendro W/o Late Sh. Dharam Bir, R/o 137, Issapur, South West Delhi, Delhi-73, have severed all her relations from grand-daughter Ms. Nidhi, D/O Sandeep, and disowned/debarred her from all of her movable-immovable properties. My client shall not be responsible for her acts.

Anita Gupta Sharma (Advocate)
Ch. No.608 Saket Court,
New Delhi-17

PUBLIC NOTICE

The general public is hereby informed/notified that my client, Sh. Suresh Kumar Bansal S/O Late Sh. Hazari Lal Bansal R/O Ward No. 17, Hudda Colony, H. No. 25, Ellenabad, Sirsa, Haryana, (M):9466001953, is the absolute owner in possession of land of Khasra No. 1081 (1-1), at Village Rangpuri @Malikpuri Kohi, Teh. V.V. Sub-Division, ND, by virtue of regd. sale deed dt. 02.02.1982. Hence, any individual or legal entity whosoever is warned to refrain from entering into any kind of transaction for sale or purchase of the said land or dealing with in any manner whatsoever, shall be doing so at their own risk, peril, costs & consequences.

SS Panwar & Associates
Enrl. D-297/1979 (advocates)
Ch. No. 348, Block-I, Delhi High Court, New Delhi-110003
(M): 9312234919, 9716700004

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public is hereby informed that my client Sh. Rajender Luthra S/o Lt. Tilak Raj Luthra resident of 209/2, Phase I-A Om Vihar. Uttam Nagar, Delhi. 110059 has severed all his relations with his son Sh. Chetan Luthra and his wife Smt. Bhavika Luthra due to their bad habits and conduct. My above named client has also disowned and debarred his said son and daughter-in-law from all his movable and immovable properties. Henceforth, Sh. Chetan Luthra and Smt. Bhavika Luthra shall have no right, title, interest or claim whatsoever in any of the movable or immovable properties of my client.

Anybody dealing with Sh. Chetan Luthra and Smt. Bhavika Luthra shall do so at his/her own risk and responsibility and my client shall not be responsible for any act, deed, transaction, liability or dealing undertaken by them. No person is authorized to enter into any transaction on behalf of my client through them.

Sd/-
Richa Babbar
Advocate
P-1 Post Office Lane,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is hereby informed to the General Public that I, Sanjaya Gupta S/O Prem Nath Gupta R/O 46, Anekant Apartment 23 Vasundhara Enclave New Delhi-110096 India, has lost Original Provisional Allotment Letter for Unit No. SOC000A065, Customer Code: 396884 and Sales Order No.50798. I have also lost Original Payment Receipts No. 2300026536 dated 01.10.2014 of Rs 3,50,000/-, No. 2300003316 dated 06.05.2015 of Rs. 5,20,400/- issued by Jaypee Infratech Limited in respect of bearing Unit Reference No. SOC000A065 in **YAMUNA VIHAR at JAYPEE GREENS SPORTS CITY EAST, GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR**, on 04.09.2026 at Mayur Vihar, New Delhi. Any one finding the said documents is requested to kindly return the same to us or the Company.

Name: Sanjaya Gupta
Address: 46, Anekant Apartment 23 Vasundhara Enclave New Delhi-110096 India.
Phone No: 9810003467
Email: sanjaya@4cplus.com

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, **Sh. Rajesh Kumar S/o Sh. Krishan Kumar R/o H. No. 458-A, PanaDhaniwara, Bawana, Delhi-110039**, hereby declare that I have disinherit and **disowned** all my ancestral and self-acquired moveable and immoveable property and assets, **and severed all relations with my son, Sh. Vansh Sehrawat** on account of his continuous **misbehaviour, misconduct and acts contrary to my wishes and instructions**.
They have gone completely astray, are not acting according to my advice or wishes, and are no longer under my control. I shall not be responsible for any of their acts, omissions, debts, liabilities, or dealings with any person.
The general public is hereby cautioned **not to deal with them in my name or on my behalf**, as I shall not be responsible for any such transaction or representation.

Subhash Sharawat (Advocate) D/46/2015
Shop No. 12, Basement, Shiv Market,
Near Sub-Registrar Office, Alipur, Delhi-36

PUBLIC NOTICE

My clients Mr. Sandeep S/o Late Sh. Dharam Bir & Mrs. Geeta W/o Mr. Sandeep Both R/o 137, Choudhary Mohalla, Issa Pur, South West Delhi, Delhi-73, have severed all their relations from their daughter Ms. Nidhi and disowned/debarred her from all of their movable-immovable properties. My clients shall not be responsible for her acts.

Anita Gupta Sharma (Advocate)
Ch. No.608 Saket Court,
New Delhi-17

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Letter No: 787 **E-Tender Time Extension Notice-1** Date: 8/09/2026

Due to unavoidable circumstances the date of submission and opening of following e-tender invited by the office of the Executive Engineer (Gen.), MB-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) is hereby extended as follows:
Tender No.22/EE (GEN)/MB-II/2026-27: Procurement of various spares for CCTV surveillance system at MB-II, Dharasu Power house, Chinyalisaur, Uttarkashi.
Last date of submission of bids on website: - 15.09.2026 up to 11:00 Hrs.
Last date of submitting hard copy of document in the office of Executive Engineer (Gen.), MB-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi): 15.09.2026 up to 11:00 Hrs.
Date of opening of bids on website: - 18.09.2026 up to 11:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal **http://uktenders.gov.in**

Executive Engineer (Generation) Dharasu Power House

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CIN No.U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website:www.ujvnl.com

पत्र संख्या: 786 दिनांक: 08/09/2026

Tender Corrigendum and date extension notice-2

Tender no 12/EE (Civil-III)/LMP/2026-27 ITT Clause 2(b) is here by amended As per tender "The vehicle should not be older than 3 Years" After Amendment "The vehicle should not be older than 4+1 Years"
Therefore, the date of submission and opening of tender No 12/EE (Civil-III)/LMP/2026-27 invited for the work of Excavation Contract (Civil-III), Lakhwar Multipurpose Project, Dakpathar (Distt-Dehradun), are revised as following. The other terms and condition of the tender shall remain unchanged.
Last date of downloading of bid: 14.09.2026 up to 13:00 hrs
Last date of submission of documents: 14.09.2026 up to 13:30 hrs
Due date for opening of Tender: 15.09.2026 up to 11:30 hrs
For fuller & further details, kindly visit Nigam's website **www.ujvnl.com**.

Executive Engineer (Civil-III)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

INDIA EXPOSITION MART LTD.
CIN: U82300DL2001PLC110396
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Email id: cs@indiaexpocentre.com, Website: www.indiaexpomart.com

NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS

25TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING & INFORMATION ON E-VOTING

Notice is hereby given that the 25th Annual General Meeting ('AGM') of the shareholders of India Exposition Mart Ltd. ('the Company') is scheduled to be held on **Wednesday, September 30, 2026**, at **4:00 PM (IST)** at **"Govt. Servants Co-operative House Building Society Limited", Kalyan Kendra, 9, Institutional Marg, Vasant Vihar, New Delhi - 110057** to transact the business(es) as stated in the notice, sent to the shareholders individually.

The Notice of the AGM has been dispatched to all the shareholders whose email IDs are registered with the Company. Physical copies of the same have been sent to all other shareholders at their registered address in the permitted mode. The Notice is also available on the website of the Company at **www.indiaexpomart.com** and of the Central Depository Services (India) Limited ('CDSL') at **www.evotingindia.com**. The dispatch of notice of AGM has been completed on Tuesday, September 8, 2026.

The documents pertaining to the business(es) to be transacted at the AGM are available for inspection at the Registered Office of the Company between 12 Noon to 3:00 PM on all working days, except Saturday, Sunday and Gazetted Holidays, upto the date of AGM.

In compliance with the provisions of Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013, read with applicable rules thereto, and Secretarial Standards-2 issued by the Institute of Company Secretaries of India, the shareholders will have an opportunity to cast their votes remotely by electronic means (**Remote E-voting**), facilitated by CDSL, on all the resolutions set forth in the notice. The remote e-voting shall commence on **Sunday, September 27, 2026**, at **10:00 AM (IST)** and will end on **Tuesday, September 29, 2026**, at **5:00 PM (IST)**. The remote e-voting module shall be disabled by CDSL for voting thereafter. Kindly refer the notice of the AGM regarding instructions on e-voting.

- The Company shall also provide facility for voting during the AGM. Shareholders attending the meeting who have not already casted their vote by remote e-voting shall be able to exercise their right to vote at the AGM. The shareholders who have casted their vote by remote e-voting prior to the meeting may participate in the meeting but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again.
- The **cut-off date for determining the eligibility to vote by electronic means or at the AGM is Wednesday, September 23, 2026.** A person whose name is recorded in the register of members as on the cut-off date shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting or voting facility available at the meeting, as the case may be.
- Any person who has acquired shares of the Company and becomes shareholder after dispatch of the Notice and holding shares as on cut-off date, may obtain the login id and password by sending a request at **helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com** with a copy marked to **cs@indiaexpocentre.com** by mentioning DP ID/ Client ID.
- If you have any queries or issues regarding e-Voting from the CDSL e-Voting System, you can contact at toll free no. 18002109911 or write an email to **helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com**
- The results of voting would be declared as stipulated under the relevant rules and will also be posted on the above-mentioned Company's and CDSL website.

By Order of the Board of Directors
For India Exposition Mart Ltd.
Sd/-
September 9, 2026 Anupam Sharma
Delhi **Group Company Secretary & Compliance Officer**

"IMPORTANT"

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BRIDCUL (ब्रिडकुल) CIN No. : U45203UR2008SGC032591
ब्रिज, रोपवे, टनल एण्ड अदर इन्फ्रास्ट्रक्चर डेवलपमेंट कॉरपोरेशन ऑफ उत्तराखण्ड लिमिटेड
(उत्तराखण्ड सरकार का उपक्रम) पूर्व में उत्तराखण्ड राज्य अवस्थापना विकास निगम लिमिटेड
परियोजना ईकाई–हल्द्वानी, ईकाई कार्यालय : रौतेला कॉलोनी, छोटी मुखानी, पो0ऑ0–बड़ी मुखानी, हल्द्वानी, नैनीताल–263139

पत्रांक : 1714/ब्रिडकुल/टेण्डर–105/2026 दिनांक : 08.09.2026

नीलामी सूचना

महामहिम राज्यपाल, उत्तराखण्ड, की ओर से प्रबन्ध निदेशक ब्रिडकुल द्वारा इस निगम में सम्बन्धित श्रेणी–II (2 से 5 करोड़ तक के सिविल निर्माण कार्यों) हेतु पंजीकृत एवं अनुभव प्राप्त ठेकेदारों/फर्मों से मदवार दरों पर टू–बिड सिस्टम के आधार पर निम्नानुसार ई–निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है:–

S. No.	Ref. No.	Name of Project	Estimated Cost including (GST & all Taxes) (In Lac)	Earnest Money (in lac)	Cost of Tender Document (in Rs.)	Times Period
1.	BRIDCUL/ HLD/04/ 2026-27	डॉ0 ए0पी0जे0 अब्दुल कलाम प्रौद्योगिकी संस्थान, टनकपुर, चम्पावत में निर्माणाधीन अनावासीय भवनों के अवशेष निर्माण कार्य।	300.33	6.01	5000 + 18% G.S.T.	06 माह

उपरोक्त निविदा प्रपत्र डाउनलोड करने की प्रारम्भ तिथि 11.09.2026, अपराह्न 03.00 बजे तथा निविदा जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि 25.09.2026 अपराह्न 03.00 बजे तक है। उपरोक्त के सम्बन्ध में वर्णित निविदा सम्बन्धी विस्तृत जानकारी एवं निविदा प्रपत्र व किसी भी प्रकार के परिवर्तन आदि की सूचना वेबसाईट https://uktenders.gov.in पर उपलब्ध होगी।
अधोहस्ताक्षरी को बिना कोई कारण बताये निविदा को स्वीकृत अथवा निरस्त करने का पूर्ण अधिकार होगा।

परियोजना प्रबन्धक

टेलीफैक्स:– 05946–264331 ई–मेल : pmbridculhld@gmail.com
BRIDCUL (ब्रिडकुल) CIN No. : U45203UR2008SGC032591
ब्रिज, रोपवे, टनल एण्ड अदर इन्फ्रास्ट्रक्चर डेवलपमेंट कॉरपोरेशन ऑफ उत्तराखण्ड लिमिटेड
(उत्तराखण्ड सरकार का उपक्रम) पूर्व में उत्तराखण्ड राज्य अवस्थापना विकास निगम लिमिटेड
परियोजना ईकाई–हल्द्वानी, ईकाई कार्यालय : रौतेला कॉलोनी, छोटी मुखानी, पो0ऑ0–बड़ी मुखानी, हल्द्वानी, नैनीताल–263139

पत्रांक : 1720/ब्रिडकुल/टेण्डर–106/2026 दिनांक : 08.09.2026

नीलामी सूचना

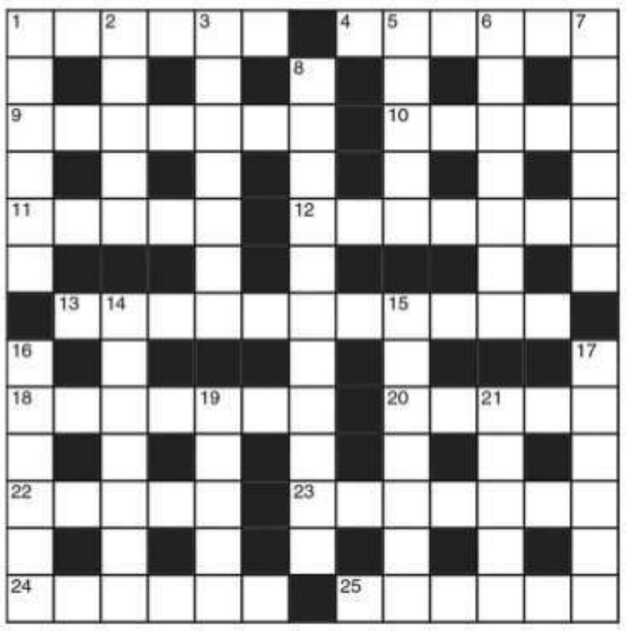
महामहिम राज्यपाल, उत्तराखण्ड, की ओर से प्रबन्ध निदेशक ब्रिडकुल द्वारा इस निगम में सम्बन्धित श्रेणी–III (02 करोड़ तक के सिविल निर्माण कार्यों) हेतु पंजीकृत एवं अनुभव प्राप्त ठेकेदारों/फर्मों से मदवार दरों पर टू–बिड सिस्टम के आधार पर निम्नानुसार ई–निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है:–

S. No.	Ref. No.	Name of Project	Estimated Cost including (GST & all Taxes) (In Lac)	Earnest Money (in lac)	Cost of Tender Document (in Rs.)	Times Period
1.	BRIDCUL/ HLD/03/ 2026-27	जनपद–अल्मोड़ा के विकासखण्ड द्वाराहाट के अन्तर्गत ग्राम सभा सकुनी में श्री सुकेश्वर महादेव मन्दिर के जीर्णोद्धार का अवशेष कार्य।	111.79	2.24	4000 + 18% G.S.T.	12 माह

उपरोक्त निविदा प्रपत्र डाउनलोड करने की प्रारम्भ तिथि 11.09.2026 अपराह्न 03.00 बजे तथा निविदा जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि 25.09.2026 अपराह्न 03.00 बजे तक है। उपरोक्त के सम्बन्ध में वर्णित निविदा सम्बन्धी विस्तृत जानकारी एवं निविदा प्रपत्र व किसी भी प्रकार के परिवर्तन आदि की सूचना वेबसाईट https://uktenders.gov.in पर उपलब्ध होगी।
अधोहस्ताक्षरी को बिना कोई कारण बताये निविदा को स्वीकृत अथवा निरस्त करने का पूर्ण अधिकार होगा।

परियोजना प्रबन्धक

• CROSSWORD 6089



ACROSS
1 Give travel guidance the shortest way (6)
4 Verse and essay by US writer (6)
9 Doctor Cameron in work of fiction (7)
10 Article about that particular place (5)
11 Left in a unit entirely without support? (5)
12 Changed speed or rested (7)
13 Dictator of no great importance (5,6)
18 It goes on incessantly even when idle (7)
20 Deposit a jacket and hood (5)
22 Mother making the final move? (5)
23 I've cut the tips for the salad (7)
24 Withdraw a direction to surrender (6)
25 A very personal description (6)

DOWN
1 Died in a city in Natal (6)
2 Codeword signalling end of affair for young lover (5)
3 Show co-operation (7)
5 Where a washer is always available (2,3)
6 Traitor's initial justification for his crime (7)
7 Gives way in determining the dividends (6)
8 Confidential sign employed by executives (11)
14 A commodity extensively used (7)
15 Quickly knock but to no avail (7)
16 Rascals given temporary accommodation on board (6)
17 Concentrate on providing a complete range (6)
19 Weary but tried anyway (5)
21 Show we hear to look back on (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6088 ACROSS: 1 Prosper, 5 Loser, 8 Statisticians, 9 Remit, 10 Outline, 11 Allure, 12 Bonnet, 15 Lassoed, 17 Prank, 19 Weather-beaten, 20 Drear, 21 Deserts DOWN: 1 Poser, 2 On a small scale, 3 Pointer, 4 Ration, 5 Licit, 6 Stationmaster, 7 Respect, 11 Allowed, 13 Oppress, 14 Adored, 16 Other, 18 Kings

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

All are lunatics, but he who can analyze his ___ is called a philosopher. — Ambrose Bierce (8)

DIXEO

BBEILN

GHTIS

CUPIDS

SOLUTIONS: Oxide, Sight, Nibble, Cupid
ANSWER: All are lunatics, but he who can analyze his **delusion** is called a philosopher. —Ambrose Bierce

• OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

• CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON

• MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG

SUDOKU 6436

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

	3	7				6	4	
	2	4	1		8	3	7	
	9						1	
			7	1	2			
7								6
			6	9	5			
	7						9	
	6	5	2		4	1	3	
	4	8				5	6	

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6435

4	6	8	5	3	7	1	2	9
7	1	9	4	8	2	5	3	6
5	2	3	9	1	6	8	7	4
6	7	5	2	9	1	3	4	8
1	3	2	8	6	4	7	9	5
9	8	4	3	7	5	2	6	1
8	9	7	6	5	3	4	1	2
2	5	1	7	4	9	6	8	3
3	4	6	1	2	8	9	5	7

• ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This is a solid day for you because you're motivated to work and accomplish something. This is half the battle. Motivation is everything. Talk to co-workers and friends. Tonight: Get organised.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Today the Moon will move into your fellow Earth sign, which will encourage a more lighthearted approach to life. Enjoy socialising with others. Your involvement with sports and the company of children will be rewarding. Tonight: Socialise.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): You have lots of mental energy today, which is why you want to share your ideas with someone. As the day wears on, home and family discussions will become important. Tonight: Relax at home.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): For a large part of this day, the Moon is in your Money House. During the Moon Alert, be smart and restrict your spending to food and gas. If you want to buy something, do your research, then act once the Moon Alert is over. Tonight: Stimulating discussions.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Today holds the promise of fun socialising and romantic escapades. Reach out to someone you care about. After the Moon Alert is over, shopping will be on your mind. Tonight: Check your money.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Today has a vague, lighthearted, dreamy quality until the Moon Alert is over. However, once the Moon moves into your sign to join the Sun and Mercury, it's all systems go. Tonight: You win.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): You're a social person, which is why you need others in your life. This day begins with a strong desire to talk to others or be involved in groups. However, after the Moon Alert, you need some peace and quiet. Tonight: Enjoy peace and quiet.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): For the first part of this day, you're noticed. You might have to do some damage control. Keep this in mind. After the Moon Alert, make an effort to talk to a friend or be involved with a group. This will be rewarding. Tonight: Be friendly.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Initially, you might feel a strong sense of escape today. You might want to run away and join the circus. You want to do something different. Take it easy, especially because this feeling will simmer during the Moon Alert, which makes you feel a bit rudderless. Tonight: You're admired.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Postpone important financial negotiations or banking decisions until the Moon Alert is over today. Welcome any opportunity to travel, learn and explore your world. Tonight: Explore.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): This morning you have to cooperate with others, which means you might have to go more than halfway. However, after the Moon Alert, you might make progress tying up loose ends and dealing with red tape matters related to shared property and banking. Tonight: Check your finances.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Go along to get along today, especially at work. After the Moon Alert today, the Moon will be opposite your sign, which means you have to be cooperative. Make no demands on yourself or on others. Tonight: Cooperate.

GOVT. OF JHARKHAND
JHARKHAND FLYING INSTITUTE
CABINET SECRETARIAT AND VIGILANCE DEPARTMENT
(CIVIL AVIATION DIVISION)
STATE HANGAR, AIRPORT ROAD, HINOO, RANCHI
email - cad@jharkhandaviation.in ; govtflyops@gmail.com

Ref.No.-VI-Canteen (Misc.)/13/2026–ना०वि०/635, /Ranchi/Date-03.09.2026

Notice

The Cabinet Secretariat and Vigilance Department (Civil Aviation Division), Government of Jharkhand invites bids through Government e-Marketplace (GeM) from eligible agencies/firms for Providing Canteen and Pantry Services at State Hangar, Ranchi. The details of tender can be seen in website https://www.gem.gov.in with GeM Bid Number-GEM/2026/B/ 7988541, Dtd.-02.09.2026. Interested bidder can submit their bid only through GeM Portal.

Sd/-
(Piyusha Shalina Dona Minz)
Under Secretary.

PR.NO.389148 Civil Aviation(26-27):D

JHARKHAND BIJLI VITRAN NIGAM LIMITED
(CIN:U40108JH2013SGC001702)
Engineering Building, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004
E-mail ID: dgm.ia@jbvnl.co.in

Expression of Interest (EOI)
EOI No.: -244/PR/JBVNL/2026-27
"Appointment of Internnal Auditor for FY' 2021-22 to FY' 2025-26"

Jharkhand Bijli Vitran Nigam Limited (JBVNL), Ranchi hereby invites 'Expression of Interest' (EOI) from Firms for conduct of Internal Audit for the FY's 2021-22 to 2025-26.

Important timelines of the EOI are as below: -

S. N	Activity	Timeline
1	Start of Availability of 'BID-DOCUMENTS'	12-09-2026 at 10.00 hrs
2	End of Availability of 'BID-DOCUMENTS'	29.09.2026 after 17.00 hrs
3	Pre-Bid Meeting	18.09.2026 at 11.30 am
4	Date and time of opening of Bids* – A. Technical Bid (Part-I) B. Financial Bid (Part-II) * Note: Part-II (Financial Bid) of only those bidder(s) will be opened whose Part-I (Technical Bid) is found responsive by JBVNL.	30.09.2026 TIME 14.00 hrs to be intimated after technical evaluation.
5	PLACE OF OPENING OF BIDS	Jharkhand Bijli Vitran Nigam Limited (JBVNL), Engineering Building, HEC, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004, Jharkhand, India
6	BID Inviting Authority	GM (F&A-IA), JBVNL, Engineering Building, HEC, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004, Jharkhand, India M-8210972284 E-mail id:gm.ia@jbvnl.co.in

स्वहित एवं राष्ट्रहित में ऊर्जा बचायें। कृपया अपनी शिकायतों को 18003456570(कॉल सेन्टर) पर दर्ज करायें।

Sd/-
General Manager (F&A)
Internal Audit, JBVNL

PR.NO.389285 Jharkhand Bijlee Vitran Nigam Ltd(26-27):D

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमंडल दुमका

शुद्धि-पत्र

एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि निविदा संख्या– 05/2026-27/RWD/EE/DUMKA, Dt.-06.08.2026 (PR No.-386931) में आंशिक संशोधन किया जाता है, जो निम्नरूपेण है :–

1. वेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि 21.08.2026 के स्थान पर तिथि 08.09.2026 पढ़ा जाए।
2. ई–निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय 12.09.2026 अपराह्न 5:00 बजे के स्थान पर तिथि 01.10.2026 अपराह्न 5:00 बजे पढ़ा जाए।
3. निविदा खोलने की तिथि 15.09.2026 एवं समय पूर्वाह्न 11:30 बजे के स्थान पर तिथि 03.10.2026 पूर्वाह्न 11:30 बजे पढ़ा जाए।
4. आईडेंटिफिकेशन संख्या/पैकेज संख्या– RWD/DUMKA/10/2026-27 में अंकित पथ का नामः– पंचायत–चकनिया में पी0डब्ल्यू0डी0 पथ से कोलहरिया पथ भाया मुस्लिम लोधना तक पथ निर्माण कार्य के स्थान पर **"पंचायत–चिकनिया में पी0डब्ल्यू0डी0 पथ से कोलहरिया पथ भाया मुस्लिम लोधना तक पथ निर्माण कार्य"** पढ़ा जाए।
5. आईडेंटिफिकेशन संख्या/पैकेज संख्या– RWD/DUMKA/08/2026-27 में अंकित पथ का नामः– ग्राम खिलकिनारी सिद्धो–कान्हु चौक से मचाडीह आर0ई0ओ0 रोड भाया हेठबहियारी एवं परगाडीह तक पथ निर्माण कार्य का कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि को 15 महीने के स्थान पर 18 महीने पढ़ा जाए।

शेष सभी शर्तें यथावत रहेंगी।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग,
कार्य प्रमंडल दुमका

PR 389174 Rural Work Department (26-27)_D

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, SUNABEDA
email- serwsbd2003@yahoo.com

25001/1099/2627

Letter No. **Date:**

NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH GePNIC e Procurement Notice

1. **Name of the Work** : Construction of Road Works - 05 Nos.
2. **Class of Contractor** : "B" & "A" Class of (Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authority.
3. **Estimated Cost** : Various from Rs.122.10 Lakhs to Rs.533.04 Lakhs (Approximately).
4. **Details Projects** : As per Annexure attached

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender on-line for bidding		Last Date & Time of seeking tender clarification	Date & Time of opening of tender	
		From	To		Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Sunabeda	CCERWCSBD - Online -34/2026-27	10.09.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	07.10.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.	06.10.2026 up to 2.00 P.M.	08.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	To be intimated separately

5. The details of works can be seen from the web site https://www.tendersodisha.gov.in
6. Any Corrigendum/Addendum will be displayed in the above e-tender web site.

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Rural Works Circle, Sunabeda.

OIPR-25001/25182/1/26-27/0070

Govt. of Bihar

GOVERNMENT ENGINEERING COLLEGE JEHANABAD
Walipur, Hulasganj, Jehanabad-804407
Short Term Recruitment
Email ID:- principal@gecjehanabad.ac.in Website:- www.gecjehanabad.ac.in

Walk-in Interview for Guest Technical Assistant

Applications are invited for the post of Guest Technical Assistant in the Government Engineering College Jehanabad. Interested and eligible candidates may appear for the Walk in-interview with all their original Academics certificates, category certificate, residential certificate, hard copy of CV, 02 sets of photocopies of original documents and 02 recent passport size photographs as per the following details.

Sl. No.	Name of Post	Subject	Eligibility	Date, Time and Venue of Interview
1	Guest Technical Assistant	Electronics and Communication Engineering	The qualification for recruitment is as per DSTTE, Patna Norms.	Date-18/09/2026 Time-11:00 AM Venue-Administrative Block, GEC Jehanabad

Important Instruction:
1. This engagement will be purely on temporary basis and the service can be terminated without any prior notice. No claim will be entertained in this regard.
2. Remuneration for Guest Technical Assistant will be as per the existing rules and directives of DSTTE, Govt. of Bihar.
3. The institute reserves the right to withdraw the partial or full advertisement with respect to walk-in-interview without any reason.
4. The services will be terminated without any notice if their services found unsatisfactory. No claim will be entertained in this regard.
5. No TA/DA will be paid for attending the interview.

Principal
Govt. Engg. College Jehanabad

This information is available on website **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** also
PR. No.011098 (Sci.&Tech.) 2026-27

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, धनबाद

शुद्धि पत्र

सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि इस कार्यालय के ई– निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या 08/RWD/DHANBAD/26-27 दिनांक 08.08.2026 जिसका पी0आर0 387769 Rural Works Department (26-27) dated 18.08.26 में निम्नांकित पथों का निविदा को अपरिहार्य कारणवश रद्द किया जाता है:–

निविदा का कमांक	आईडेन्टी फिकेशन संख्या/पैकेज संख्या	प्रखण्ड	कार्य का नाम	राशि (लाख में)
13	DMFT 34/26-27	बाघमारा	बागदाहा पंचायत अन्तर्गत सिन्दूर बाबा से पिपरा टोला हरिमंदिर होते हुए सहारा मैदान होते हुए पंचल पत्थर तक पी0सी0सी0 पथ निर्माण एवं गार्डवाल का निर्माण	296.439
14	DMFT 35/26-27	तोपचांची	कोरकोट्टा पंचायत अन्तर्गत जय भारत उच्च विद्यालय से देबू भट्टाचार्य के घर तक पथ का जीर्णोद्धार	156.078

शेष सभी योजनाए यथावत रहेगी।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, धनबाद

PR 389232 (Rural Work Department)26-27*D

BHARATIYA RESERVE BANK NOTE MUDRAN PVT. LTD. (BRBNMPL)
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Phone No. 03227-280176 / 280317; Fax No. 03227-280744 / 280222

OPEN TENDER ENQUIRY (OTE)/NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING (NCB)

Bids are invited under Two-Part bidding system for the following e-Tender through MSTC Portal: -

1. **DESIGN, ENGINEERING, MANUFACTURE, ASSEMBLY, TESTING, INSPECTION, SUPPLY AND TRANSPORTATION OF 8 NOS. OF NEW LHB TYPE RAILWAY TREASURY VANS WITH ACCESSORIES AND BUYBACK OF EXISTING 08 Nos OF ICF TYPE TRESURY VANS FOR BRBNMPL, MYSURU AND SALBONI; MSTC Event No. BRBNMPL/Salboni Press/MMD/24/26-27/ET/50 [RAILWAY TREASURY VAN]; BRBNMPL TENDER NO. 009/SAL/PUR/2026-27; [EST. COST – ₹4800 LAKH]**
2. **REPAIR, RECTIFICATION, WATERPROOFING AND REPAINTING OF UTILITY BUILDINGS INSIDE PLANT AREA, BRBNMPL, SALBONI; MSTC EVENT NO. BRBNMPL/SALBONI PRESS/MMD/26/26-27/ET/52 [WATER PROOFING WORKS]; BRBNMPL TENDER NO. 012/SAL/MMD-CIVIL/2026-27; [EST. COST – ₹550 LAKH]**

Last date of tender submission for **Sl. No. 1 is 13.11.2026 by 11:00 Hrs and for Sl No. 2** is 09.10.2026 by 11:00 Hrs. For downloading tender document and other details, kindly visit websites **www.mstcecommerce.com** and **www.brbnmpl.co.in**. Any changes shall be uploaded on the above websites only.

Senior General Manager

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमंडल, बोकारो
कम्बाइंड बिल्डींग, सिविल एस०डी०ओ०, ऑफिस
ओल्ड चास कोर्ट एरिया, बोकारो

शुद्धि पत्र

इस कार्यालय द्वारा आमंत्रित ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या:- 01/2026-27/RWD/EE/BOKARO दिनांक – 22.08.2026 जो समाचार पत्रों में पी0आर0नं0–388258 Rural Work Department (26-27) D के द्वारा प्रकाशित निविदा के कमांक सं0 (2) वेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि:– 01.09.2026 के स्थान पर तिथि :– 12.09.2026, कमांक सं0 (3) ई–निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि :– 21.09.2026 के स्थान पर तिथि :– 03.10.2026, कमांक सं0 (4) निविदा खोलने की तिथि :– 24.09.2026 के स्थान पर तिथि :– 05.10.2026 पढ़ा जाय एवं अन्य शेष शर्त्ते यथावत रहेंगें।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग
कार्य प्रमंडल, बोकारो

PR 389286 Rural Work Department (26-27)_D

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय,
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, राँची

अल्पकालीन ई–प्रोक्योरमेंट सूचना
टेन्डर रेफरेंन्स नं0–प0नि0वि0/राँची–24/2026–27
दिनांक :– 05.09.2026

1.	कार्य का नाम	**Surface Renewal of Road from Karamtoli Chowk (Ch. 0.00 KM) to Maharaja Madra Munda Chowk (Ring Road) (Ch. 8.20 KM) (Total Length -8.20 KM) for the year 2026-27.**
2.	अनुमानित प्राक्कलित राशि (रू0 लाख में)	रू0 475.83425 लाख (रूपये चार करोड़ पचहत्तर लाख तिरासी हजार चार सौ पचीस) मात्र।
3.	अग्रधन की राशि (रू0 लाख में)	रू0 4.76 लाख (रूपये चार लाख छिहत्तर हजार) मात्र।
4.	समय	03 (तीन) माह
5.	वेबसाईट पर निविदा प्रकाषन की तिथि	09.09.2026 10.30 बजे पूर्वाह्न
6.	निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि/ समय	24.09.2026 12.00 बजे दोपहर तक
7.	निविदा खोलने की तिथि/ समय	24.09.2026 12.30 बजे अपराह्न।
8.	निविदा प्रकाषित करने वाले कार्यालय का नाम एवं पता	कार्यपालक अभियंता पथ निर्माण विभाग,पथ प्रमंडल, मोहराबादी, राँची–834008.
9.	प्रोक्योरमेंट पदाधिकारी का सम्पर्क संख्या	0651–2361018
10.	ई–प्रोक्योरमेंट सेल का हेल्पलाईन संख्या	0651–2403007

- प्राक्कलित राशि एवं अग्रधन की राशि घट–बढ़ सकती है, जिसे ***Tender Online Upload*** में देखा जा सकता है, एवं किसी भी प्रकार का बदलाव ***http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in*** पर देखा जा सकता है।
- नियम एवं शर्तों के लिए वेबसाईट ***http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in*** पर देखें।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, राँची

PR 389157 (Road Construction Dept Road Division Ranchi)26-27*D

BBL opened to private investors, CA expects an AUD $1bn windfall

Pat Cummins supported the privatisation drive. EXPRESS PHOTO

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 8

CRICKET AUSTRALIA (CA) threw open the doors of Big Bash League franchises to private investors in a move that is expected to lead to a windfall of $1 billion, according to media reports in Australia. This opens a new avenue for owners of Indian Premier League franchises to invest in the Big Bash and Women's Big Bash.

Significantly, when CA made the announcement in a press conference the presence of top cricketers alongside CA hierarchy was the most notable part. Sitting besides CA CEO Todd Greenberg and chair Mike Baird at the press conference were Australian captains Pat Cummins, Sophie Molineux and stars such as Travis Head and Ellyse Perry. Their presence was symbolic, because the Australian Cricketers' Association is yet to formally approve the initiative.

"Privatisation, if done well, can be a great thing for the sport," Cummins was quoted as saying by Australia's *7News*. "So many benefits for obviously the Big Bash League, but as an Aussie captain as well, Test cricket's so important for me, and I think this sets us up really well for the future."

"This can unlock some new areas that we can go into in the Women's Big Bash. New investors, new opportunities to be able to innovate and grow the game. The Women's Big Bash, quality-wise, is still the best competition in the world. But bringing in all these new opportunities that come with privatisation can hopefully make the product even better, which is a really cool thing to be part of," said Molineux, who captains the Renegades in the WBBL.

Talking about the impending Renegades sale, Molineux hoped that it would translate into "getting some new fans on board".

"It's going to feel different," she said. "Different isn't always ... I suppose it can be a really good thing."

The major opposition to the move towards privatisation has come from NSW and Queensland even though Tasmania, Victoria and Western Australia have long backed the opportunity to have private investors. For now, CA has said that Melbourne Renegades will become the first club to go through a sales process and will invite bids from private investors.

DULEEP TROPHY FINAL DAY 3

Shami's masterclass on a flat pitch shows Siraj still has a lot to learn

Choking South Zone's riposte with a spell of 2/17, veteran pacer shows he is still a quality performer

Ventaka Krishna B
Chennai, September 8

On a placid Chepauk deck, Mohammed Shami posed questions aplenty with the ball. PTI

ON AN attritional Day 3, where South Zone ground their way to 242 for 6 at 3.02 runs an over in response to East Zone's imposing total of 708 in the Duleep Trophy final, Mohammed Shami handed a few lessons to his younger peers, Mohammed Siraj in particular. If Siraj was watching how Shami operated on the Chepauk deck, where East Zone were a bowler short, Anukul Roy unavailable after an impact injury to his finger while batting, he'd have taken home something valuable about control and execution.

On a red-soil pitch prepared to last five days, the bowlers haven't had the easiest conditions to work with yet. The wear has been gradual, though the ball did keep low at times when the spinners landed it on the rough.

With two days still to go, the bowlers will feel there's plenty here to exploit. Having conceded a huge total, South faced a mountain to climb from the start of their innings on Day 3 morning; getting anywhere near East's total was always a stretch. Shami made it harder still, with the new ball and the old, alongside Mukesh Kumar, the pair choking South with a slow, patient squeeze.

With temperatures in the mid-30s and the humidity making it worse, the two seamers bowled in short spells, none longer than four overs, some just two or three, ensuring maximum effort whenever they did bowl.

"Five or six-over spells wouldn't really work here, because bowling five or six-over spells naturally brings cramps. So our plan as a bowling group was to bowl in short bursts, and if a spell was meant to be five or six overs, we converted it into three overs, meaning we put in maximum effort into every ball," Mukesh said.

Unlike Siraj, who wasted the best of the seam-friendly conditions on Day 1 morning by bowling short and wayward, Shami was on the mark throughout.

As Bharat Arun told this newspaper, hand Shami the red ball and conditions or situation barely register; his competitiveness, and the sight of batsmen struggling against his seam movement, bring him real joy.

Shami's message

What Shami passed on to Mukesh wasn't any secret. Just a simple message: land the ball on the seam, hard into the pitch.

"The other part is working on the ball, applying sweat repeatedly, polishing it, preparing it for reverse swing. On red soil like this, balls tend to scuff up and lose condition quickly. It comes down to how well you shine it and look after it; that's crucial for reverse swing. We worked on that, and it gave us movement."

It's exactly what Siraj and the rest of South's pace attack couldn't manage, leaking runs instead. With the new ball, Shami offered control, and so did Mukesh, both attacking the stumps or making the batsmen play.

The first two wickets, though, were gifts from South's openers. Ricky Bhui edged Mukesh down the leg side, before N Jagadeesan fell to a loose shot. Part-time spinner Shikhar Mohan landed one wide, and the opener, going for a square drive, sliced it straight to the fielder at backward point.

Devdutt Padikkal and Shaik Rasheed steadied things briefly, but it didn't last, and it was Shami who ended South's resistance. After a three-over opening spell, he returned for his second and found reverse swing straight away, the reward, as Mukesh said, for looking after the ball.

With the ball shaping sharply as it neared the batsman, Rasheed managed a couple of lovely flicks and drives regardless. But when Shami hit back-of-a-length and got one to nip in sharply, it thudded into his pads, and the 21-year-old was gone lbw.

> ***If Siraj was watching how Shami operated on the Chepauk deck, where East Zone were a bowler short, he'd have taken home something valuable about control and execution.***

Shami had barely finished celebrating before Mukesh replaced him and had Padikkal too, an aerial flick straight to the fielder at deep square leg, out for 66.

Four down, East turned to their spinners, and Tilak Varma and Ravichandran Smaran ground through the middle overs together. Shami returned for a third spell and ended Smaran's innings testing him in the channel outside off. On a flat deck, his figures for the day read 11-4-17-2. Off-colour since the Sri Lanka Tests, Siraj got a live demonstration of exactly what's required on pitches like this.

Once Smaran departed, captain Varma held one end together, Shreyas Gopal offering solid support at the other. Against the old ball, with the spinners in, they tried to wear East down, before Kounain Quraishi removed Shreyas off the final over of the day.

BRIEF SCORES: East Zone 708 (Ishan Kishan 270; Tripurana Vijay 4/180) vs South Zone 242 for 6 (Devdutt Padikkal 62, Tilak Varma 56 not out; Mohammed Shami 2/17, Mukesh Kumar 2/36), trail by 466 runs.

Pakistan's squad overhaul was news to me: Babar

Associated Press
Birmingham, September 8

BABAR AZAM admitted he was blindsided by the decision to tear up his squad ahead of this week's final cricket test against England, saying the drastic cull was "news to me." Babar learned of the wholesale changes only after an official statement by the Pakistan Cricket Board, he said on Tuesday, the day before the third test at Edgbaston.

"It was news to me," Babar said in Urdu. "I found out after. The PCB decided it, so they will be able to explain better. The PCB's decision must have been taken after some thought process. It's better if you ask them why." Heavy defeats at Leeds and Lord's were met with sweeping changes by the PCB, who sent seven players home and removed head coach Sarfaraz Ahmed and his assistant Umar Gul. The replacements summoned included five with no test experience, while white-ball coach Mike Hesson and Ashley Noffke were drafted to take charge at Edgbaston.

Babar framed the remarkable overhaul as a fresh chance for the players "to showcase their talent." None of the Pakistan squad, including Babar, has played a test at Edgbaston. "The series is lost but we have nothing to lose," he added. "We should play freely and believe in ourselves as a team." He missed the innings loss at Headingley because of a finger injury and made only 8 and 6 at Lord's, where Pakistan lost by 194 runs. He said the senior players have to lead the way. "I firmly believe you need to grab opportunities and perform in difficult conditions," Babar said.

Babar Azam during practice ahead of the third Test. AP

"That's why we play cricket, because we have to perform and dominate in difficult conditions. We need to forget about past failures and shift focus to the future." England captain Joe Root considered it "disrespectful" to say Pakistan has showed a lack of fight on tour.

"We've found Pakistan a challenge," Root said. "I think that's a bit disrespectful to both Pakistan as a team and to us as a team. I don't think we've allowed them to get into games because of how well we've played and how quickly we've read the situations and the surfaces that we've had. I think it's very easy to say one team is excellent and one team is poor. Normally it's somewhere in the middle. If one team has been outstanding then the other team can't have been poor and vice versa."

Root's return to the captaincy has gone well but he has had a lean run with the bat this summer, although pitches have been overwhelmingly in favour of seam bowlers. Root has been lbw nine times in his past seven tests and struggled with the wicketkeeper standing up, but he says he enjoys the challenge of trying to get back into form.

ENGLAND VS PAKISTAN: 3rd Test, live from 3:30 pm on Sony Sports Network.

• BRIEFLY

Scott McTominay was treated for heart arrhythmia. REUTERS

Napoli's McTominay to miss Arsenal clash after successful heart procedure

NAPOLI MIDFIELDER Scott McTominay has had a successful procedure to correct a heart arrhythmia and is expected to return to training in about two weeks, the Italian club said on Tuesday. The 29-year-old Scotland international underwent a planned ablation procedure at Spire Manchester Hospital following a diagnosis of a mild, benign arrhythmia last week. "As was planned, Scott McTominay had an ablation procedure carried out at the Spire Manchester Hospital during the morning," Napoli said in a statement. "The surgery was perfectly successful. McTominay will observe a rest period of around two weeks before resuming training." The former Manchester United midfielder sat out Napoli's 3-2 Serie A defeat by champions Inter Milan on Saturday. He is set to miss Wednesday's Champions League opener against Arsenal, as well as two league fixtures. REUTERS

Mumbai City rope in Lazar Cirkovic on one-year deal

MUMBAI CITY FC on Tuesday roped in Serbia's Lazar Cirkovic on a one-year deal for the 2026-27 Indian Super League season. The 34-year-old defender has previously played for Chennaiyin FC and Jamshedpur FC in the Indian Super League, apart from spending time at various clubs in Serbia. Cirkovic began his journey at Serbian SuperLiga club Rad in 2010 and later on moved to Palic on a loan. In 2014, Cirkovic joined FK Partizan and went on to make his debut at the UEFA Europa League fixture against Tottenham Hotspur. During his four-year stint at FK Partizan, Cirkovic was a member of the sides which won two Serbian SuperLiga titles and one Serbian Cup. PTI

Smriti ranked 5th among women's T20I batters

INDIA OPENER Smriti Mandhana on Tuesday strengthened her position inside the top five of the ICC T20 rankings after producing a remarkable 124 against Hong Kong in the ongoing Women's Asia Cup. Mandhana's 64-ball innings not only helped India secure a 137-run victory and a place in the semi-finals but also saw her become the all-time leading run-scorer (10,880 runs) in women's international cricket across all formats, surpassing Mithali Raj (10,868). The innings was also her 18th international century, moving her clear at the top of the women's international centuries list. Mandhana is ranked fifth in the standings. PTI

India bag 2 golds at World Archery Para Series

INDIA BAGGED 2 gold, 2 silver and 1 bronze on the penultimate day of the World Archery Para Series (Stage III) in Ahmedabad, with the men's compound and recurve teams winning the top honours and Swati Chaudhary grabbing 2 medals. Reigning world champion Toman Kumar and Shyam Sundar Swami won the men's compound team gold with a 152-139 victory over Iraq, while Harvinder Singh and Vijay Sundi rallied past Slovakia 6-2 for the men's recurve team title. The women's recurve team of Bhawna and Pooja added a silver, while Swati and Nazir Ansari finished runners-up in the Mixed Team W1 (Rec/Comp) event. PTI

Kane, Dembele Ballon d'Or contenders

LAST YEAR'S winner Ousmane Dembele, Harry Kane and Kylian Mbappe are among the top contenders for the men's Ballon d'Or. The 30 men's and 30 women's nominees were revealed by France Football magazine on Tuesday, with the winners to be announced at a ceremony in London on Oct. 26. In the women's field, two-time winner Alexia Putellas, Ewa Pajor and Melchie Dumornay are among the favorites to take over Aitana Bonmati. The winner of the past three women's awards, Bonmati did not make the cut after missing most of the season through injury. Kane had one his best seasons, scoring 73 goals. AP

• ONES FOR THE FUTURE

'New Messi': Football's next gen arrives with tags they didn't choose

Sandip G
New Delhi, September 8

LIONEL MESSI was curious about the boy they called the New Messi. The then 16-year-old Rodrigo Mora, then of Porto and now Roma's treasured jewel. The resemblances were striking. Like Messi in his wunderkind years, soft curls of the puffy mullet bounced onto forehead, he was of similar physical dimensions, of stocky build and a subterranean centre of gravity. The Portuguese did Messi things too, cutting into the box with explosive speed from a leisurely stroll, and twinkling and jinking past his markers with teenage intrepidness.

Messi, during Inter Miami's fixture with Porto last year, was so pleased with what he saw that he took him by his side, swapped shirts, and later put him among the top ten young stars. Rodrigo couldn't contain his hysteria and blurted out a verbal faux pas that incensed his country. "As a Portuguese, I could not hold back the jealousy in my heart. If only we had a figure like Messi," he said. Cristiano Ronaldo's faithful spewed scathing vitriol at him regardless.

Two years later, Roma acquired him. It took him little time to marvel the Italians with his wriggly-wiggly art, tactical intelligence, capacity to modulate the game's tempo and direct attacks. Roma's legend Francesco Totti was impressed by his fluidity in tight spaces, lauding his calm under pressure. The veteran coach Gian Piero Gasperini rates him an "extraordinary talent with the potential to become a legend."

Superlatives have been overflowing, although every hyped talent comes with several caveats and cautionary tales of unfulfilled renown, but he headlines a squadron of fledglings ready to seize and storm the grandest European stage that is the Champions League.

Rodrigo has almost certainly heard the "New Messi" tag applied to others before him. Como's Martin Baturina, meanwhile, carries a gentler version of the same burden, set against his countryman and metronome Luka Modrić.

The 23-year-old was born in Switzerland but was adamant on wearing Croatia's stripes. His idol, it goes without saying, is Modrić. He has a similar vision, a fetish for long-range passes from the outside of the foot and a variety of deft skills. But he patrols a more advanced position and is eager to have a pop on goal. He netted a pearler against England at the World Cup, where he slashed in from the flank and leathered a first-time rising shot into the top left. He has been in sinister goal-scoring touch this season, scoring against Genoa and Napoli away.

As has been Borussia Dortmund's 18-year-old Konstantinos Karetsas. He is often a blur on the right wing, emerging like a shadow from nowhere and devouring the defenders. He is a throwback dribbler, exceptional in one-on-one situations and imparts outrageous bend and velocity into the ball.

He was raised in Belgium's Genk, where his parents had come to work in coal mines, and he retains the simplicity of his upbringing.

"I have seen how hard my parents have worked. It was their dream to make me a footballer and I should keep working hard to become the best I could be," he told his club's website. A raft of clubs were sniffing for his signature, but he had his heart beating for Dortmund, the best club in a youngster's developmental phase.

Another Xavi at Barca

Footballers of attacking profiles often steal the limelight, but defensive midfielders and defenders have apportioned some of it in recent years. Barcelona's 18-year-old full-back Xavi Espart is already watched covetously. A midfielder in his early education, he is highly technical and intelligent, endowed with pace and the gift of organising at attack. Manager Hansi Flick likens him to his old teammate Philipp Lahm.

"When I see him play, I like how confident he is with the ball," Flick said of Espart in a press conference last week. "He is similar to Philipp Lahm; he can play as a six or as a two. He performs well on and off the ball." He is a classic La Masia product, extremely strong with his positional play, and capable of stepping into midfield during build-up.

While he cannot be snatched or lured from Barcelona, scouts have been hovering over Lens' tenacious centre-back Ismaelo Ganiou (21). The French defender of Burkina Faso descent is a blend of the traditional and modern, adept at distribution and wearing down attackers with sharp movements and positional sense. Of similar nature is Zeno Debast, a year older than Ganiou, of Sporting CP.

A host of clubs, including Manchester United and Arsenal, monitored him in recent years, before being turned away by the tough-negotiating Portuguese club.

Some could wither; some could leap into greatness. But every new edition unfolds with the feverish hope of a new talent bursting forth. It could be the season of New Messi, or New Modrić, or someone dressed in anonymity.

• FOOTBALL'S GEN Z

Prodigies to watch out for in the 2026-27 Champions League

RODRIGO MORA
Age: 19
Team: AS Roma
Position: Attacking midfielder
Last season's stats: 5 goals, 2 assists

KONSTANTINOS KARETSAS
Age: 18
Team: Borussia Dortmund
Position: Attacking midfielder
Last season's stats: 3 goals, 18 assists

ISMAELO GANIOU
Age: 21
Team: RC Lens
Position: Centre-back
Last season's stats: 10 clean sheets

MARTIN BATURINA
Age: 23
Team: Como
Position: Attacking midfielder
Last season's stats: 8 goals, 4 assists

XAVI ESPART
Age: 19
Team: FC Barcelona
Position: Right-back
Last season's stats: 3 goals, 5 assists

ZENO DEBAST
Age: 22
Team: Sporting Clube de Portugal
Position: Centre-back
Last season's stats: 8 clean sheets

Blunders, bad luck extend misery for Anand's team

Viswanathan Anand. GCL

Mayank Chaudhary
Bengaluru, September 8

IT WAS a day PBG Alaskan Knights would rather forget.

An illegal move, a denied draw, two heartbreaking losses resulted in Viswanathan Anand's team stretching its losing streak to three matches at the 2026 Global Chess League on Tuesday. Everything that could have gone wrong for the Knights did, and it all started with them dropping a winning match against Ganges Grandmasters due to an illegal move.

Despite Anand's one-move blunder against Ian Nepomniachtchi and losses for Yağız Kaan Erdoğmuş and Kateryna Lagno, the Knights had stayed in the contest after Arjun Erigaisi and Nino Batsiashvili struck with black pieces. The scoreline hung in the balance with just one point separating the teams.

On the Prodigy board, Abhimanyu Mishra had just converted a drawn position into a near-winning endgame. Despite trailing 8-9 in the match, Mishra's win would have given the Knights a 12-9 victory.

But it wasn't meant to be. With the clock running low, Mishra promoted his pawn to queen but placed it on e1 instead of f1 in a rush, also dropping the rook on the board. Two pieces ended up on the same square at the same time, making it an illegal move.

As a result, two seconds were taken off Mishra's clock, which already had just three seconds left. With effectively one second remaining, the youngest Grandmaster in chess history needed to promote his pawn, replace it with a queen, and hit the clock all with one hand - an impossible task. Hence, the Knights lost. "I had two or three seconds after I played rook takes f1, g takes f1, promoting to a queen. When I promoted, I took the queen and put it on the square, but somehow the rook was still in that area. The move wasn't entirely completed. I had to retry with one second left, and I flagged," said a disappointed Mishra.

The Knights were to suffer another disappointment. This time, it came from the top board in Anand's clash with Fyers American Gambits' Javokhir Sindarov. Just like the first match, the Knights had the game in their pocket, with Anand only needing to hold Sindarov to a draw.

But with Arjun and Mishra going down in their games, the onus fell on Anand to salvage the match. In a drawn endgame, Anand blundered after refusing an offer to draw from Sindarov, and the game turned on its head. Gambits won the clash, breaking their three-match losing streak.

(The writer is in Bengaluru at the invitation of Global Chess League)

Back to blue: Hockey teams revert to original jerseys for Asian Games

An HI official pushed for saffron jersey before president Tirkey intervened

Pritish Raj
New Delhi, September 8

THE INDIAN hockey teams will revert to the iconic blue jersey at the 2026 Asian Games after playing the men's and women's World Cups in saffron and white jerseys. The return to tradition comes after the federation copped flak from many hockey enthusiasts and former players. Indian hockey teams have largely been in blue since the country made its Olympic debut in 1928, barring a few isolated instances.

The Indian Express learnt that despite the controversy and criticism, a senior Hockey India (HI) official wanted to push for the saffron jersey before president Dilip Tirkey intervened. In an email exchange starting August 6, the HI official shared saffron as the primary colour and white as the second one for the men's and women's teams, before Tirkey asked to keep blue as the primary colour and saffron as the second.

"We never said it (the saffron jersey) was permanent. The Indian hockey team will sport the blue jersey. Nothing is permanent as we had seven colours to choose from," Tirkey said.

India will sport the blue jersey at the 2026 Asian Games. HI

The jersey colour for the recent World Cups in Belgium and the Netherlands had become a talking point before the tournaments. "I must say that Hockey India has done many good things for India. But this is embarrassing. The legacy and identity of the Indian team has always been BLUE. I wore the Blue jersey with pride for many years. Fans want to see our Indian team in blue. What is the logic of orange?" former India captain Viren Rasquinha had posted on X.

Tirkey said there were seven options as far as the colour of the jersey was concerned.

"Right now, there is nothing permanent when it comes to jersey colour. We have used saffron in the past and we can use it again but at the Asian Games, we will be using the blue jersey again," he said.

The change to saffron for the World Cup prompted internal wrangling in Hockey India with letters flying back and forth among top functionaries of the federation. The logic put forth in favour of a saffron jersey was that it would help players identify teammates on the blue turf. It was argued that the blue jersey on the turf of the same colour may hinder coordination.

Hockey India said that players were consulted before the change. However, five different players had told this paper that they had no prior inkling in this matter. The players *The Indian Express* spoke to, across the men's and women's teams, denied being part of the process.

"I wasn't asked or consulted. It is not true," said one of them, who requested anonymity. All five said they did not speak for the entire group, but it suggests that the proposed change was not common knowledge.

The drama deepened further when Tirkey himself claimed that he wasn't consulted. The HI president alleged that he was kept in the dark till the 11th hour.

"At the outset, I wish to make it clear that the issue under consideration is not merely the colour or design of a playing jersey," Tirkey wrote. "The matter concerns the decision-making process adopted for a change involving one of the most recognisable symbols of Indian hockey, the authority under which such a decision was taken, the consultations undertaken, compliance with Hockey India's governance framework, and whether appropriate institutional processes were followed."

The Indian women's team finished fifth – their highest finish at the World Cup in more than half a century – while the men's team came back with an eighth-place finish.

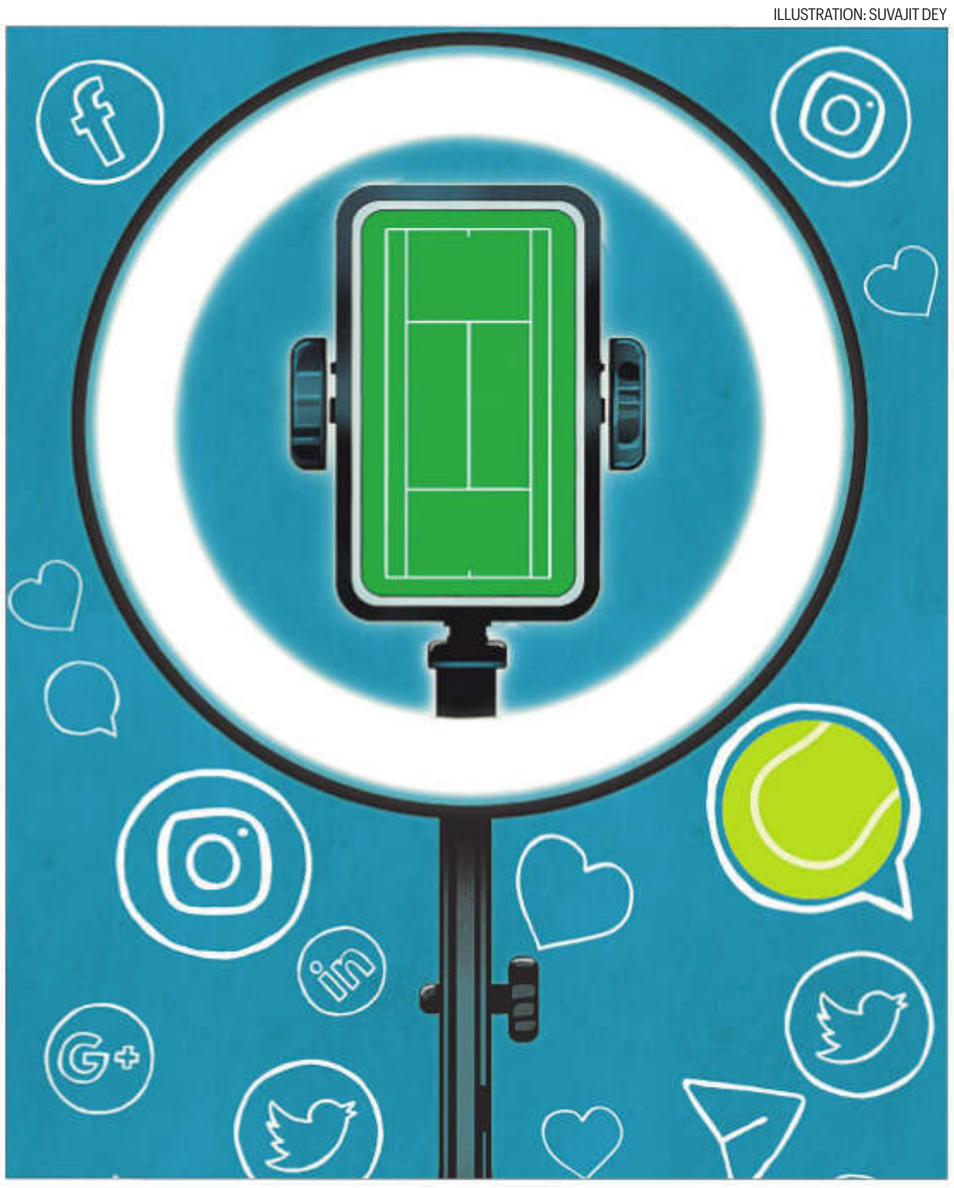
TOP PLAYERS SPLIT ON INFLUENCERS

US Open: Tennis chases new fans at expense of etiquette

Flashing lights, mid-point selfies, movement during play are some conditions not to the liking of a few

Bhuvan Gupta
New Delhi, September 8

ILLUSTRATION: SUVAJIT DEY



USTA has stood by its decision to increase the number of invited influencers from 54 to 100-odd this year.

NO RING lights, no mid-point selfies, no nuisance. Wimbledon won't let anyone play fast and loose with tennis etiquette.

The All England Club has decided against accrediting content creators and influencers for the 2027 edition, Press Association has reported. It will also seize any items (like ring lights) that can hamper play. This comes after social media savants' alleged disruption at the US Open sparked controversy and conversation.

Flushing Meadows is turning into "a bit of a zoo" per Adrian Mannarino. He flagged the free movement of people during points, among other things.

"The tournament puts up with it, and I don't know if it's the best thing for tennis in general. There's a smell of marijuana on the court, noise everywhere," the French veteran told reporters.

The issue became prominent during Naomi Osaka's first-round match. She was serving to Anastasia Zakharova when a group brandished a ring light to click photos in their hospitality suite. Chair umpire Kader Nouni had to pause the match and admonish the crowd before resuming play. It was not the only interruption that evening.

Another group spoke loudly while recording themselves during the match. Nouni intervened again. "Today, the umpire told everyone to be quiet more than I've ever heard an umpire tell a crowd to be quiet," Osaka said. "...I think it bothered my opponent too."

The former World No.1 demanded respect from audiences. "If you come to a sporting event, you have to respect the sport. It's common courtesy to read up on the sport, especially the etiquette," Osaka said. She had no issue with popularising tennis through influencer marketing, but felt the management could be a lot better, "especially in the situation like (my) first-round match".

Coco Gauff had a similar perspective. "It's cool to have a new demographic and I definitely think it helps grow the sport. But if you're being invited to a red carpet, you wouldn't show up in jeans. I think it's just 'follow (sic) the etiquette of the sport'."

Fellow American Jessica Pegula said it was tough to see videos of people taking pictures and using the selfie lights mid-match. "People are down there trying to perform. It's their career and their job. It seems a bit disrespectful."

Not everyone is a critic of the disruptions. Frances Tiafoe had no problem with "anybody doing anything", while watching the tennis. "All different walks of life, different types of people, different types of occupations. Personally, I love that."

Daniil Medvedev, too, threw his weight behind the trend. "The more the sport grows, the better it is. I trust the USTA (United States Tennis Association) with what they are doing. I think (there is) a lot more upside than downside, so go for it."

USTA, meanwhile, has stood by its decision to increase the number of invited influencers from 54 in 2025 to 100-odd this year. It has also downplayed the disruptions as "infrequent".

USTA spokesperson Brendan McIntyre told the New York Post: "These instances happen infrequently, and similar to when crowd noise reaches a certain level, our chair umpires have the ability to address the crowd when they occur."

Before the tournament started, USTA chief executive Craig Tiley had expressed his desire to make the season's last Grand Slam "the tennis Disneyland". He spoke about a need to find ways of reaching new audiences, and of reaching people "in a way that they connect with media" today.

"The creation of the creator credential has been a key part of that because it's enabled us to talk to people in a way that they're listening. That's been a big focus," he reiterated.

> **"It's cool to have a new demographic and I definitely think it helps grow the sport. But if you're being invited to a red carpet, you wouldn't show up in jeans. I think it's just 'follow (sic) the etiquette of the sport'."**
>
> COCO GAUFF, AMERICAN TENNIS PLAYER

While Wimbledon has held out for now, it might be a matter of time before the tradition-first grasscourt Major relents. The practice of inviting influencers cuts across sports and event scale, be it the recent badminton World Championships in Delhi or cricket and football World Cups. Most contemporary players, including Gauff and Osaka, are leveraging social media heavily to augment their personal brands.

It is the default for every celebrity and sports personality in the digital age. It's only understandable that sports tournaments don't want to be left behind. In fact, when Gauff was asked what she wanted the WTA to improve last year, she mentioned user-generated content — clips, highlight packages, memes and other media that players and fans make — in addition to the official content put out by the tours and broadcasters.

The organisers may consider a refresher course, covering the sport's basic dos and don'ts, before they land up at arenas. They should understand when it is okay to click photos, talk and move around, and when it absolutely is not.

Because that's just not tennis.

Gauff, Rybakina sail into US Open last 8, Zheng escapes again

Reuters
New York, September 8

HOME FAVOURITE Coco Gauff and world number two Elena Rybakina sailed into the U.S. Open quarter-finals on Monday, while China's Zheng Qinwen mounted another extraordinary fightback to upset six-times Grand Slam champion Iga Swiatek. Top seed Alexander Zverev beat Italian Luciano Darderi 6-2 6-2 7-6(3) at Arthur Ashe Stadium, the German surprised to finish before midnight after coming through a couple of five-setters earlier in the tournament.

"I think after 10 hours on court, I just maybe found my rhythm a little bit better, which is helpful because the first two matches were really not great level," Zverev said. "I think I'm going in the right direction, moving forward in the right direction."

Zverev, who is bidding for a second Grand Slam title after winning the French Open in June, avenged his defeat by Darderi at the Italian Open in Rome earlier this year.

Fourth seed Gauff outclassed compatriot Iva Jovic 6-1 6-4 to set up a clash with fellow French Open champion Mirra Andreeva for a place in the semis.

"Mirra is someone that I always have tough matches with," Gauff told reporters. "She's obviously in a different mindset now at the top of the game coming off of a Grand Slam win ... it's going to be a really athletic, tough match."

Gauff is the sixth American player into the quarters, joining Jessica Pegula, Emma Navarro, Frances Tiafoe, Alex Michelsen and Ben Shelton. Rybakina continued her quest for a third major title with a 6-1 6-4 win over former U.S. Open champion Naomi Osaka, who was hampered by an Achilles tendon injury that had flared up in the previous round. The victory leaves second seed Rybakina one win away from becoming world number one for the first time, with Olympic champion Zheng awaiting her in the quarters.

The win was another encouraging sign for Rybakina, who had arrived in New York with questions over her fitness after retiring from the Cincinnati Open in the build-up to the tournament.

Zheng has become something of an escape artist at Flushing Meadows. After coming back from a 0-5 deficit in the deciding set against third-round foe Madison Keys, she let the first five games slip through her fingers in 20 minutes against 2022 champion Swiatek.

Elena Rybakina reached the US Open quarterfinals. AP

However, she clawed her way back into the match and collapsed to the court with her face in her hands after sealing the win on the fourth match point.

Zheng is the first qualifier since Emma Raducanu in 2021 to reach the quarter-finals of the women's draw, as she battles back from a chronic elbow injury.

The evening session in the men's draw was not short on drama. At Louis Armstrong Stadium, Karen Khachanov fought back to claim a 7-5 4-6 6-7(6) 6-1 6-4 win over 20-year-old American Learner Tien, while on the Grandstand court Botic van de Zandschulp emerged victorious after a five-hour marathon against Arthur Gea.

The 21-year-old Gea had been one point away from becoming the first lucky loser in Grand Slam history to reach the quarter-finals, before his Dutch opponent engineered a 3-6 6-7(0) 7-6(7) 7-6(3) 6-4 comeback.

RESULTS

Men's singles fourth round: Alexander Zverev bt Luciano Darderi 6-2, 6-2, 7-6 (3); Karen Khachanov bt Learner Tien 7-5, 4-6, 6-7 (6), 6-1, 6-4; Botic van de Zandschulp bt Arthur Gea 3-6, 6-7 (0), 7-6 (7), 7-6 (3), 6-4; Alexander Blockx bt Francisco Cerundolo 6-3, 4-6, 7-5, 7-5

Women's singles fourth round: Elena Rybakina bt Naomi Osaka 6-1, 6-4; Coco Gauff bt Iva Jovic 6-1, 6-4; Qinwen Zheng bt Iga Swiatek 7-5, 6-3; Mirra Andreeva bt Anastasia Potapova 5-7, 6-4, 6-3.

SEARCH FOR GOLD

In Malaysian badminton, 'split, why split' saga of doubles pair takes centrestage

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, September 8

ANDREW KAM who passed away this week, was a Malaysian businessman who had announced in 2012 that anyone who brought back an Olympic badminton gold (read: Lee Chong Wei or doubles legends, Tan Boon Heong-Koo Kien Keat at London '12), would be rewarded with a 12.5 kg gold bar. He loved the sport of course, like rich patrons do. But he also was in the business of mining gold — for real — in Raub, Pahang, ancient minefields of the yellow precious. Scooping up an Olympic gold though, has proven elusive for shuttlers of the badminton-mad country.

And though Chong Wei's misses at the hands of Lin Dan, are legendary, there were enough doubles pairings who could well have taken Malaysia to the pinnacle they so desperately covet.

The search for gold reached a crazy crescendo that thrummed in the background of Malaysia's men's doubles Aaron Chia and Soh Wooi Yik's World Championships campaign at Delhi. Malaysian coaches believe the 2022 World champions should be split to optimise chances of gold at Los Angeles 2028: find each of them a younger partner, fresher legs and put two pairings in contention instead of one. Double the probability. But gold conquests are seldom as simple as an amoeba splitting into two. The whole complexity of the split / don't split / why split? saga was at play, at Delhi — with speculation swirling akin to the breaking of a band or a celebrity power couple's decoupling.

They have a World's gold — in 2022, and finished with a silver at Delhi, that answered none of the questions about what was to be done with Aaron-Soh. There's coach Herry Iman Pierngadi with his teddy-bear kind eyes and silver-haired wisdom. A bronze at Paris (painful as it was for India), wasn't enough. It wasn't going to get the duo the promised 12.5 kg boulder of gold. Malaysia have subsequently witnessed Chen Tang Jie and Toh Ee Wei win mixed doubles World title. But as 2028 approaches, the men's doubles with two of their most dependable shuttlers splitting and shepherding two younger partners, is too irresistible a proposition.

Then there's Aaron and Soh, two soft spoken individuals, humble to a fault and nothing like the ninja-assassin's they become on court. You got the sense they were persuaded initially to split up, urging them to skill-up separately, find their own individual identity and leadership while mentoring juniors.

Malaysian coaches believe 2022 world champs Aaron Chia and Soh Wooi Yik should be split to optimise chances of gold at LA 2028. REUTERS

This was announced a few months back and they played three tournaments apart before combining for the World's where every mixed zone video of their's was frame by frame analysed by self-annointed body language experts.

India had their own dodgy shoulders and doubles chemistry and a surprise bronze, besides our monkeys and circus to worry about. So, Aaron-Soh cruised right up to the final and lost to the Chinese.

But the Malaysian storm kept rumbling in the background — it's roughly on the scale of Indian cricket's Virat-Rohit saga. But with fewer layers to the intrigue. Malaysian fans don't want the split, with the same fervour of the unfragmented world that didn't want Jennifer Aniston and Brad Pitt to split. Some of it was ridiculous — thought bubbles in memes shipping them like it's a K Drama, though most of it was a well-meaninged prayer not wanting a friendship to wane and wither, with their march into the finals seen as a validation of why they were best together.

Strong friendship

The two at the heart of this debate, said they could handle the on-court stuff because their friendship was strong. What happened beyond was left to coaches. So even if Soh Wooi Yik has been dropped for Asian Games, Lee Chong Wei brought all parties together and got them to commit to the partnership till LA, not wanting any U-turns later.

While Aaron Chia is a talent-beast, Soh is an able partner with underrated ability to rotate and hold fort, who comes from a Badminton family with his father and uncle having played at top level. There is never a dearth of reasons in a country like Malaysia with dozens of talents in men's doubles, that could get coaches wondering if a mix 'n match might work.

But the disruptive effect on the pairing has been a saga given the changes and experiments will continue. Coach Herri is not a cruel, cold man. Nor a puppeteer. Maybe, Aaron and Soh really needed some time apart to figure out their individual games. The 15-point system can alter what works and what doesn't. The winner of the last two gold medals — Taiwanese Lee Yang and Wang Chi Lin spent plenty of time away from the circuit nursing injuries and barely gunning for the Tour titles. After their World title, maybe Aaron and Soh needed this little disruption to realise how precious the partnership was.

Or maybe, Aaron Chia and Soh Wooi Yik are the compulsive rollercoaster Malaysians like getting on at all times, as they fixate on a player/pair and keep themselves riveted till the Olympics fetch up. Scooping gold is easy for mining-folk. Sport works vastly different. Friendships matter. And that kinda gold is just not found in mining grounds.

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